MONDAY, OCTOBER 12, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 20 PAGES

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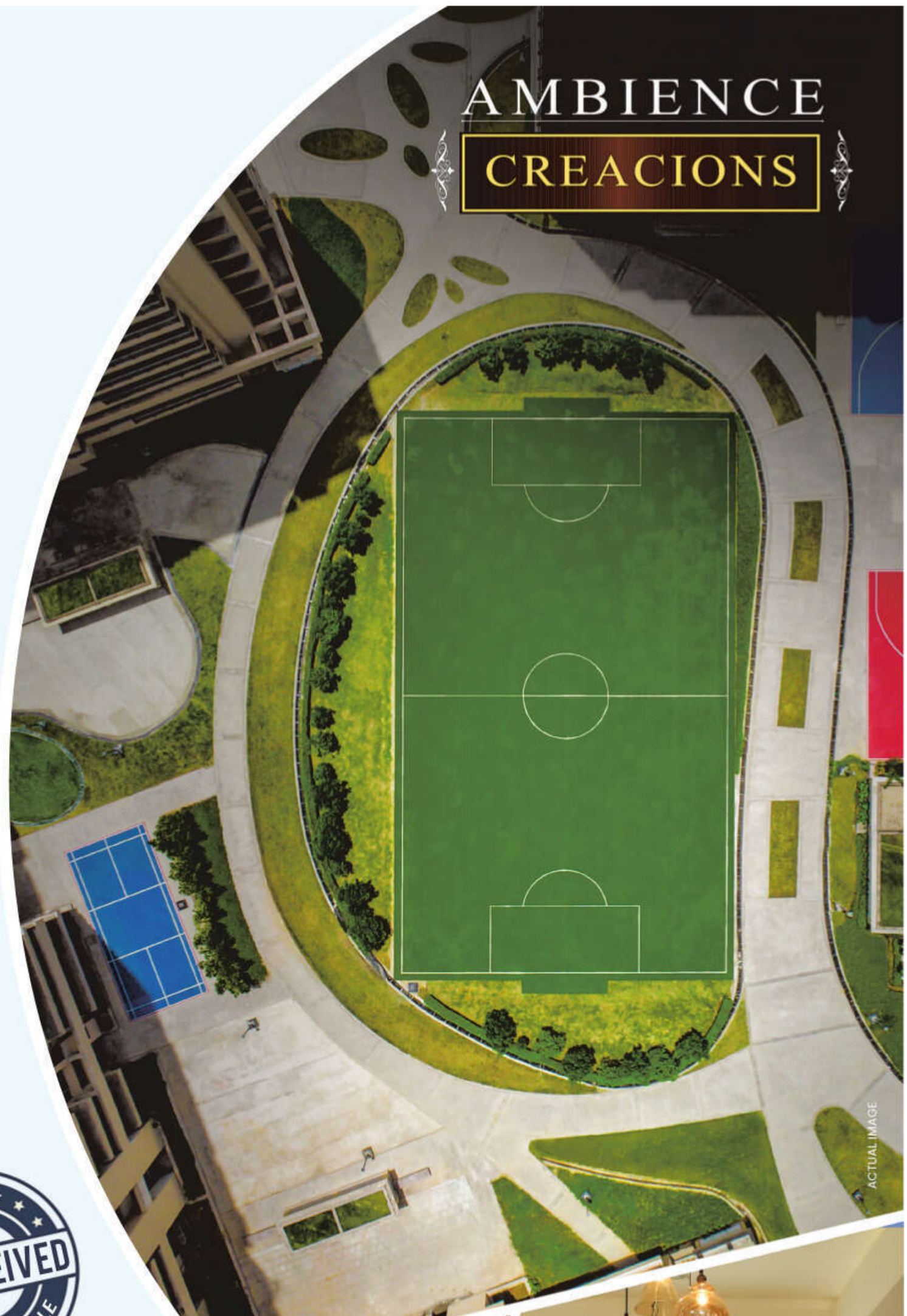
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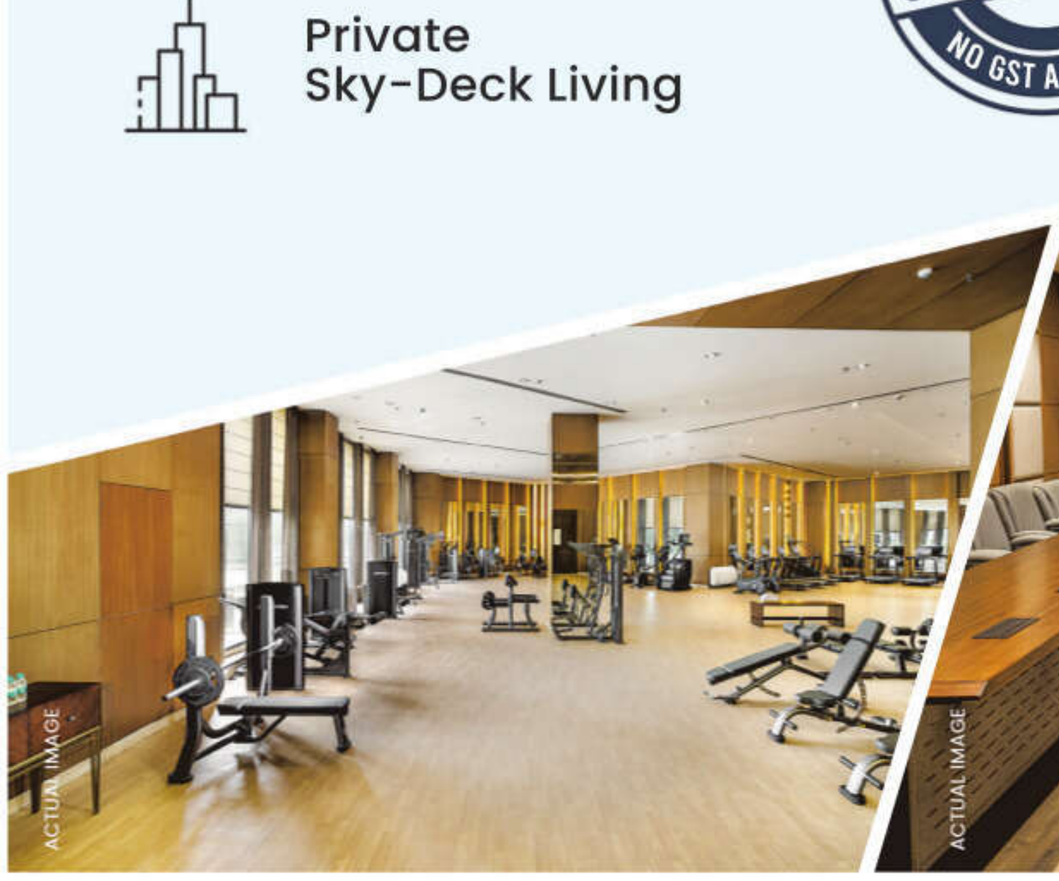
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DELHI PROTESTS: SC ISSUES NOTICES TO CENTRE, POLICE, DMRC, SAYS PRIMA FACIE CASE OF CONTEMPT

SC: Ensure no illegal detentions, restore Metro, internet services

In special sitting, Bench underlines law and order conditions for lifting of curbs

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 11

AMID THE ongoing protests in the Capital, the Supreme Court on Sunday directed the authorities to ensure that there are no illegal detentions, free and smooth movement of people is allowed, Metro and train services function normally, and internet services are not disrupted — all subject to law and order conditions.

A bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana held a special sitting to hear petitions challenging the restrictions put in place on Saturday, allegedly in contempt of the court's directions on Friday to ensure there is "no complete prohibition on movement of Metro/ trains", and the detention of protesters including political leaders.

Saying that there was a prima facie contempt case, the bench issued notices to the Centre, Delhi Police and the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) to file affidavits and submit compliance reports. "Having considered the submissions of the learned counsel for the parties and perused the averments in the contempt petition, we are of the opinion that the petitioners have made out a prima facie case. Accordingly, we issue notice upon the alleged contemnors. They are directed to file counter affidavit to the said petition, including a compliance report in terms of our order as aforesaid by 13.10.2026," the bench said in its order.

The bench directed that in the interim, "Metro and rail facilities shall function normally until and unless regulations

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



CPI(M)'s Rajya Sabha member John Brittas being detained at Connaught Place in New Delhi on Sunday. GAJENDRA YADAV

REPORT, PAGE 3



PM Narendra Modi and Tamil Nadu CM C Joseph Vijay take a Metro ride in Chennai, Sunday. ANI

PM: Govts kept changing, my resolve to help TN unbroken

Launches Rs 13,000-cr projects; CM Vijay says strong states make strong India

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 11

PROMISING CENTRAL support to help Tamil Nadu reach "new heights" on what he called a "historic day", Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday inaugurated and laid foundation stones for infrastructure projects worth more than Rs 13,000 crore in the state, including the first operational stretch of Chennai Metro Rail's Phase II.

"We want to build a Tamil Nadu that continuously reaches new heights... Whatever help is required from the Centre, we stand with you with complete commitment," Modi said during an event at IIT Madras.

Recalling his dealings with successive state governments, Modi said that as Gujarat chief minister, he had several opportunities to interact with Tamil Nadu chief ministers M Karunanidhi and J Jayalalithaa, and as Prime Minister with Jayalalithaa, O Panneerselvam, Edappadi K Palaniswami and M K Stalin.

"Governments kept changing, but my resolve for the development of Tamil Nadu and service of its people always remained unbroken... Today, with the same resolve, together with Chief Minister Joseph Vijay, we are taking forward this journey of Tamil Nadu's development," the Prime Minister said.

The projects, he said, would

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

CJP leaders released, to seek new date for Jantar Mantar protest



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke after his release in New Delhi, Sunday. AP

Alok Singh & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, October 11

THE COCKROACH Janta Party (CJP) leadership said on Sunday that its protests would continue across the country until their demands are met, mainly the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The call for continuing the protest was made after CJP's three top leaders — Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das — were released from police custody on Sunday morning, around 24 hours after being held under preventive arrest ahead of the protest they had called on Saturday.

On Sunday night, the CJP announced in a post on X that Ranka, Das and other CJP

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

CJI says no to Cong meeting request, Opp to march to SC today

Asad Rehman & Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 11

THE CONGRESS on Sunday called for a march to the Supreme Court on Monday afternoon to meet Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and submit a memorandum to him amid protests demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar. The CJI, however, declined the request for a meeting.

In his reply to the Opposition party, the CJI raised four points, it is learnt. First, he said that the grievances the Opposition was seeking to raise, including the issue of Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and those related to the CEC, were pending before the court. Second, the CJI is learnt to have pointed out that in the Constitutional scheme, the court does not have the powers to take cognizance of such grievances on the "administrative side".

The CJI told the Opposition party that the court has the power of judicial review under Article 32 and other powers, and that if any petition highlighting these grievances is filed on Monday, it will be taken up for hearing the following day, when the already pending matters are listed for hearing. He also reiterated the court's commitment to protecting the fundamental rights of citizens and that its doors were always open to them.

Hours earlier, Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi issued a "Chalo Dilli" call, urging students, civil society organisations, and Opposition parties to join a march to the Supreme Court, where an Opposition delegation was supposed to meet the CJI. The march is scheduled to begin at 1.30 pm from the Connaught Place-Barakhamba Road junction and end at the Supreme Court, around 2 km away.

In a video message, Gandhi

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Riyadh airport attack: One Indian killed, 10 others injured; Govt says 'unacceptable'

Shubhajit Roy & Nikhila Henry
New Delhi, Hyderabad, October 11

AN INDIAN national was killed and 10 others were injured in the missile attack on Riyadh's international airport on Saturday, the Indian Embassy said. Condemning the attack, India on Sunday said it was "completely unacceptable".

While the government is yet to identify the victim, *The Indian Express* has learnt that he was a resident of Hyderabad, and was part of a 13-member group that had gone for Umrah. A part of the airport's roof fell on him during the attack, said a relative. His family members are reported to be among those injured.

A day after the attack in which 12 others were killed and over 300 injured, Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis claimed responsibility, and also warned airlines, travellers and airport workers to stay away from airports in Saudi Arabia.

Hours later, the Saudi-led coalition in Yemen said an "unidentified projectile" had targeted Riyadh's international airport on Sunday too. It said Saudi air defences had intercepted a cruise missile in the vicinity of the airport.

Meanwhile, US President Donald Trump said Washington was considering joining

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPLAINED

Home to more than 2.7 million Indians

The Indian community in Saudi Arabia numbers around 2.74 million, including skilled and semi-skilled professionals. Since the start of the West Asia war, India has issued statements condemning attacks on civilian targets. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has also spoken to Saudi's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman on the conflict.

THE WORLD P 12

HOUTHIS ISSUE WARNING, RIYADH AIRPORT FACES FRESH ATTACK

Happening today

- **CANADIAN TRADE** Minister Maninder Sidhu will visit India with a delegation of 300 members, seeking to boost ties.
- **CJI SURYA** Kant will attend an event to mark the 33rd anniversary of the NHRC.

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THE WORLD P 12

RUSSIA, UKRAINE HAVE REACHED ENERGY CEASEFIRE AGREEMENT: TRUMP

IDEA EXCHANGE



'Ready to engage with India on even keel... must pass through intersection of dignity and shared benefits'

M RIAZ HAMIDULLAH
HIGH COMMISSIONER, BANGLADESH

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THE EDITORIAL PAGE

BARRICADES AND DETENTIONS DO NOT FORTIFY THE ECI

PAGE 8

INSIDE

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300 PROTESTERS DETAINED AT SHIVAJI PARK IN MUMBAI



3 FLASHES OF PROTEST, EACH SNUFFED OUT

After crackdown, Delhi eases curbs, over 500 detained in 'flash protests'

CPI(M) MP John Brittas detained, says security personnel assaulted him

Pragynesh, Drishti Jain, Sakshi Chand, Abhimanyu Hazarika & Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, October 11

A DAY after Delhi Police and Central forces launched a large-scale crackdown on the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, restrictions in the Capital were slightly eased Sunday, with metro services resuming and internet restrictions lifted.

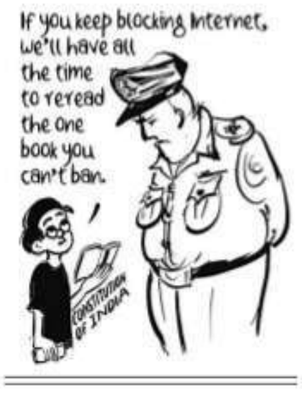
However, groups of five or more people continued to face detention in central Delhi, which remains under prohibitory orders, even as some protesters staged smaller "flash protests" at various locations in the late afternoon.

Around 30,000 police personnel, supported by 200 companies of paramilitary forces,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



• TODDLER DAUGHTER OF THE 31-YEAR-OLD WAS RAPED AND MURDERED IN PUNE

A father's anguish resonates on streets with play on women safety, reporting crime

Chandan Haygunde
Pune, October 11

"IS IT my fault that I am a girl?", asks a rape victim, as people around her rain questions down on her: "What were you wearing?, "Who will marry you now?".... Finally, she breaks down: "He (the rapist) hurt my body, but society is hurting my heart."

This is a scene from a *patha natya* (street play) conceptualised by Shubham Kulkarni, 31, the father of a 3-year-old girl who was raped and murdered this year in Pune. The 12-minute play titled *Nasrapur Prakaran Ajun Kiti* (How many more cases like Nasrapur) was performed recently before Ganpati Mandals in the city during the Ganesh festival.

PAGE 1 anchor

At the end, Kulkarni comes onto the stage for a few minutes to speak to the audience about being cautious regarding the criminal elements in their surroundings.

But, as much as it is about the safety of girls and preventing sexual violence against them, Kulkarni tells *The Indian Express,* "The play sends the message that society should not view the victim and her family negatively. It is wrong to question the victim for the crime committed by the rapist."

The younger daughter of Kulkarni, who works as a priest and lives in Pune, was sexually assaulted and killed on May 1, 2026, while away at her grandmother's house in Nasrapur village in Pune district, leading to widespread public outrage.

The accused, 65-year-old Bhimrao Kamble with a previous criminal record, was tried and convicted by a fast-track court. On June 29, the court awarded Kamble death penalty under Sections of the BNS and POCSO Act.

Kulkarni, whose elder daughter is 7, says while he was satisfied with the court order, the incident again highlighted the issue of safety of women. With that in mind, he started a charitable foundation in his deceased daughter's name. Around the same period, filmmaker Pramod Prabhulkar, who runs the Miracles Academy of Arts and Media, got in touch with the family, offering support for their legal battle.



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The play was staged during the Ganesh festival in Pune recently

Prabhulkar's Marathi film *YouthTube*, released in 2019, was based on similar issues surrounding rape.

On September 12, Kulkarni asked Prabhulkar what he thought about performing a street play to highlight what he felt about his daughter's death. Prabhulkar offered his support.

Prabhulkar told *The Indian Express:* "It was my duty to stand with a father who had lost his daughter to such a serious crime. When I spoke to my team, 15 young artists came forward voluntarily to act in the play."

While Mitali Patwardhan prepared the script, Shreyas Indapur directed it. The play had its first performance on September 22 at the reputed Kasba Ganpati Mandal in Pune, followed by 10 other Ganesh Mandals across the city.

Shravani Mohite, an engineer employed with a corporate company who calls acting her "passion", performed the lead role. "When I heard about the play, I wanted to be a part of it because, like every other girl, I have faced such untoward experiences. Through the play, I wanted to contribute to the cause of women's safety. The response from the audience has been overwhelming. Hundreds of devotees gathered at Ganesh Mandals saw the play. Many were left in tears," says Mohite.

Kulkarni points out that the play urges people not to hide incidents of sexual abuse but to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Mysuru Dasara begins

Karnataka CM D K Shivakumar during the inauguration of Mysuru Dasara festival, at Chamundi Hill. The 11-day celebrations commenced on Sunday with Koppal's Gavimath pontiff Abhinava Gavisiddeshwara Mahaswamiji inaugurating the festivities. PTI

Secunderabad: Girl playing in basement found dead; police search for ex-guard

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, October 11

AROUND 6.30PM on Saturday, a boy went down to the basement of his society's clubhouse in Secunderabad where his five-year-old sister was playing.

She told her brother that she would be back in 10 minutes.

The boy left for home.

Few hours later, the girl's body was found in the basement of the same upscale society, only a short distance away from where she was last seen alive.

Police have begun investigation into the matter and are looking for a man who was earlier employed as a guard in the society, and was captured on CCTV camera following the girl.

"Everyday she used to go and play in the clubhouse basement at 6 pm. She rode a cycle to the clubhouse daily," G Ramesh, ACP, Trimulgherry, told *The Indian Express*.

The siblings lived in an upscale, gated housing society in Secunderabad where it is normal for children to venture out alone. "When she was playing in the basement, her elder brother was asked to fetch her. She told him she would be back in 10 minutes," Ramesh said.

When the girl did not return even by 7pm, the family went searching for her. At 7.45 pm, the child's grandfather received a ransom call from an unknown number demanding Rs 20 lakh against her release.

"Despite that, they kept searching for the child and informed the police at 9pm. We went there and checked the CCTV and found that one man was following the child," Ramesh said.

Police said though the suspect had been fired, he continued being in touch with other security guards. He used the SIM of one of the guards to make the ransom call, they added.

"He called her grandfather using the SIM card of another security guard. So we narrowed down on this suspect," Ramesh said. A case has been registered for kidnapping and murder at the police station concerned.

Meanwhile, an audio clip of the call, during which the demand for ransom was made, went viral.

Police said the suspect was employed as a security guard at the society, which only housed villas, for the past two years.

Police have launched a search operation to trace the accused and formed 10 special teams for the purpose, Ramesh said. His phone was last located near Secunderabad Railway Station after which it was switched off. The police had earlier searched for him near the station premises. Searches were also conducted with drone cameras during the night. Lodges and hotels around Secunderabad Railway Station were also checked.

Police have completed the post mortem examination and have handed over the girl's body back to her bereaved family members. "We have not ruled out sexual assault. So, we have sent vaginal swabs to the Forensic Science Laboratory," Ramesh said.

A father's anguish resonates on streets

report them to the police immediately, "so that criminals don't feel encouraged to commit more crimes". "At the end of the play, emergency contact numbers are displayed for people to call if they learn about such incidents."

For this news report, Kulkarni gave a signed affidavit, saying he has no objections to his name and other details about him being carried.

The other thing Kulkarni wants the play to convey is that the arrest of the accused is not the end, and marks the start of a long judicial process. "After the lower court's order, cases go to the High Court, then the Supreme Court. The time taken for final delivery of justice is uncertain. Also, there is no guarantee that punishment granted by a lower court will be upheld. For a common man, such long legal battles are not easy," says Kulkarni.

Since the accused of the rape-murder of his daughter has been given death, the case will mandatorily be heard by the High Court.

Kulkarni plans to next approach schools and Navratri festival organisers in Pune to hold the play. "We want to take it across Maharashtra. What happened to my daughter should not happen with any other girl."



[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Supreme Court

require to be imposed keeping in mind disturbance to public order as envisaged under Article 19 (2) of Constitution".

"Free movement of people in the city shall be permitted subject to traffic regulations" and "requirement of imposition of barricades shall be reviewed forthwith keeping in mind law and order and other traffic conditions," it said.

"Internet facilities shall remain undisturbed," the bench said, but clarified that it was not taking away the administration's powers to act under the Information Technology Act. "If law requires, that's always there," it said.

"Smooth movement of people in the city shall be permitted in accordance with law," the bench said. "There shall not be detention, save and except by procedure established by law, particularly with regard to peaceful, unarmed assemblage of people beyond the area where Section 163 of Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) is in operation," it said. Section 163 of BNSS empowers executive magistrates to issue urgent, temporary orders to maintain public peace and safety, like barring the assembly of five or more people.

During the hearing, the petitioners informed the bench that Section 163 of BNSS had been imposed right outside the Supreme Court. "We have been informed that a notice board stating imposition of Section 163 has been put up in and around the precincts of the Supreme Court. We direct the authority to take down this board if not already done, so that there is no apprehension with regard to ingress or egress to SC or any other court of law," the bench said.

Appearing for the Centre, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said internet facilities had been restored and Metro/ train services were fully functional. He also assured that lawyers, journalists and other professionals would not be impeded in the discharge of their professional duties.

At the outset, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for a petitioner, said the police were picking up people from trains. He said people were being detained from outside the demarcated area of a 4-km radius around Jantar Mantar. He said internet was suspended and 45 Metro stations were closed on Saturday, despite the court's directions.

On Friday, a bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Bagchi and Justice Mohana had directed the government to ensure that there is "no complete prohibition on movement of Metro/trains", and "no inconvenience is caused to the citizenry of Delhi".

Senior advocate Shadan Farasat, who was among those detained on Saturday, said he was "brutalised" along with others. "Question is not only in respect of lawyers. We are a subset of larger citizenry. We don't have special rights as lawyers. Yesterday, situation in the city was remarkably suppressive. A person was not even allowed to stand on the street. I was thrown in a moving bus after being picked up. It's not about individuals or lawyers but about citizens' right to protest. The sense I got yesterday, we were one step away from police state," he said.

Urging the bench to "restore right of citizens... to protest peacefully in the nation's capital", he said this was "destroyed" on Saturday.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for some petitioners, referred to video grabs of the detentions and related incidents. "If your lordships notice the nature of violence being perpetrated, it's not even a question of being proportionate. First comes necessity, then comes proportionality — necessity to detain individuals moving peacefully, unarmed, children, students, beat them... have scuffles with them, was completely uncalled for," he said.

He urged the court to direct that free movement be restored forthwith and all barricades be removed. He also alleged the continued presence of police personnel without badges.

Senior Advocate Shoeb Alam claimed that 7,000-8,000 people were detained, raising questions about the right to protest.

"We are aware of the gargantuan detentions as you say... A bench presided by Chief Justice of India had already made it clear that Article 19(2) is not a prohibition but a regulation," Justice Bagchi said.

Senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy, who had filed a petition challenging the detention of political leaders, said the youth were being prevented from exercising their constitutional right to protest against what they feel is an unfair election system. "Something graver is at stake -- what is at stake is the suspension of the citizens' peacefully exercised constitutional rights... The last time the court had to consider such requests, such challenges, was at the time of the Emergency," she said.

Advocate Jai Anant Dehadrai, appearing for the Delhi Police, said several police personnel had also been "brutalised" during the protests.

"Life and liberty equally sensitive -- we have said that before. Be it police officer, citizen. All intervention applications will be listed. We will pass a composite order on listed matters," Justice Bagchi said.

Justice Bagchi said the court is agnostic with regard to the individual who is subject to any wrongdoing, and its duty to protect life and liberty extends across all sections.

Responding to the submissions of the petitioners, Mehta said those detained had already been released. "There was no curtailment of any Metro service...There was zero reduction in total volume of Metro operations on October 10," he said. He said of the total 303 Metro stations in the Capital, only 45 were closed. He said all stations were opened with effect from 10 pm on Saturday.

Justice Bagchi said the DMRC should clarify the location of the stations so the court would have a better understanding of the situation. He said the court would also like to see the advisories with regard to train services.

Apparently responding to Sibal's comments to the media earlier that he had lost trust in the Supreme Court, Justice Bagchi also added: "We are here to instil the faith of Mr Sibal in the institution...whose confidence has been one of our surest weapons in the fight for justice."

The bench said it would give the government time to respond to the petitions and that in the meanwhile, no advocate should be hindered from discharging professional duties. The court is likely to hear the matter again on October 13.

Curbs ease

remained deployed across the Capital. Unlike Saturday, police did not check every vehicle within a 10-km radius of Jantar Mantar on Sunday morning. But major roads leading to Parliament Street, including Ashoka Road, Tolstoy Road and Janpath, remained sealed. Entry was restricted to those carrying identity cards.

The number of buses deployed to transport detained protesters was less. At metro stations, commuters travelling from Gurugram to Delhi were seen entering and exiting. However, footfall remained sparse, particularly at stations near Jantar Mantar.

A few people who exited at stations close to the protest venue, including Janpath, Seva Teerth and Patel Chowk, said they were wary of joining the demonstration given the detentions on Saturday. Police checks along MG Road and the Dwarka Expressway were also relatively limited.

The flash protests, in which small groups gathered quickly across New Delhi district to shout slogans, were mainly organised by Left student groups and political parties. More than 500 people were detained.

Around noon, a group of 50-60 members of the All India Students' Federation (AISF) and Krantikari Yuva Sangathan (KYS) were detained near Palika Bazaar. Shortly afterwards, CPI(M) MP John Brittas arrived in the same area and was detained while speaking to the media. He later accused Central forces personnel of assaulting him.

By 1 pm, AISA national president Neha called for a protest near RK Ashram Marg metro station. A heavy deployment of around 200 police, Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB) and Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) personnel was in the area, including a sizeable number of women officers. At around 2.15 pm, SFI protesters took out a march near RK Ashram Marg, with the police taking away more than 50 of them in buses.

Soon afterwards, reports emerged that AISA supporters and Neha had taken out a march in Connaught Place, prompting police personnel to rush across. Neha was subsequently detained near the Panchkuian intersection along with her supporters and taken to a detention centre in a bus. Subsequently, police erected multiple barricades between the Connaught Place inner circle and Panchkuian Road.

At 3.45 pm, a group of 50-60 people led by the DISHA organisation began marching from Gate 1 of Rajiv Chowk metro station, chanting slogans against the CEC and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The march lasted around seven minutes before Delhi Police, Rapid Action Force (RAF) and Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) personnel detained more than half of them.

Students unaffiliated with political organisations also arrived in central Delhi on Sunday to demand the resignation of CEC Kumar. Although their numbers remained relatively small, the easing of metro restrictions allowed some to reach Connaught Place. Carrying placards, these young protesters made their way despite the heavy security presence.

One protester, a first-year student at SRCC, said she had participated in the July protests, too, coming from her home in Rajasthan against the wishes of her parents.

Standing outside Palika Kendra behind a police barricade, holding a handmade poster reading "Gyanesh, it's done bro", she said: "As students, we have the right to ask questions. I wanted to come yesterday too, but I was afraid of the police. Today, I was sure I had to come, even if they were going to detain me." A 21-year-old final-year student at St. Stephen's College, who is "preparing for the UPSC exams", said he had been unable to reach central Delhi Saturday. "Today, I tried getting down at Rajiv Chowk but saw security forces questioning students. So I got down at Central Secretariat instead. But while walking to Connaught Place, the cops were asking every 10 minutes where I was going. They were restricting our movement."

CJI

said: "Tomorrow, we will march to the Supreme Court as Indians, united beyond party, gender, caste, community and state. The youth, all Opposition parties, civil society groups, all those who believe in democracy and stand by the Constitution of India, will walk with us."

"We will submit a memorandum to the CJI on behalf of the nation, demanding an end to vote chori (theft), halting of the SIR and the resignation of Gyanesh Kumar," Gandhi said.

The LoP urged people not to be scared. "These cowards cannot intimidate us. They will have to step aside. We will march together, with love, brotherhood, and patriotism," he said.

Gandhi said the nation's youth, with "love in their hearts", had hit the streets in Delhi to protest peacefully, but were "beaten by the police and BJP goons". "This is not the India we want," he said.

After two days of police crackdown to stop the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and Left student groups from gathering at Jantar Mantar in central Delhi, the Opposition is expected to mobilise Congress, Samajwadi Party (SP), Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD), and Left workers from neighbouring states for the march, sources said. The Opposition is trying to ensure that the march is larger than the protests it held in the national Capital over the past week.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said earlier in the day that the Opposition can't "demand anything from him (CJI)" and only wants to place its "concerns before him with folded hands and request his intervention".

Accusing Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah of creating "chaos across the country", Kharge said, "An undeclared Emergency is prevailing, and we will continue to fight against it."

Apart from Kharge and Gandhi, MPs from all INDIA bloc parties are expected to join the protest. Other senior leaders likely to attend include Mamata All India Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee, SP president Akhilesh Yadav, CPI's P Sandosh Kumar, and CPI(M)'s M A Baby and John Brittas, sources said.

Trinamool's Rajya Sabha MP Derek O'Brien said the crackdown on protesters and the detention of journalists covering the protests were a "cause for concern" for the government.

"We are seeing journalists being picked up by police from outside the Press Club of India. These are dangerous signs for this government. I express gratitude to the young people of India and 'cockroaches' who have got this going," O'Brien told *The Indian Express*.

Senior Congress leader K C Venugopal also criticised Delhi Police, saying that every time one thought it "couldn't hit new lows, it went lower".

"Detaining and assaulting reporters from agencies, Malayalam journalists, independent bloggers and YouTubers, especially women, to hide your own crimes, is completely unforgivable," he said.

Venugopal accused the police of turning "the entire city into a torture chamber where innocent citizens exercising their fundamental rights are being chased, thrashed and detained".

He alleged that vigilante groups aligned with the ruling party were being allowed to assault protesters under police protection.

On October 9, INDIA bloc MPs had met President Droupadi Murmu to raise their concerns about SIR and the EC.

Riyadh

Saudi strikes on the Houthis in the conflict, a spillover from the war on Iran that the US and Israel launched in February.

Among the others killed in Saturday's attack were four Saudi citizens, two Bangladeshi nationals, a Palestinian, a US citizen, an Egyptian, a Jordanian, a Syrian and a Sudanese, the Saudi civil aviation authority said. In a post on X, the Indian Embassy in Riyadh said: "It is learnt that one Indian national injured in the Riyadh attack has unfortunately lost his life today. We convey our heartfelt condolences to the family of the deceased. We are in touch with the family and will provide all support for ensuring the early repatriation of mortal remains."

In an earlier post, it said it "has been following up on the dastardly attack". "It is learnt that 11 Indians are among those injured in the attack. Embassy has been in touch with local authorities to enquire about their well-being. Our officials have also reached out to the hospital authorities. We will provide further updates as they become available," it said.

Quoting the Indian Embassy's post, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said on X: "Our Embassy is doing everything necessary in this difficult situation."

Earlier in the day, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) issued a statement condemning the attack. "We strongly condemn the repeated attacks on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport over the past few days, including the dastardly attack on October 10, which have led to loss of lives, injuries and damage to property. We express our condolences to the families of the deceased and wish speedy recovery to the injured persons," it said.

"The repeated attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure are completely unacceptable and must cease immediately," it said. "We stand in solidarity with the people and the government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia in defence of their sovereignty, and hope that peace and normalcy returns to the region at the earliest," it added. This is the second time in the last few days that India has condemned the attacks on Saudi airports. On October 8, with two airports in Saudi targeted in the previous two days, India had issued a strong condemnation along with an advisory to its nationals there to remain alert.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

CJP leaders released

leaders would go to the Parliament Street police station at 10 am Monday to seek a date for another protest at Jantar Mantar. "Delhi police can give us a date within 24 hours, or we will announce our own protest call," it said.

The CJP leaders and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee were among over 7,000 people, including Opposition leaders and activists, who were detained on Saturday as authorities clamped down on the protest in central Delhi. Other detainees had been released by Saturday night.

Dipke, Ranka and Das were released from the heavily secured Delhi Cantt police station at around 10.15 am Sunday on the orders of the Executive Magistrate at Delhi Cantt. According to police, the CJP leaders were released after they signed a bond. "A bail bond as Surety Bond of Rs 50,000 was filled for maintaining peace and good behaviour, for a period of one year, and they were released by the SEM (Special Executive Magistrate) Court," the police said.

While Dipke left for his home in Maharashtra following the demise of his grandmother, the other CJP leaders held a press conference in the afternoon and accused the Delhi Police of seizing their phones without following the prescribed legal procedure, including the preparation of a seizure memo.

"They picked us up as if we were criminals. They took our phones forcibly," Das told reporters, adding that all three of them had been taken to different locations. He alleged that their phones had been retained for 24 hours and expressed apprehension that the devices might have been "hacked", "cloned" or "planted with evidence".

Referring to the bond they had signed, the CJP declared on X: "No CJP leader has signed any bond that says they will not protest any more. The bond refers to refraining of breach of peace. But participating in a peaceful protest is a Constitutional right and DOES NOT breach peace."

Ranka, meanwhile, accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah of causing "the actual breach of peace". He said the clampdown over the weekend and the mass detention of protesters has "damaged the image of our country".

Das said they wanted to protest at the designated protest site at Jantar Mantar, adding that the move to turn it into a highly secured fortress had inconvenienced residents and created an atmosphere of confrontation.

"The people want to protest at the designated site. The Government should have come forward to talk with us. More than 40,000 troops are here. It has become a fortress. You have created a war-like situation and people are facing problems," he said.

Dipke, Das and Ranka had been detained on Saturday within minutes of their flight from Mumbai landing in Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport at 10.19 am.

Soon after their release on Sunday, the Delhi police issued a statement saying that they had been placed in detention as preventive arrests under sections 126/170 of the BNSS.

Section 126 BNSS is a preventive measure which empowers an Executive Magistrate to require a person likely to breach the peace or disturb public tranquillity to execute a bond for maintaining peace.

Section 170 BNSS, on the other hand, lets a police officer arrest someone without a warrant who they think can commit a cognizable offence which cannot be prevented without the arrest. Custody can be only upto 24 hours unless further detention is permitted.

"All due legal procedures were followed and they were produced before the SEM Court, Delhi Cantt on October 11," the police said.

YouTuber Rathee, who was picked up from his residence in Gurugram's Sector 56 on Saturday morning, described his detention as a "kidnapping" in a video posted on X on Sunday. "I was sleeping in my bedroom...at around 7 am, someone was at the door and my mother opened the door. There were 20 men without any uniforms. They pushed her and barged in," he claimed in the video.

He alleged that he was "dragged like a criminal" from his bedroom, and that he did not have access to his phone for the duration of his detention. "I couldn't even wear my slippers. I was dragged and shoved into a jeep. They took me to many police stations. They snatched my phone...didn't let me meet my lawyers. For around 20 hours, they detained me. I wasn't allowed to access my phone," he said.

PM in Tamil Nadu

make daily travel easier, strengthen industry and trade and "create jobs for young people across Tamil Nadu".

Vijay, who shared a dais with the Prime Minister for the first time in a major government event, sought Central approval for a series of Metro, highway, high-speed rail and water projects.

Welcoming the Prime Minister, Vijay said his government was seeking to provide a "corruption-free and transparent administration, rooted in social justice" while pursuing inclusive development in education, healthcare, agriculture, fisheries and the larger economy.

"Strong states make strong India. When the Union government and state government work together, its benefits should directly reflect in the lives of the people," he said.

Tamil Nadu, he said, was working towards becoming a 1.5-trillion USD economy by 2036, with an emphasis on "Innovation, Investment and Infrastructure," while ensuring that growth extended beyond Chennai to every district.

Most of Vijay's speech was marked by requests to the Centre. He sought approval for about 65 km of Chennai Metro Phase III, covering Airport-Kilambakkam, Poonamallee-Sriperumbudur/ Sunguvarchatram and Koyambedu-Pattabiram. He asked Modi to reconsider Metro proposals for Coimbatore and Madurai, and sought approval for an interstate Metro connection linking Hosur with Bengaluru.

Vijay also welcomed the high-speed rail corridors connecting Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Chennai announced in the 2026 Union Budget, while reiterating Tamil Nadu's request for extensions from Chennai to Kanyakumari and Coimbatore.

The Chief Minister's requests for highways included six-laning the Chengalpattu-Trichy section of GST Road; stretches connecting Trichy, Panchapur, Jayamkondam and Karur; and the Karur-Coimbatore route, besides an elevated corridor from Madhavaram to Sholavaram.

Vijay asked the Centre to prioritise the Godavari-Cauvery river-linking proposal as a national project and act on Tamil Nadu's request to use Tamil as the principal language in proceedings of the Madras High Court. He also sought the release, "without any conditionalities," of Rs 510 crore that he said was due to Tamil Nadu from the Central share of funds.

Earlier, Modi arrived at the Chennai airport shortly after 11 am, where Vijay received him with a shawl and bouquet. Their first stop was Porur Bypass Metro station. After 12 pm, Modi and Vijay, along with Governor Rajendra Arlekar, flagged off the first train on the 14.64-km Poonamallee Bypass-Vadapalani section of Chennai Metro Rail Phase II, and travelled from Porur Bypass to Poonamallee and back.

Vijay said Chennai already had 54 km of operational Metro under Phase I, and that Phase II was under construction. Passenger operations on the new stretch began later Sunday.

Modi placed the expansion within the rapid growth of Metro systems nationally. "In 2014, Metro ran in only five cities in the country. Today, Metro services are operated in 25 cities," the Prime Minister said.

The country's Metro network had grown from around 250 km in 2014 to more than 1,100 km, Modi said. The expansion in Chennai was intended to make travel easier for "ordinary people," working families, students and senior citizens, he said.

After the Metro journey, Modi visited the Jalakandeshwarar temple and the Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre before attending the government function at IIT Madras. Governor Arlekar and Vijay accompanied him on these visits.

Referring to these visits in his speech, Modi said: "From temple to Metro, these experiences of Tamil Nadu, this is the spirit of today's India."

Anti-CEC stir: 4 linked to right-wing outfit arrested for beating protesters

2 men booked in attempted murder cases earlier

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 11





Raman Singh and Ravinder Singh are among four men arrested.

FOUR MEN, who claimed to be linked with right-wing outfit Hindu Raksha Dal, were arrested on Sunday after a purported video, widely shared on social media, showed a group of men allegedly assaulting young demonstrators, including women, amid protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Two of them have been previously booked in attempted murder cases.

The incident took place on Saturday at Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg, according to officers, as the Capital saw intense restrictions following a call by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and All India Students' Association (AISA) over alleged Special Intensive Revision (SIR) irregularities.

Police said the arrested men have been identified as Raman Saini, 50; Vivekanand alias Vivek, 32; Kapil Kumar, 27; and Ravinder Singh alias Govind Hindu, 35.

Madhur Verma, Joint Commissioner of Police, Central Range, said, "During the investigation, we received inputs that three of the four men were planning to flee. One was planning to go to Madhya Pradesh, another to Haridwar, while the third was planning to leave for another district in Uttar Pradesh. They were subsequently traced and arrested."

Two of the four accused — Raman Saini and Ravinder Singh — have been previously booked in attempted murder cases, said police. While a case against Saini was filed at Burari police station in North Delhi, the case against Singh was filed in Uttar Pradesh.

The accused were reportedly proceeding towards Hanuman Mandir in Connaught Place when the incident took place.

The purported clip had triggered widespread condemnation. Former UP chief minister Akhilesh Yadav, Indian Youth Congress, AISA and CJP shared the video on their official handles on social media.

The viral footage purportedly shows young protesters getting hit, with women also subjected to physical aggression. A police officer can reportedly be seen at the scene as the incident unfolds.

While no complaint was filed, Delhi Police took suo motu cognisance of the matter and registered an FIR under sections pertaining to causing hurt and wrongful restraint.

Police had also received a tip-off earlier, suggesting that the accused might attempt to leave Delhi-NCR and go into hiding, prompting teams to trace and arrest them.

Was grabbed by neck, pinned down & choked, says MP John Brittas

Drishti Jain, Liz Mathew & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, October 11



Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas was detained on Sunday. GAJENDRA YADAV

CPI(M) RAJYA Sabha MP John Brittas was detained and allegedly manhandled by security personnel at Connaught Place on Sunday afternoon, with the MP alleging that he was grabbed by the neck, pinned down to a seat inside a bus and choked before being taken to RML Hospital for treatment.

Brittas was speaking to mediapersons a few metres away from a group of protesters when personnel from the Rapid Action Force and Delhi Police detained him.

"I had gone to Connaught Place after getting information that some student leaders had been detained. I was standing on the road and talking to some journalists when CRPF men forcefully detained me and threw me in a bus. They pinned me to a seat after grabbing me by the neck and choked me. It was only after a Delhi Police DCP's intervention that I was allowed to go," he told *The Indian Express*.

"I had been telling the CRPF men that I am an MP. But they didn't listen and assaulted me," he said.

A video later shared by CPI(M) showed Brittas lying on the steps of a bus and panting, with another person assisting him. "While in the van, DCP Sachin Sharma was calling on my mobile. He seemed to have found out that I was taken away. There was this boy from Jharkhand, Sajith, with me. He helped me take the phone call," the MP said.

The DCP was heard directing personnel to release him, Brittas said. "They seemed to have realised the seriousness," he said, adding that Delhi Police personnel subsequently tried to drop him at an unfamiliar location. "I was about to collapse. They put me in an auto and I somehow could recollect that my car was parked in CP. Then my driver and the CPM general secretary came and took me to RML," he said.

The detention took place amid a crackdown on student groups and Left activists protesting against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The protest was scheduled for 10 am, following a call by AISA national president Neha.

A senior police officer said that Brittas was detained after he refused to move from the area despite repeated requests. "His allegations of assault inside the police van will be investigated," the officer added.

The incident took place when Brittas, who was surrounded by cameras as he spoke to journalists, criticised the police action. "Whatever the Delhi Police is saying and doing is against the pronouncements of the Supreme Court... Delhi Police cannot become a state. The state has become Delhi police now... students are being trashed...," he said. "In a Capital city, four or more people cannot come together; they can be thrashed and detained. Is this democracy... Internet shutdown... is also being denied. Every protesters face is being covered by the police with their camera... So, I would say absolutely it is anarchy," he added.

Following the incident, Brittas wrote to the President, the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha and the Chief Justice of India, seeking urgent intervention, accountability and an independent investigation.

CPI(M) condemned the action, alleging that Brittas had been brutally attacked by the Delhi Police. "He was later dropped by the roadside, visibly injured and in distress. Delhi Police has crossed all limits!," it posted on X.

Several other Left leaders, including CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby, Brinda Karat, M V Govindan, P K Sreemathy and P Rajeev, were also detained on Sunday. CPI national secretary Annie Raja was also detained along with activists of the All India Students' Federation and the All India Youth Federation who were marching towards Jantar Mantar.

"The Communist Party of India strongly condemns the brutal manhandling and detention CPI National Secretary of Annie Raja and police brutality against AISF-AIYF activists who were peacefully marching towards Jantar Mantar...," CPI said in a statement.

How Dipke, two other CJP leaders were released

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, October 11



Police detain protesters at Connaught Place in New Delhi on Sunday. GAJENDRA YADAV

A DAY after Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke and two other CJP leaders, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, were detained by Delhi Police from an aircraft at the Indira Gandhi International Airport, an Executive Magistrate Court in the Capital on Sunday ordered their release. According to their lawyer, the police "could not give grounds for further detention".

The three CJP leaders were detained on Saturday upon arrival in the Capital from Mumbai to lead a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged discrepancies in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise. Police had said that they had not given permission for the protest.

Placed under preventive arrest, the CJP leaders were produced before the Court of Special Executive Magistrate Sanghamitra at the Delhi Cantonment Police Station on Sunday. As they were not arrested, and were placed under preventive arrest, they were produced before the Executive Magistrate within 24 hours rather than a Judicial Magistrate.

They were subsequently asked to fill a personal bond of Rs 50,000 and released on the condition that they will "not engage in breach of peace for one year". "This was an arrest under preventive detention provisions of BNSS) The ground was that, as per the police, these persons could 'commit' a crime if not detained," their counsel, Advocate Soutik Banerjee, told *The Indian Express*.

Advocate Banerjee added, "The police could give no grounds of further detention, so they were released. A procedural hearing took place where we sought release on personal bonds and without any deposit by surety. A more detailed hearing would've taken place had the police provided grounds of further detention which then we would have contested legally. All our submissions and prayers were accepted by the SEM Court, including for the release of their devices, which were taken away during the period of detention."

Along with him, advocate Devika Tulsani appeared for the CJP leaders. The charges invoked against the three CJP leaders were sections 126 (Security for keeping peace) and 170 (Arrest to prevent commission of cognizable offences) of the BNSS. Section 126 BNSS is a preventive measure, which empowers an Executive Magistrate to require a person likely to breach the peace or disturb public tranquillity to execute a bond for maintaining peace.

Section 170 of the BNSS, on the other hand, lets a police officer arrest someone without a warrant who they think can commit a cognizable offence which cannot be prevented without the arrest. Custody, however, can be extended to only 24 hours unless further detention is permitted.

"A breach of peace would mean only such activity that is not constitutionally permitted and not protected as a fundamental right. If the Constitution allows me to express myself freely, to form associations and gatherings, or to move freely, then that can only be curbed within the narrow paradigm of reasonable restrictions which are proportionate in nature," Banerjee said. "As was repeatedly stated by the Supreme Court today, peaceful protests are permitted and can always be organised. That cannot by any stretch of imagination amount to a breach of peace," he added.

Crackdown against over 1,000 structures in a month after Satya Niketan building collapse killed seven

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 11



A five-storey building collapsed in Satya Niketan on September 6. FILE

IN A major crackdown on illegal construction and unsafe buildings in the Capital, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has taken action against 1,046 properties between September 6 and October 10. Directions were issued by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta in the wake of concerns over building safety after a building collapsed in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan last month, claiming seven lives.

According to the government, while 282 of these properties were sealed, 47 dangerous buildings were demolished, as part of the ongoing exercise to address structural risks and enforce building regulations.

The five-storey building in Satya Niketan that was being operated as a paying guest (PG) accommodation for students in a dilapidated condition and construction work was being carried out in the basement.

Officials said the enforcement drive covering all 12 MCD zones aims to prevent accidents by targeting unauthorised construction and structures posing a threat to public safety.

"Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has directed the civic body to sustain and accelerate the campaign, stressing that there will be no compromise on citizen safety," an official said.

The South Zone recorded demolition action against 121 properties, followed by Shahdara North at 115 and Rohini at 158.

Action was also taken against 62 properties in Narela, 63 in Civil Lines, 61 in Keshavpuram, 87 in City-SP Zone, 85 in Karol Bagh, 87 in Shahdara South, 87 in West Zone, 45 in Najafgarh and 75 in Central Zone.

Also, 87 properties were sealed in City-SP Zone, 41 each in Shahdara North and South Zone, 27 in Shahdara South, 23 in West Zone, 20 in Keshavpuram, 18 in Central Zone, 11 in Karol Bagh, eight in Civil Lines, three in Najafgarh, two in Rohini and one in Narela.

As part of action against hazardous structures, 13 dangerous buildings were demolished in Karol Bagh, eight each in Civil Lines, City-SP Zone and West Zone, two each in Narela, Rohini, Keshavpuram and South Zone, and one each in Shahdara South and Najafgarh. No demolition of dangerous buildings was recorded in Shahdara North or Central Zone during the period.

Meanwhile, in Seemapuri, where a building collapse recently killed at least four people, one unsafe building was demolished.

The Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) also issued notices to three other houses in the area.

The objective, Chief Minister Gupta has emphasised, is to ensure compliance with building regulations, identify potntially hazardous structures and reduce the risk of accidents.

Multiple FIRs filed amid crackdown

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 11

AMID SPORADIC protests against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar following the call given by Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and All India Students' Association (AISA), Delhi Police has registered multiple FIRs since Saturday at various locations in the city, according to officers.

Even as the number of cases filed has not been revealed officially, sources said at least 20 FIRs have been registered. These are in addition to 25 FIRs registered in connection with similar demonstrations held between October 2 and 9, which include cases related to alleged assault on police personnel, unauthorised demonstrations and other violations, according to officers.

The latest FIRs pertain to incidents reported during Saturday's demonstrations when groups of protesters attempted to assemble at several locations in parts of the Capital. The cases registered include allegations of disrupting law and order, obstructing public servants from discharging their duties and other violations, said sources.

The sections invoked in the FIRs, the number of people named as accused and the details of the allegations in individual cases are yet to be revealed. After CJP-AISA called for protest over alleged discrepancies in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision exercise, Delhi Police on Saturday intervened to disperse gatherings and detain protesters in various parts of the city following denial of permission to hold demonstration at Jantar Mantar.

The Capital saw heavy restrictions over the weekend to quell the protests. While 45 Metro stations were closed Saturday amid heavy security deployment, Around 30,000 police personnel, supported by 200 companies of paramilitary forces, remained deployed across the city on Sunday.

A day after thousands of people were detained, more than 500 people were detained on Sunday as sporadic demonstrations continued for the second day in a row.

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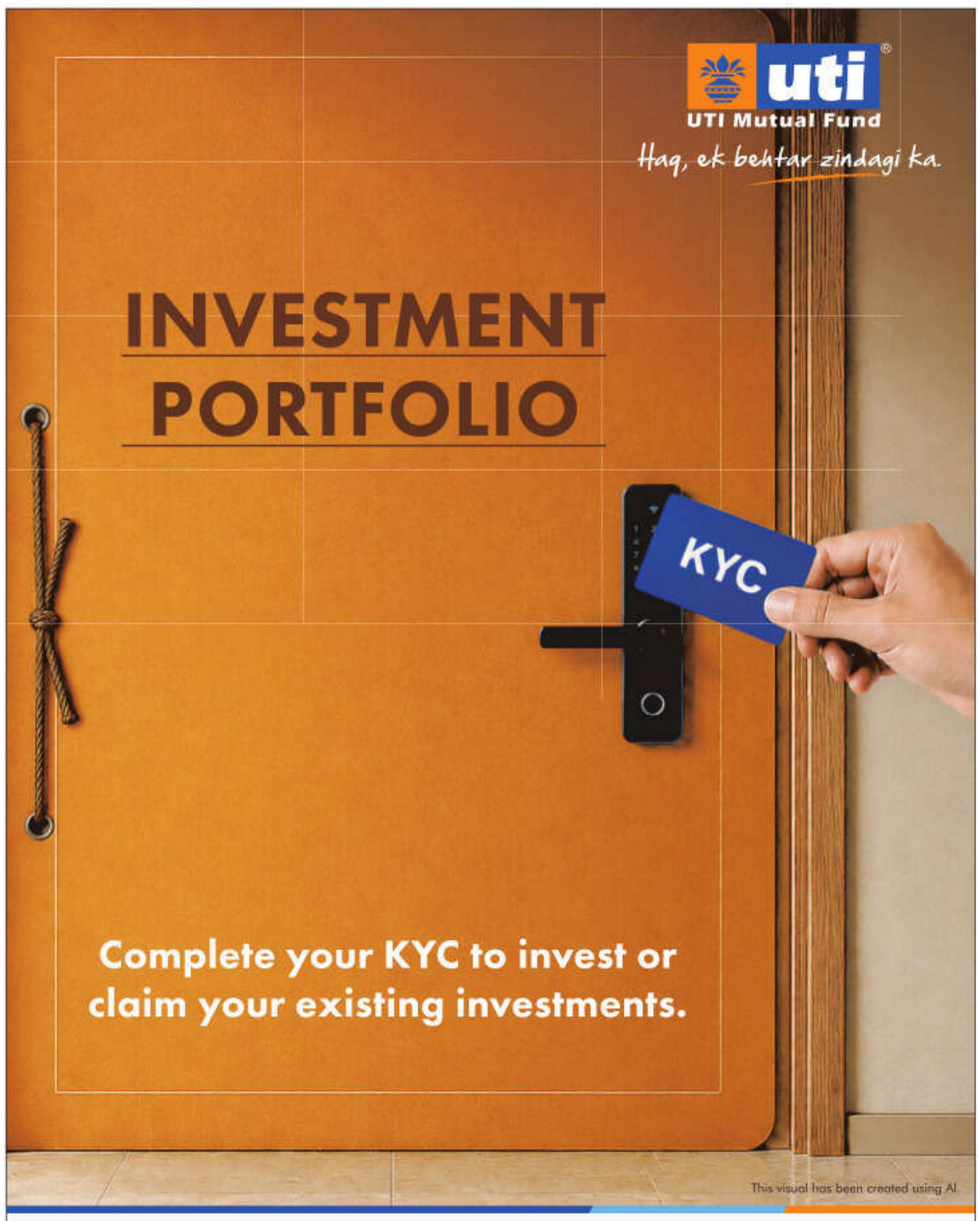
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Security personnel stand guard at Connaught Place in Delhi on Sunday. GAJENDRA YADAV

3 flashes of protest, each snuffed out

Heavy security deployment, swift detentions and scenes of resistance across Central Delhi

Pragynesh, Abhimanyu Hazarika & Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, October 11

AS SECURITY personnel detained protesters at RK Ashram Marg on Sunday afternoon, a woman wearing a mask, a red cloth around her neck and round, black-rimmed glasses was mistaken for AISA national president Neha, triggering a media frenzy.

As AISA supporters who arrived for the protest were picked up one by one, each hauled away by four to five police personnel and pushed into waiting buses, a fresh commotion erupted behind them. "Neha is detained," someone said.

Suddenly, cameras swung around. Mediapersons shouted the breaking news – "Neha has been detained. The police are taking her away."

As protesters jostled with the police around the woman, she was eventually pushed towards the steps of a bus. As she turned her head, possibly to face the cameras, good sense dawned upon the onlookers.

She was not Neha but a look-alike. A reel on Neha's Instagram account soon revealed that she was elsewhere – in Connaught Place, running alongside AISA supporters as police personnel chased them.

Near Blue Tokai, Neha slowed down. She was eventually detained at Vijay Chowk, this time with the police having found the right person.

The episode unfolded amid heavy security deployments at two locations in the Capital, where police detained protesters from AISA, SFI and other Left groups during flash protests. Around 50 people were detained in the episodes at RK Ashram Marg and Connaught Place, with police pushing them into buses and detaining them.

At RK Ashram Marg, the protest called by Neha against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar barely had time to gather momentum before police moved in. More than 200 police and paramilitary personnel lined the streets beneath the elevated Metro corridor.

Women police officers stood shoulder-to-shoulder along one side of the road, while personnel from the Sashastra Seema Bal and other Central Armed Police Forces, equipped with riot shields, helmets with face visors and batons, occupied nearby lanes.

As activists from AISA and other Left groups arrived and raised slogans, security personnel moved in, detaining them and taking them away in buses bound for holding centres.

Meanwhile, an elderly man from Punjab affiliated with CJP, who had participated in the July protests against the NEET paper leak, watched. "I came here to show solidarity with the CJP and for the cause the current movement is raising... But this time, the police are not letting any mobilisation happen," he said.

In Connaught Place, CRPF and RAF personnel and a fleet of orange low-floor buses had taken over A Block by 5.30 pm, ahead of the SFI's women-only Tiranga rally near Gate 7 of Rajiv Chowk Metro station.







(Clockwise from top) During a demonstration near R K Ashram Metro station; an activist climbs onto the front of a bus; Neha runs alongside AISA supporters as police personnel chase them on Sunday.
GAJENDRA YADAV, MISHAL MUSSADDIQUE, X/@NEHA_AISA

Shortly after 6 pm, police began detaining protesters. A woman social worker was among the first to be taken away, followed by others, including a lawyer and her friend.

"I am cooperating," the lawyer said as police personnel dragged and pushed her and her friend into a bus.

Inside another bus, a woman in a white kurti and black mask shouted to mediapersons: "They cannot rightfully detain us according to today's Supreme Court order. I do not know why I am being detained or where I am being taken."

Another protester, who managed to open a bus window despite male police personnel guarding it from outside, said she had been detained for asking where her sister had been taken. "She was detained before me and I don't know where she was taken away to," she added.

At 6.40 pm, as a bus began to pull away, around 10 protesters, including SFI activists, tried to stop it. Former JNU students' union president and SFI member Aishe Ghosh and another protester, who had the National Flag draped across her back, climbed onto the front of the bus and held on.

Around 15 minutes later, police personnel pulled the women down and pushed them into the bus. Officers then formed a human chain to clear the way for the vehicle to leave Connaught Place.

From inside the bus, a protester screamed: "We are being grabbed, held against our will for just walking through the streets."

For Khushi (26), who had stayed away from CJP's July protests out of fear, the scenes were difficult to watch. "I was too scared to attend the July protests. This time I made up my mind to be here. But the way police have manhandled the protesters, especially women after 6 pm, is horrendous. The officers are pushing, grabbing and dragging them without a care in the world," she said.


Detained protesters on Sunday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Peaceful protest in areas where Section 163 is not in force will be allowed, say police

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 11

THE DELHI Police will continue to assess the law and order situation before acting against gatherings in areas where prohibitory orders are in force, a senior officer said on Sunday, following the Supreme Court's ruling setting limits on detentions in areas where prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS is not in force.

BNSS Section 163 empowers authorities to issue orders to prevent potential disturbances.

"We are allowing people to move and, even in areas where Section 163 of the BNSS is in force, we let people operate peacefully. But, as the Supreme Court said, we take cognisance of the law and order situation and then act accordingly. Any peaceful protest in areas where Section 163 is not in force will be allowed," the officer said.

The SC also said that Metro and rail services shall function undisturbed unless they are required to be regulated under "reasonable restrictions". Also, there should be no illegal detention, particularly of peaceful and unarmed assemblies in areas where Section 163 is not in force.

The officer said they have no plans of stopping Metro and rail services as of now. "The court has opined what our assessment is as well. The law and order situation is tense in the Jantar Mantar area, as multiple groups have given a protest call. But security in the area will be as beefed up," the officer added.

The verdict came on petitions alleging illegal detentions and seeking contempt action for wilful disobedience of the court's October 9 directive, which said restrictions on Metro services should not inconvenience ordinary commuters.


A detainee on way to a holding centre. GAJENDRA YADAV

The ruling comes amid continued police action against flash protests in Central Delhi, where several people were detained on Sunday. The court's observations distinguish between areas where Section 163 is in force and those where it is not.

On Sunday, unlike Saturday, police were not checking every vehicle moving within a 10-km radius of Jantar Mantar. Traffic had also eased on roads such as Kasturba Gandhi Marg, Minto Road and Vande Mataram Marg. However, streets around Palika Bazaar and Hanuman Mandir, including Baba Kharak Singh Marg and Connaught Place's inner circle, remained deserted. Nobody without an ID card was allowed in.

One direction remained same: anyone part of a group of five or more in New Delhi area will be detained. "We can't lay siege to the city every day. But anyone organising a protest here will be detained," a senior officer told *The Indian Express*.

'Showed press cards, yet picked up': 3 *Express* journalists briefly detained

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 11

AS REPORTERS covering sporadic protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in the Capital faced police action for the second day in a row, three journalists from *The Indian Express* Hindi team were among those detained on Sunday.

Shashwat, Siya and Vijay Kumar said that they were picked up at Chelmsford Road in New Delhi and released near Chhatrasal Stadium in North Delhi after around 45 minutes.

Recounting the incident, Shashwat said he and his colleagues were travelling from Connaught Place when they learnt that All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha was expected to reach RK Ashram for a fresh round of protest on Sunday afternoon. "Several layers of barricades restricted access to the area, and police personnel at successive checkpoints directed us to take detours," he recalled.

As they reached Chelmsford Road, they saw police personnel detaining student protesters, and approached them to understand what was happening.

"When we moved closer, police personnel allegedly pushed us forward and attempted to detain us as well. We immediately identified ourselves as journalists and explained that we were there for reporting. All three of us showed our press cards. Despite this, we were told to board a police bus," Shashwat recounted, adding that they were released about 12 km away from the spot. "We had gone there to report on the protests. We had identified ourselves, and explained why we were there. Yet, while trying to speak to protesters and document events on the ground, we found ourselves being taken away with them," he said.



Shashwat and Siya, journalists with *IE Hindi*.

Several journalists have said that they have faced police action over the weekend while covering the demonstrations after the protest call by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and the AISA over alleged irregularities in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision exercise.

The detentions at different locations were followed by scenes of confusion as journalists attempted to intervene when fellow reporters were being taken away.

In one of the incidents on Sunday, a journalist working with a national daily was detained but reportedly managed to jump out of the police bus in which he was being taken away.

A woman journalist working with another national daily was also allegedly briefly held despite wearing her press card. Following a brief verbal exchange, she was allowed to leave.

● DETAINED TWICE IN TWO DAYS

'Time to change system': Story behind viral photo of woman with SFI flag

Reva Thakkar & Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, October 11

A TIRANGA Women Rally, to be held by the Students' Federation of India (SFI), was scheduled for 6.30 pm on Sunday. However, before the rally could begin, around 6 pm, police started detaining protesters. At least 25 women were detained and Puzhakkal Pavithra was one of them.

"All of us were detained together. We were here for the SFI rally, but before it could even begin, we were detained," said Pavithra on a call with The Indian Express while she was in the detention bus.

A day earlier, a picture of Pavithra, showing her running with an SFI flag in her hand, had gone viral. "I had no idea what was happening. We had started our march from AKG Bhavan in the afternoon. On our way toward Jantar Mantar, we heard some police officers shouting, 'Bring the lady police officers'. We started running."

Her fellow protesters were detained, but she ran in a different direction. "I didn't realise that I was holding the flag," she added.

"It is our fundamental right to protest and that was restricted by the government today. During the July protests, I could not be here. I was in Kerala on a vacation. But this time, I knew I should be here. It's about time that we do something to change the system," said the 20-year-old, a third-year student of Anthropology at Hansraj College, Delhi University.

Pavithra, originally from Kerala's Palakkad district, has been part of the students' outfit for two years now.

Pavithra's mother, a bank employee, is a CPI(M) member in Palakkad. She is also the granddaughter of K V Chandran, a prominent Communist leader and a former Sarpanch of Mankara (Palakkad). Her father passed away when she was young.



The photo of SFI's Puzhakkal Pavithra that went viral.

Recounting the sequence of events on Saturday, Pavithra said she, along with other SFI members, had been camping at H K S Surjeet Bhavan the previous night. Around 8 am on Saturday, as news of police putting up barricades began to spread, about three-quarters of the students were shifted to the A K G Lawn. Bread and tea were arranged for breakfast.

"Around 11.30 am-12 pm, we started marching from AKG Bhavan. But soon after, many were detained and taken away," she said.

"While security personnel tried to catch them, about half to three-quarters ran onto the road and started protesting. We were more than 200. Many were detained right at the start, then the number started thinning," she said.

The photo that went viral, she said, was taken near Akashvani Bhavan. "After stepping out of A K G Bhavan, we were walking toward Jantar Mantar. The photo of me running was taken near Akashvani Bhavan ... we were detained from there."

Within that stretch alone, the protesters had to cross three to four barricades, she said. "At each barricade, the police were detaining people — grabbing whoever they could."

Police personnel had formed a human chain and surrounded them completely, Pavithra said, adding that they were subsequently forced into a bus. Some protesters were also beaten, she added.

There were nearly 25 people in the bus, she said. "I don't know where they were taking us ... as it got stuck in a traffic jam, me and around 10 others jumped out," she said.

On Sunday, she stepped out to take part in the protest again, only to be detained again. This time, however, she was not able to jump out of the bus.

Mehina Fatima, Joint Secretary, SFI Delhi, said: "We were there for the rally and we were brutally dragged. Me and another woman got slapped."

Fatima said the women protesters "were surrounded by male police officers", adding that the bus thay they were forced into did not have its lights on. Pavithra and others kept recording, Fatima said.

"After we crossed CP, some men, probably right wing goons, threw stones at the bus. The glass broke and dust went inside the eyes of some protesters eyes," said Fatima.

The detainees she said, were taken to Mandir Marg police station and to Kapashera Border. They were later released around 9 pm, she said.

Some who had sustained injuries are currently under treatment, Fatima said.

CJP PROTEST IN CAPITAL

'Unacceptable': India again rejects UN rights office concerns on mass detentions

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 11

A DAY after the UN Human Rights Office expressed concern over the mass detention of students, activists, civil society members, lawyers and journalists in Delhi during protests organised by the Cockroach Janta Party, India on Sunday said the "concerns are unwarranted and constitute an unacceptable interference in the internal affairs of the country".

This is the second time in the last 12 hours that India has responded to the remarks made by the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights on Saturday. Earlier, India's permanent mission in Geneva had called the concerns "misplaced, causing an unwarranted interference in the internal affairs".

This time, Ministry of External Affairs' official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: "We have seen certain remarks by the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) about yesterday's events in New Delhi. India is the world's largest democracy, where the right to peaceful assembly is guaranteed by our Constitution and safeguarded by robust institutions, an independent judiciary and a free media."

"As in every democracy, Indian citizens exercise this right subject to the maintenance of public order and safety. Our law enforcement authorities act strictly in accordance with the law, and our courts remain available to all for the redressal of any grievances," he said, defending the action by the police in Delhi and NCR.

The MEA spokesperson said, "The OHCHR's concerns are therefore unwarranted and constitute an unacceptable interference in the internal affairs of India."

"We also note that the OHCHR has an approach of extreme selectivity when it comes to public positions. Violent responses to protests in our neighbourhood have gone uncommented, as indeed have law enforcement actions in its own vicinity. Such double standards only erode the credibility of its standing and contribute to the loss of faith in multilateralism," the MEA spokesperson said, referring to police and law enforcement agency actions in Pakistan and France.

The UN Human Rights spokesperson Thameen Al-Kheetan called on Indian authorities to respect and fulfil the right to peaceful assembly, noting that restrictions must meet strict tests of necessity and proportionality.

"We are concerned by reports of mass detentions in India of demonstrators, protest leaders, members of civil society organisations, lawyers and journalists, before and during today's large-scale demonstrations in Delhi," he said in a statement on Saturday evening.

"We call on the authorities to ensure that the right to peaceful assembly is fully respected and fulfilled. Restrictions on peaceful protests must meet strict tests of necessity and proportionality," the UN office said.

"The Indian authorities should also ensure law enforcement forces exercise utmost restraint in response to peaceful protesters, consistent with the country's democratic traditions and human rights obligations. All those arbitrarily detained must be immediately and unconditionally released."

"We also urge the authorities to engage in meaningful dialogue to address the broadly held concerns expressed," it said.

Keralam to move House resolution to remove CEC

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 11



Chief Minister V D Satheesan

THE CONGRESS government in Keralam will present a resolution in the state Assembly on Monday, urging the Union government to remove Gyanesh Kumar as the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC).

With this, Keralam Assembly will become the first in the country to bring a resolution seeking the removal of the CEC.

As per the bulletin of the Legislative Assembly, the resolution will be moved by Chief Minister V D Satheesan.

In September last year, the state Assembly had passed a resolution, moved by the then Left Democratic Front (LDF) regime, against rolling out the SIR. The second session of the 16th Legislative Assembly will begin on Monday.

Apart from seeking removal of the CEC, the resolution to be presented in the Assembly would demand that voting rights of all eligible voters, who have been removed from the electoral rolls, be reinstated after rectifying the anomalies in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process.

The third demand would be the reconstitution of the committee for selecting Election Commissioners by including the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, and the Chief Justice of the Supreme Court in it.

In the 140-strong assembly, Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) has 102 members while the CPI(M)-led LDF has 35 MLAs. The BJP has three legislators.

With the Congress and the CPI(M) being part of the national campaign and the ongoing protest seeking removal of the CEC, the resolution is expected to be passed in the Assembly.

In the past, there have been several instances in which the Keralam Assembly had passed resolutions unanimously, with the backing of the CPI (M) and the Congress.

The resolution said as serious doubts are being raised over the Commission's impartiality, it is inevitable to take steps to remove the CEC to restore the credibility of the Commission. "Robbing off the voting rights of minorities, migrants, marginalised sections and the young through technical manipulation and irregularities is a violation of democratic principles," it added.

Although the resolution said lakhs of eligible voters have been removed under the "guise" of SIR, it had not made any specific reference to Keralam, where the last Assembly elections were held after the process.

Neither the Congress nor the CPI(M) had raised allegations about removal of eligible voters from the electoral rolls in the state during the SIR process.

Last September, the then CPI (M) government moved a resolution that was passed unanimously in the state Legislative Assembly, urging the Election Commission to drop its decision to roll out SIR across the country.

The resolution was moved by then CM Pinarayi Vijayan under rule 118 of the Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Assembly. That made the Keralam Assembly the first in the country to bring a resolution against SIR.

The resolution said the Election Commission's move had raised serious concern that the SIR was aimed at implementing the National Register of Citizens (NRC) in an indirect way.

40,000 paramilitary personnel proof that Delhi protest was successful, says Kishor

Santosh Singh
Patna, October 11



Police personnel in New Delhi on Sunday. GAJENDRA YADAV

DEPLOYMENT OF 40,000 paramilitary forces in Delhi was a good enough proof that the protest in the national capital on Saturday was successful, Jan Suraaj Party (JSP) founder and Bankipur MLA Prashant Kishor said as he joined the Opposition in demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar.

He said the credibility of the Election Commission of India (EC) had eroded in the last 8-10 years. Reacting to media questions on the protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Kumar, Kishor said: "Many people are looking at how many people attended the protest, but the fact that the government had to deploy 40,000 paramilitary forces to stop it shows how powerful it was."

He said the protests against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) was a reflection of people's diminishing faith in the ECI. "In last eight to 10 years, there have been serious questions on the credibility of the ECI. CEC Kumar should resign," Kishor said. He pointed out how ECI had not stopped the Bihar government from distributing Rs 10,000 each to Jeevika workers during the 2025 Assembly elections.

The JSP founder also targeted an NDA meeting held in Bihar on Saturday, viewing it as a sign of "growing vulnerability" of the ruling alliance. "Just as their panic was visible from the meeting of 480 leaders in Bankipur (ahead of the bypoll in August), there is a similar panic regarding the MLC elections. Whether the NDA calls a meeting of the legislature or the legislative council, the educated teacher and graduate voters of Bihar have made up their mind to defeat the ruling alliance's candidates," said Kishor.

FORM NO. CAA. 2

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, CHENNAI BENCH I,
IN THE MATTER OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013
AND
IN THE MATTER OF SECTIONS 230 AND 232 AND OTHER APPLICABLE PROVISIONS OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 READ WITH COMPANIES (COMPROMISES, ARRANGEMENTS AND AMALGAMATIONS) RULES, 2016
AND
IN THE MATTER OF SCHEME OF AMALGAMATION BETWEEN KOTHARI SUGARS AND CHEMICALS LIMITED AND KOTHARI PETROCHEMICALS LIMITED AND THEIR RESPECTIVE SHAREHOLDERS AND CREDITORS

CA (CAA) NO. 72/CHE/2026

KOTHARI SUGARS AND CHEMICALS LIMITED (CIN: L15421TN1960PLC004310)
...APPLICANT COMPANY NO. 1 / TRANSFEROR COMPANY

KOTHARI PETROCHEMICALS LIMITED (CIN: L11101TN1989PLC017347)
... APPLICANT COMPANY NO. 2 / TRANSFEREE COMPANY

Applicant Companies having registered office at
Kothari Building No.115, Nungambakkam High Road, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India, 600034.

JOINT NOTICE AND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE MEETINGS OF EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS AND UNSECURED CREDITORS OF APPLICANT COMPANIES

Notice is hereby given that, in the captioned matters, by an order dated September 30, 2026, the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Division Bench (Court I) Chennai ("Tribunal"), has inter alia directed that meetings of the equity shareholders and unsecured creditors of Kothari Sugars and Chemicals Limited (Transferor Company) and Kothari Petrochemicals Limited (Transferee Company) to be convened and held for the purpose of considering, and, if thought fit, approving, with or without modification, Scheme of Amalgamation between Kothari Sugars and Chemicals Limited and Kothari Petrochemicals Limited and their respective Shareholders and Creditors ("Scheme"), under Sections 230-232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013.

In pursuance of the said order and as directed therein, further notice is hereby given that separate meetings of the equity shareholders and unsecured creditors of the Applicant Companies will be held through Video Conferencing or Other Audio-Visual Means ("VC/OAVM") on **Friday, 13th November, 2026** at the respective times as mentioned hereunder and the said equity shareholders and unsecured creditors are requested to attend.

Class of Meeting	Day & Date	Time (IST)
Equity shareholders of Applicant Company No.1	Friday, 13.11.2026	10:30 A.M
Unsecured creditors of Applicant Company No.1	Friday, 13.11.2026	11.30 A.M
Equity shareholders of Applicant Company No.2	Friday, 13.11.2026	02.30 P.M
Unsecured creditors of Applicant Company No.2	Friday, 13.11.2026	04.30 P.M

The notice, explanatory statement along with all annexures of the respective meetings have been sent by email to those who have registered their email IDs and a letter containing weblink & QR Code to access the notices, explanatory statement and annexures have been sent by speed post to those who have not registered their email IDs.

The notices of the meetings are available on the websites of the Applicant Company No.1 at https://hckotharigroup.com/kscl/?q=node/133 and Applicant Company No.2 at https://www.kotharipetrochemicals.com/investors/scheme-of-amalgamation/ and National Stock Exchange Limited at www.nseindia.com and www.evotingindia.com. The copy of notice of the meetings and Scheme can be obtained free of charge from the respective registered office of Applicant Companies between 10:00 A.M. and 4:00 P.M. (IST). Alternatively, a request for obtaining an electronic/soft copy of the Notice and Scheme may be made by sending an e-mail to secdept@hckgroup.com

The business at the respective meetings shall be transacted through voting by electronic means. Equity shareholders as on the cut-off date, **6th Nov 2026**, and unsecured creditors as on the cut-off date, **31st July 2026**, shall be entitled to attend and vote at their respective meetings. Persons acquiring shares and becoming members after dispatch of the Notice, who are members as on 6th Nov 2026, may obtain login credentials by emailing investor@cameoindia.com, secdept@hckgroup.com or helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com, quoting their DP ID/Client ID.

For aforesaid four meetings, **remote e-voting commences on Tuesday, 10th November 2026 at 9.00 a.m. and ends on Thursday, 12th November 2026 at 5.00 p.m.** and shall not be permitted thereafter.

Eligible shareholders and unsecured creditors attending their respective meetings through VC/OAVM who have not voted remotely may vote electronically during the meetings. Those who have voted remotely may attend but shall not vote again. Detailed participation and voting instructions are in the respective notices.

The Hon'ble Tribunal has appointed **Shri. Badarinath** as the Chairperson and **Mr. Biswaruo Acharya,** as the Scrutinizer for the said meetings. The above-mentioned Scheme of Amalgamation, if approved by the meeting, will be subject to the subsequent approval of the tribunal.

Any query/grievance in relation to e-voting can be addressed to Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, AVP, (CDSL), A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mill Compounds, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or call toll free no. 1800 21 09911.

Sd/-
Shri. Badarinath
Chairperson appointed by the Hon'ble NCLT for the Meetings

Date : 10.10.2026
Place : Chennai



PUBLIC TRAFFIC ADVISORY

Bloomberg New Economy Forum (BNEF), New Delhi

13th October 2026, FROM 0700 TO 1300 HRS

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

VENUE: Hotel Taj Palace, Sardar Patel Marg

DIVERSIONS: 09 Points

SUMMIT DATES: 13 – 15 October, 2026

ROADS REGULATED: 13+ roads





01 AFFECTED ROADS

• Sardar Patel Marg • Mother Teresa Crescent • Africa Avenue Road (From Ring Road to R/A Yashwant Place) • Satya Marg • Niti Marg (From Satya Marg to Pancsheel Marg) • Panchsheel Marg (From Sardar Patel Marg to R/A Shanti Path) • Brigadier Hoshiar Singh Marg • Vinay Marg (R/A Yashwant Place to Panchsheel Marg) • Shanti Path (From Ring Road to Pancsheel Marg) • Nyay Marg (From Satya Marg to Pancsheel Marg) • Chandara Gupta Marg • San Martin Marg • Manas Marg • Army Battle Honours Mess Road • Abai Marg

02 ALL DIVERSION POINTS (01–09)

S.No.	DIVERSION POINT	NOT ALLOWED	DIVERTED VIA / ROUTE
01	Dhuala Kuan Flyover (DKFO)	Sardar Patel Marg	For East/South Delhi-Ring Road (MGM) For New Delhi/CP/Central/North/West Delhi - Vande Matram
02	Vande Matram Marg – Simon Bolivar Marg Crossing	Simon Bolivar Marg	For East/South Delhi - Vande Matram Marg - DKFO - Ring Road (MGM) For New Delhi/CP - Vande Matram Marg - Turn Right Shankar Road For Central/North - Vande Matram Marg Towards Jhandewala For West Delhi (i) - Vande Matram Marg - Turn Left Shankar Road (ii)- Vande Matram Marg Towards DKFO Turn Right Ring Road (MGM)
03	R/A Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital (RML)	Mother Teresa Crescent	For New Delhi/Central/North/East - Baba Kharak Singh Marg For South Delhi - Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Marg - Shankar Road - Vande Matram Marg For West - Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Marg - Shankar Road
04	Sardar Patel Marg – Mother Teresa Crescent Crossing	Sardar Patel Marg	For South Delhi - Mother Teresa Crescent - R/A Teen Murti - Teen Murti Marg - Safdarjung Road For East - Mother Teresa Crescent - R/A Teen Murti - Teen Murti Marg - Akbar Road For West/Central/North - Mother Teresa Crescent - R/A RML
05	R/A Teen Murti	Towards Mother Teresa Crescent	For West/Central/North Delhi - Teen Murti Marg - Akbar Road - Janpath
06	R/A Panchsheel Marg – Shanti Path	Towards Panchsheel Marg	For West/East/South Delhi - Panchsheel Marg - Mushtafa Kemal Attaturk Marg - APJ Abdul Kalam Road - Tuglaq Road or Aurobindo Marg For Central/North Delhi - Panchsheel Marg - Mushtafa Kemal Attaturk Marg - APJ Abdul Kalam Road - Tuglaq Road
07	Ring Road - Africa Avenue Crossing	Towards Africa Avenue	For Central/West/North Delhi - Ring Road Towards Dhaula Kuan For New Delhi/East Delhi - Ring Road towards AIIMS
08	Ring Road - Moti Bagh Crossing	Shanti Path	For Central/West/North Delhi - Ring Road Towards Dhaula Kuan For New Delhi/East Delhi - Ring Road towards AIIMS
09	Ring Road – San Martin Marg Crossing	San Martin Marg	For Central/West/North Delhi - Ring Road Towards Dhaula Kuan For New Delhi/East Delhi - Ring Road towards AIIMS

03 ALTERNATE ROUTES — RAILWAY STATIONS & AIRPORT

NEW DELHI/OLD DELHI RAILWAY STATIONS
Route A: Dhaula Kuan Flyover - Vande Matram Marg
Route B: AIIMS Flyover - Aurobindo Marg Towards Aurobindo Chowk

FROM NEW DELHI/CENTRAL/NORTH DELHI
Route - A - T3: Ring Road - AIIMS Chowk - Moti Bagh Chowk - RTR Marg - under Shankar Vihar Flyover - Sanjay T-Point - Service Road - NH-48 - under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri - T-3 Road
Route - B - Vande Matram Marg - Dhaula Kuan Flyover - Gurugram Road NH-48 - under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri - T-3 Road

04 TRANSPORT SERVICES

BUS — Route diversions possible during VVIP movements.

METRO — Fully operational at all stations — no disruption.

TAXI/AUTO — No roadside parking except designated areas; diversions possible.

05 IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS & PUBLIC ADVISORY

PRIORITY CORRIDORS & EXEMPTIONS
- Emergency & Medical Vehicles: Priority, obstruction-free passage maintained 24/7 across Delhi.
- Essential Services & Utilities: Uninterrupted access granted for essential supplies and utility operations in all zones.

TRAFFIC RULES & PARKING
- Designated Parking: Park only in authorized areas and avoid roadside parking.
- Road Discipline: Follow the instructions of deployed traffic personnel and obey all traffic rules patiently.

TRAVEL PLANNING & PUBLIC MOBILITY
- Transit Hubs: Allow extra travel time when heading to Airports, Railway Stations, and ISBTs.
- Public Transport & Routes: Opt for public transport and follow designated alternative routes and diversion points.
- Commercial Traffic: Non-destined commercial vehicles are prohibited from entering Delhi.

PUBLIC SAFETY & UPDATES
- Security Vigilance: Report any unidentified objects or suspicious activity to the nearest police officer immediately.
- Real-Time Information: Stay updated via official Delhi Police social media channels and traffic portals.
- Public cooperation is solicited to ensure smooth transit and safety for all.

PLAN AHEAD. TRAVEL SMART.

For the complete point-wise diversion list and live updates during the Bloomberg Summit 2026 advisory window, follow Delhi Traffic Police online.

ISSUED BY DELHI TRAFFIC POLICE · PUBLIC ADVISORY — SHARE WIDELY

DP/9919/2026

General public and motorists may remain updated through Delhi Traffic Police Website https://traffic.delhipolice.gov.in, Facebook page https://www.facebook.com/dtptraffic, X handle https://X@dtptraffic, Instagram page https://www.instagram.com/dtptraffic

BE A TRAFFIC PRAHARI DOWNLOAD APP FROM Google play or App Store 24 HRS. TRAFFIC HELPLINE: 011-25844444/1095 TRAFFIC WHATSAPP HELPLINE 8750871493 TO SHARE ANTI TERRORIST ACTIVITIES, CALL 14547 FOR IMMEDIATE POLICE HELP CALL 112

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



'Gen Z' Chaupal

BJP MP Manoj Tiwari is all set to relaunch his outreach programme — Tiwari Ki Chaupal — with a new target audience. The former Delhi BJP chief has decided to dedicate the latest round of 'Chaupal' discussions to the youths and Gen Z representatives. He will hold the 'Chaupal' on a regular basis across his Parliamentary constituency of North East Delhi, sources said. A staple during his tenure as Delhi BJP chief between 2016 and 2020, 'Tiwari Ki Chaupal' saw discussions on various issues among participants seated on string cots, similar to the corner meetings in rural India. Earlier too, Tiwari had launched several youth-centric programmes such as the Yamuna Challenge Trophy, which allowed aspiring and talented young cricketers from the Capital to join sponsored training programmes.

No Shortcuts

AMID HEAVY security arrangements and restrictions in place across central Delhi ahead of the CJP protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar on October 10, some CPI(M) leaders decided to spend Friday night at Kerala House, which is just a stone's throw from Jantar Mantar. Senior CPI(M) leader Brinda Karat also stayed back at Kerala House, despite having a residence in Delhi, to ensure easy access to the protest site the next morning. However, the plan didn't work out as Delhi police personnel detained the CPI(M) leaders from Kerala House itself.



Aaditya and Amit Thackeray in front of Shivaji Park Police Station in Mumbai on Sunday. AKASH PATIL

300 detained, Aaditya says Mumbai stir will intensify

ENS & PTI
Mumbai, October 11

THE PROTEST at Mumbai's Shivaji Park area in support of CJP's stir against CEC Gyanesh Kumar intensified on Sunday evening after Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray and MNS's Amit Thackeray arrived with hundreds of supporters, triggering sporadic sit-ins and sloganeering.

Mumbai Police registered an FIR and detained 300 protesters, including activist Anjali Damania, who gathered at Shivaji Park. The Thackeray cousins slammed the BJP governments at the Centre and Maharashtra and sought the release of those detained.

Aaditya, joined by brother Tejas Thackeray, claimed police had attacked and manhandled Shiv Sainiks, including women, outside Sena Bhavan nearby. "We have appreciated Mumbai Police several times in the past (for the way they handled protests). However, they are acting like the Delhi Police now. If they behave like this, there will be protests everywhere. Maharashtra is not going to stop, and this is because of the local police," he said. "I am giving a call to the entire Mumbai to come to Shivaji Park. This protest will not subside now. If you touch protesters, then the agitation will intensify till Gyanesh Kumar resigns," said Aaditya, who climbed atop a police vehicle with detained protesters inside.

Amit Thackeray questioned the reason behind the police detaining the protesters. "From tomorrow our MNS activists will be there (to protest)," he said.

The leaders and workers of Shiv Sena (UBT) and MNS demonstrated outside Shivaji Park police station, where most of the detainees had been taken.

Several students were detained at the entrance of Shivaji Park, with some of them being sent to Worli camp, Tardeo and Worli police station. "We had just come to visit the park, but the police detained us," a person who was detained told *The Indian Express*.

All detained protesters were released later.

EXPRESS special

Yogi-Akhilesh banter puts Ayodhya contest back in focus

The BJP has held the seat for most of the past three decades, but fluctuating electoral fortunes, SP's caste arithmetic and civic concerns pose a challenge

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, October 11

TWO YEARS after the BJP lost the Faizabad Lok Sabha seat to the Samajwadi Party (SP), Ayodhya is back at the centre of UP politics, with Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav challenging each other to contest the 2027 Assembly elections from the temple town.

The Ram temple is located in the Ayodhya Assembly constituency, one of the five segments of the Faizabad Lok Sabha seat. While the BJP has largely held the Assembly seat over the past three decades, its vote share and winning margins have fluctuated. The SP's 2024 victory in Faizabad has raised questions about the ruling party's electoral prospects.

Earlier this week, attending a Bhagwat Katha recitation in Ayodhya, Yadav challenged Adityanath to contest from the constituency.

On Saturday, Adityanath responded by saying, *"Chalo ek baar kismat aajma lete hain. Tay ho jaaye. Aap bhi aaiyen, main bhi aata hun* (Let us test our fortunes. Let it be decided. You come, and I will come too)", he said. Adityanath, however, said Ayodhya was a place of faith for him and not contesting elections.

The CM is currently the MLA from Gorakhpur Urban. Yadav was elected from Karhal in 2022 but vacated the seat after winning in Kannauj in 2024.

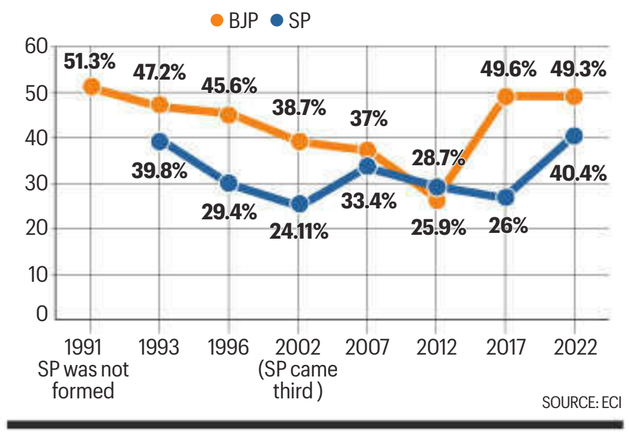
Taking another swipe at Yadav, Adityanath said the contest should be face-to-face rather than through political followers. BJP sources said the remark was aimed at former Ayodhya MLA Pawan Pandey.

Pandey, also known as Tej Narain Pandey, is the first SP candidate Yadav has announced for the 2027 Assembly elections. At an event in Lucknow on August 5, the SP chief said Pandey would contest from Ayodhya. A Brahmin leader, Pandey has accused the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust of irregularities in land purchases and has attacked the BJP over alleged discrepancies in temple donations.

On Sunday, Yadav said that his declared candidate, Pawan Pandey, was enough to "blow the arrogance" of the BJP government. Speaking to reporters after garlanding the statue of Jayaprakash Narayan at the Jayaprakash Narayan International Centre in Lucknow, Yadav took a dig at the CM, saying that someone who "was unsure of getting a party ticket" to contest the Assembly elections was challenging him. "The arrogant people will be blown away by the wind of our 'Pawan'. Whose ticket was finalised first? It was Pawan Pandey from Ayodhya...," he said.

"Tell me, does a chief minister distribute (election) tickets? Even he (Adityanath) has to get in line to get a ticket... One who is unsure whether he will get a ticket is speaking about getting a ticket for others. Get your own ticket confirmed, then challenge me," the SP president added.

• PERFORMANCE OF BJP AND SP IN AYODHYA OVER THE LAST EIGHT ASSEMBLY POLLS



SOURCE: ECI

BJP's fortunes

An analysis of the past eight Assembly elections shows that Ayodhya remained a BJP stronghold until 2012, when Pandey defeated the party's veteran leader Lallu Singh.

The BJP recorded its highest vote share in the constituency in 1991, when the Ram Janmabhoomi movement was at its peak. Singh garnered 51.3% of the vote and won by a margin of 30,400 votes.

He retained the seat in 1993, months after the demolition of the Babri mosque, but the BJP's vote share fell to 47.24% and its winning margin to 9,238 votes. Singh continued to win the seat, but the BJP's vote share declined to 45.61% in 1996, 38.72% in 2002 and around 37% in 2007.

In 2012, amid anti-incumbency against the Mayawati-led BSP government, the SP fielded Pandey, who defeated Singh by 5,404 votes. Pandey secured 28.74% of the vote, while the BJP's share fell to around 26%.

The BJP returned to power in the constituency in 2017, when Ved Prakash Gupta polled 49.56% of the vote and defeated Pandey by 50,440 votes. Gupta retained the seat in 2022, with the BJP's vote share slipping to around 49%. Its winning margin, however, fell to 19,990 votes, while Pandey's vote share rose to 40.4%.

The BJP's defeat in Faizabad in 2024 came despite the consecration of the Ram temple and the launch of major infrastructure projects in Ayodhya. The SP's Awadhesh Prasad, a Dalit leader, defeated Lallu Singh in the Lok Sabha constituency.





Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and SP chief Akhilesh Yadav

Caste calculus

Caste equations are expected to be crucial in Ayodhya. Dalits form a substantial section of the electorate, followed by Brahmins, while Muslims and Yadavs are significant communities traditionally associated with the SP's support base. The BJP draws support from sections of the upper castes and OBC communities such as Kurmis, Nishads, Mauryas and Rajbhars.

"The current social equations make the election a challenging task for our party in the prestigious Ayodhya seat. Yadavs and Muslims are traditional SP voters. Also, the SP has fielded a local Brahmin candidate who will cut into our Brahmin and other upper-caste votes. Dalit voters will play a key role here," a BJP leader said.

Despite losing the Faizabad Lok Sabha seat, the BJP led in the Ayodhya Assembly segment by 4,667 votes. The SP led in the other four segments — Dariyabad, Rudauli, Milkipur and Bikapur. The Lok Sabha setback also brought renewed attention to civic issues in Ayodhya, including pending drainage and roadwork.



New UP Congress chief Aradhana Misra

Clashes break out at new UP Cong chief's welcome event

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, October 11

THE EVENT to mark Aradhana Misra formally taking charge of the UP unit of the Congress was marred by a clash between supporters of the outgoing state president Ajay Rai and a group of party workers at the Congress headquarters in Lucknow on Sunday.

Shoes were allegedly hurled, and abuses were exchanged on the premises of the party headquarters in the presence of senior party leaders.

The incident took place before Misra and newly appointed working president Imran Masood formally took charge. Party leaders said Misra was not present in the office when the clash broke out.

According to a senior Congress leader, who was present at the party office when the incident took place, the trouble began when Rai arrived with his supporters.

Supporters of Congress corporator Mamta Chaudhary, who is also the president of the Central Zone Mahila Congress, and other party leaders were already present on the office premises. As Rai and his supporters arrived, the office corridors got overcrowded, leading to jostling among the people there.

"The situation soon escalated as people started abusing and hurling shoes, leading to a scuffle," a party leader said.

Misra and other senior leaders later intervened to pacify the workers, following which the charge-taking ceremony was concluded.

Videos of the altercation surfaced on social media.

HC: Detention may not have been authorised, release 7 Goa protesters

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, October 11

HOURS AFTER seven protesters were detained at Azad Maidan in Panaji, the High Court of Bombay at Goa on Sunday night directed police to release them, noting that their "detention may not have been authorised".

The protest was organised by a Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) affiliate in Goa to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

In an order, a division bench of Justices Amit S Jamsandekar and Valmiki Menezes said, "Considering that there are no prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS, we are of the opinion that the detention may not have been authorised. We are also informed that the Executive Magistrate Dattaprasad Toraskar, who was present at the site, had given oral instructions to the police to detain the seven persons since they had barged into Azad Maidan, Panaji."

The court said, "For the moment, without entering into controversy and the correctness of the detention order, considering that... learned Senior Advocate appearing on behalf of the detainees, gives an undertaking that the detainees would not protest at Azad Maidan, Panaji tonight, we direct the PI [police inspector] Panaji Police Station to release the 7 persons named..."

Earlier, a habeas corpus petition was filed in the HC by Advocates Malisa Zemira Simoes and Rui Gomes Pereira, seeking the release of the seven detainees.

The petitioners said that the seven persons were taken to Pernem police station, and that no orders were issued by the state government under SSection 163 of BNSS, which prohibits any gathering at Azad Maidan or any part of the location.

BJP questions Rahul's 'silence' on MP's dismissal from JNU

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 11

THE BJP on Sunday questioned Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi's "silence" on the dismissal of Congress MP Bimol Akoijam from JNU over alleged sexual harassment of 11 students. The party also attacked the Congress MP over his claim that Prime Minister Narendra Modi had launched a "full-scale attack" on Tamil language and culture.

Addressing a press conference, BJP MP Bansuri Swaraj accused Rahul Gandhi and the Congress's top leadership of adopting double standards on the issue of respect for women.

Demanding Akoijam's suspension from the Congress, Swaraj asked the LoP and the Congress whether "smash the patriarchy" was "merely political rhetoric and a political slogan for them".

"For the Congress, feminism begins with a hashtag and ends at the threshold of accountability. What is surprising is that these allegations surfaced in May, yet until now, the Congress Party's top leadership, particularly Rahul Gandhi, has maintained silence. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Priyanka Gandhi and Sonia Gandhi have also not said anything on the matter," she said.

"...it appears that, somewhere, it (Congress) is accepting the conduct of its MP accused of sexual harassment and shielding him," the New Delhi MP said, asking why the Congress has not initiated any inquiry in the matter or issued a show-cause notice to the MP.

"Rahul Gandhi should clarify whether the 'chhatron Ki goonj' of these 11 female students has reached him, or whether he has reduced their concerns to an excuse for frivolous comedy," she said.

Attacking Gandhi over his allegation that the Tamil language was under "assault due to the introduction of NEET", during the Chatron ki Goonj event in Tamil Nadu, Rajya Sabha MP and BJP national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said: "The reality is that the Tamil language has been accorded immense respect during PM Modi's tenure; efforts have been made to elevate its various dimensions to the international stage."

Trivedi said projects worth Rs 13,000 crore have been undertaken in Chennai, including Rs 4,900 crore for the Chennai Metro, Rs 3,700 crore for National Highways, Rs 7,750 crore for the Karaikal-Peralam line, and upgrades to cargo and cruise facilities at three ports, including Chennai's VOC and Kamarajar ports.

He said 41 Sagarmala projects identified in Tamil Nadu, three ports receiving new projects today, and an annual cargo target of 300 million tonnes set for the Chennai-Kamarajar-Cuddalore mega-port cluster by 2047 underlined PM Modi's developmental agenda and respect for the state.

The BJP MP also claimed that Gandhi made baseless allegations against the Prime Minister. The Congress leader is trying to create a divide between the North and South on the lines of language, he said.

• THE VALLEY'S BEAUTY IS OVERWHELMING; SO IS THE QUIET HOPE THAT ITS PEOPLE MAY FINALLY LIVE WITHOUT FEAR

The train to Kashmir is running, the journey to normalcy continues



NORTHERN LIGHTS

BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON THE POLITICS AND IDEAS SHAPING NORTH INDIA

"It was so beautiful, the water so clear, the sky so bright and the mountains so silvery... It's definitely going to be my core memory."

This is a lanky 14-year-old from Chandigarh raving about his short trip to Pahalgam. Just a weekend that bowled over this young globetrotter. His mother was more measured. "It was very scenic, but there was something eerie about the place." Both knew about the April 2025 Pahalgam massacre. The boy's view was unburdened by history. Hers was not.

In 2004, when the BJP was riding its India Shining campaign and Atal Bihari Vajpayee was a big hit among Kashmiris, Srinagar felt like a city under siege. *The Indian Express* had travelled to the Valley in the run-up to the parliamentary polls. Muscular bulletproof vans and armed CRPF men dominated its streets. As the Sun dipped, you kept your van lights on so the soldiers could see you.

Yet, inside homes, over steaming cups of *kahwa*, some young people spoke of a different future, of a rail link to Jammu, of sending children to the "mainland" for education. A young doctor at the crowded Lal Ded maternity hospital — women in Jammu-Kashmir enjoy 50% quota in MBBS seats — wistfully spoke of peace. A carpet dealer confided, "I want to see my son play national cricket. It's not possible here."

However, not everyone welcomed such talk. A few years later, on a train to Udhampur from Ambala, a Kashmiri teacher reading a Jeffrey Archer novel looked up and said the railway would "violate the purity of the Valley". It was another assault on its culture.

Those days, a fair number of students from Punjab's border districts, especially Amritsar and Gurdaspur, came to the Valley for their Bachelor of Education (B.Ed.) degree. For many of them, a teaching job as a "master" meant a steady income and the chance to continue farming. That job was worth the risks posed by insurgency. And they came back safe.

In the Valley, the grief over lives lost, the Army's cordon-and-search operations, and the deep us-versus-them feelings were never far. In an Anantnag village, schoolgirls told me they wanted to join the police because they were tired of being "schooled" by militants who would descend on their village at will. At another village, a young man, eyes burning with tears, asked: "What about our 'shaheed' (martyrs)? What did they die for?"

A different Kashmir

Much water has flowed down the Jhelum since then. The abrogation of Article 370 still rankles. But the everyday texture of life has shifted. The Vande Bharat from Jammu to Srinagar, inaugurated this May, has turned what was once a long, uncertain journey into less than five hours of travel. The rail project itself — an old dream conceived in the late 19th century under Dogra ruler Maharaja Pratap Singh — finally materialised after nearly three decades of construction through some of the world's most difficult terrain. It boasts 36 tunnels, 943 bridges, including the Chenab Bridge that is the highest railway arch bridge in the world, and the Anji Khad bridge, India's first cable-supported railway bridge soaring 331 meters above the Anji River.



Despite development, deeper tensions remain in the Valley. FILE

Tourist arrivals, which had climbed to nearly 98 lakh in the Kashmir division and 2.36 crore across J&K in 2024, collapsed after the Pahalgam attack. They are climbing again. The Jammu-Srinagar train regularly runs at near-full occupancy. Srinagar, once deserted after dark, now has more than 200 cafés, up from a handful less than a decade ago. A multiplex opened in 2022, ending an over two-decade absence of cinema.

The deeper tensions remain. The heated debate over full statehood and the restoration of Article 370 continues. The Lieutenant Governor still holds significant authority over the bureaucracy and police under the Union Territory framework.

AFSPA remains in force and security is less intrusive but still omnipresent. There are reports of land frauds, delimitation rows, fuzzy electoral rolls, and the harrowing problem of drugs. It brings to mind the touristy Vietnamese T-shirts with the slogan, "Same, same but different".

Roger Mac Ginty, the peace and conflict scholar who developed the idea of "everyday peace", has written about how ordinary routines and small joys can quietly blunt the sharp edges of conflict. In Kashmir, history hasn't disappeared, but ordinary life has begun to compete with it.

A dermatologist from the Valley who works in Chandigarh, however, cautioned, "Nothing in the Valley is as it seems. There is a lot of politics."

My own core memory of the Valley is quite mundane: a well-lit largish cyber cafe (as they were called then) up a flight of solid wooden stairs near Lal Chowk, where I had gone to key in news reports among men hunched over computers.

I was midway through the second story, my colleague downstairs for tea, when I noticed the silence. I looked up to find the café empty, computers still glowing, a wallet left where its owner had sat, and a stunning chinar tree framed against silver mountains in the distance. Later, I learnt that everyone had left for Friday prayers. There was nothing eerie about it. It was a simple pause, and the beauty of the Valley came rushing in.

(Manraj Grewal Sharma is National Editor, North, The Indian Express)

Punjab Police ASI shot dead by bike-borne assailants in Tarn Taran

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, October 11

THE 55-YEAR-OLD Assistant Sub-Inspector (ASI), Iqbal Singh, was shot dead by bike-borne assailants on his way back home from duty, near the Patwarkhana on the Naushehra-Lohka road on Sunday, police said. Iqbal Singh, a resident of Naushehra Pannuan, was serving in the Counter Intelligence wing at Ferozepur.

Police said, according to eyewitnesses, ambushers on a motorcycle surrounded him and fired at him. Having sustained multiple gunshot wounds to his chest and upper body, Iqbal Singh died on the spot, police said, adding that the armed assailants soon fled the scene.

Soon after, senior police officers from Tarn Taran reached the scene with police teams.

Patti Deputy Superintendent of Police Ravi Sher Singh said, "Police have sealed the crime scene, and evidence is being collected... At present, the exact motive behind the murder and the identities of the attackers have not been established. Police are reviewing footage from nearby CCTV cameras and conducting search operations..."

The body of ASI Iqbal Singh has been sent to the hospital for a post-mortem examination.

Police suspect the crime might be linked to his nephew's murder, which occurred a month ago, or could be another murder linked to Pakistan.

On September 11, the ASI's nephew, Ajmeet Singh, was shot similarly by bike-borne assailants. Police records reveal that Ajmeet faced half a dozen serious criminal charges, including an Rocket-Propelled Grenade attack at the Sarhali police station in Tarn Taran.

Power bank fire forces IndiGo flight to land in Hyderabad

Hyderabad: An IndiGo flight from Delhi to Chennai was diverted to Hyderabad's Rajiv Gandhi International Airport after a passenger's power bank caught fire mid-air.

The cabin crew extinguished the fire, and the aircraft landed safely. All passengers and crew members are safe. Authorities have launched an investigation into the incident.

"IndiGo flight 6E 6115... was diverted to Hyderabad after smoke was detected from a customer's personal electronic device. In line with established protocols, pilots diverted ... safely at Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, Hyderabad," an IndiGo spokesperson said. **ENS**

'My father will handle': Drunk student driving Mini Cooper kills 3 in Kochi

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 11

THREE FRIENDS who had stepped out for tea were killed when an speeding Mini Cooper, being driven by a 19-year-old student, ran over their scooter near the Kochi airport early on Sunday.

All the deceased, one man and two women, were 21-year-olds working as part-time salespersons at a showroom at Thrikkakara near Kochi.

The incident sparked much outrage, especially with the accused driver, allegedly under the influence of alcohol, purportedly heard telling eyewitnesses that "his father will handle the issue."

The accused, college student Suhail Sajeev, was booked for non-bailable offence of culpable homicide not amounting to murder (Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita's Section 105) and arrested.

Sajeev's mother runs a prominent design studio and brand in Kochi and Alappuzha. In a Facebook post, she had stated that she was presenting the Mini Cooper to her son as a birthday gift. The video has gone viral after Sunday's incident.

According to Kochi airport police, the deceased were identified as Iyas, a native of Sullia in Karnataka, Devika from Wayanad, and Gopika of Palakkad.

Police said the trio was returning after a tea break with Iyas riding the scooter and the two women as pillion passengers. The girls were students of a college in Thrikkakara, but they all worked in a shop.



The Mini Cooper was a birthday gift to Suhail Sajeev. (SUHAIL__SAJEEV/ INSTAGRAM)

Police said they were thrown off the scooter after the car hit it from behind.

"We have confirmed that the driver was under the influence of alcohol when he was behind the wheels. Probe is on to ascertain whether he had used synthetic drug also," said Airport police station house officer B K Arun.

Police said Sajeev has a history of speeding, including an incident in which he was recorded driving at 218 kmph and trying to escape after brandishing his businessman father's "influence".

At the time of the accident on Sunday, he was allegedly driving the car at a speed of 125 km per hour.

Local rescuers told police that Sajeev asked them: "This is airport road, what is wrong with overspeeding?" He said, "My father will handle the case."

The first responders overpowered him and handed him over to the police, which later confirmed that Sajeev was under the influence of alcohol.

After paying tributes to the three deceased youths, Congress's Thrikkakara MLA Uma Thomas said stringent action should be taken against the accused. "I will ensure justice to the families of the deceased."

After the accused told police he had consumed alcohol from three liquor bars on Saturday night, state excise minister M Liju ordered probe against the establishments concerned since the minimum age for purchasing liquor is 23 in the state.

Sajeev had shared several reels on Instagram sharing his affinity for high-speed driving. In a number of these instances, he was allegedly speeding above 200 km per hour.

EXPRESS special

Sixth acquittal for Doda 'militant' as police case fails witness test again

Prosecution witnesses in latest case say they were 'tutored' by cops

Arun Sharma
Jammu, October 11

A 50-YEAR-OLD alleged by the Jammu and Kashmir Police to be a self-styled divisional commander of the Hizbul Mujahideen has been acquitted in a sixth case after, yet again, prosecution witnesses did not confirm police claims.

In the case in which the acquittal came last week, police had accused Ghulam Nabi alias Javed Qureshi, identified by them as a Hizbul militant, and "associate" Khursheed Ahmed of opening fire at a police search party in the forests of Marmat in Doda district in 2009, killing SPO Mohammad Ashraf. None of the prosecution witnesses supported the police version.

The witnesses whose testimony led to the acquittal of both Nabi and Khursheed included members of the police search party. A number of them told the trial court that the officers had "instructed" them what names to take, with one of them also saying that the rifle shown as seized from Nabi and Ahmed had been previously shown as seized in other FIRs.

Additional Sessions Judge, Doda, Archana Charak acquitted Nabi and Ahmed.

The testimony of the doctor who conducted the postmortem said Nabi had three bullet wounds, and was "shot from a distance of about 6 metres", adding: "It did not seem to be a case of cross-fire..."



Ghulam Nabi is facing trial in two other cases registered in 2010.

In its order, the trial court said defects or lapses in investigation by themselves do not necessarily entitle the accused to acquittal where substantive evidence establishes guilt. However, the judge said, in this case the prosecution evidence itself suffers from "material contradictions" and there is no "reliable corroboration". "... The benefit of doubt must necessarily go to the accused persons," Judge Charak said.

However, Ghulam Nabi continues to be in jail as he is facing trial in two cases filed in 2010 at Doda police station.

Nabi's wife Shama Begum said he was arrested from Dehradun for the first time 16 years ago, where he worked as a labourer. He was around 35 at the time, and it fell upon her after that to raise their three children, between the ages of 1 and 3. She works as a cook at a private hostel, earning Rs 8,000 a month.

Nabi was last home in 2025, when he was brought for an hour after his mother died.

Advocate Asim Hashmi, who was appointed amicus curiae in cases against Nabi, claimed that all six FIRs in which he stands acquitted are sordid examples of police probes.

The other five FIRs:

The first FIR was filed against Nabi on a complaint reportedly by one Mohammad Shareef on August 6, 1999, at Khellani police post, saying his nephew Shakeel Ahmed had been killed by "militants" Shakeel Ansari, Irshad Ahmed and Ghulam Nabi outside the house of Shakeel's father-in-law Mohammad Akram.

During the trial, all eyewitnesses "... stated that he (Nabi) is their relative and they used to go to his house", observed Judge Charak. The judge also noted that Shakeel's mother-in-law testified that the statement she gave was "tutored by police". Nabi was acquitted on November 25, 2025, in the case.

A second FIR was filed on May 8, 2009, after Haseena Begum, of Marmat's Salota village, filed a complaint at Goha police post saying her husband Sadiq Ali had been taken away by a "nafri (party)" from the Goha Army camp. She said the family was kept locked in their home, and after about an hour they heard gunshots.

Haseena said, they found it was Sadiq who had been shot.

Police booked Ghulam Nabi, and an alleged accomplice, Muzaffar Ahmed. The two demanded money from Sadiq. When he refused, the FIR said, they took him with them. Police also claimed that after killing Sadiq, the "militants" fled as some Army troops chanced upon them, leaving behind arms and ammunition.

Nabi was arrested in 2010 following an "encounter", in which Muzaffar Ahmed was killed. During the course of the trial, Sadiq's wife Haseena testified that police recorded her statement one-and-a-half years after the incident and she was told to repeat what she was "tutored". Another witness, Abdul Hameed Gurjar, said he saw Army personnel running away from where Sadiq's body lay.

Nabi was acquitted by Judge Charak on November 14, 2024, noting that all the witnesses had deposed that the deceased was killed by Army persons.

On September 8, 2010, Goha police post reportedly received information that "militants" Ghulam Nabi, Jameel Ahmed, Ajad Hussain and Khursheed Ahmed had killed their "accomplice" Firdous Ahmed over personal rivalry. Nabi was acquitted on May 22, 2025.

Another case was registered against Nabi in 2010, while he was already in police custody. Police claimed he had confessed to hiding an SLR at Nagnala near Dheratop, and said it had been given to him by militants Azad Hussain and Jamil Ahmed Kayfatullah. The weapon belonged to SPO Baldev Singh of Bulandpur post who was killed by them in 2007, police said.

During the inquiry, police said they found that Nabi joined the Hizbul in 1993 and many cases of murder were registered against him in Doda.

However, during the final arguments in court, Nazir Ahmed, who investigated the seizure of the SLR, admitted that the weapon had been seized by them in an earlier murder case.

"... no independent civilian witness has come forward... It is not safe to hold the accused guilty," the court held, acquitting Nabi on February 19, 2020.

On August 18, 2010, a party from Goha police post was carrying out searches in Kundan Dhaar forest area of Marmat when it said it came under attack, forcing them to flee leaving behind four empty cartridges of AK-47 rifles.

During investigations, Nabi, Ghulam Nabi Lone, Jameel Ahmed and Khursheed Ahmed were named as accused.

Until January 18, 2019, prosecution presented only four witnesses, all of them police personnel. Noting that the accused had been in judicial lock-up since October 2011, then Additional Sessions Judge, Doda, Madan Lal, said: "Speedy trial is the fundamental right of the accused."

It also noted that none of the witnesses had deposed that the accused were involved in the offence, merely testifying to the recovery of four empty cartridges of AK-47.

• BRIEFLY



Students protest on IIT Ranchi campus on Sunday, a day after a first-year student of the institute was found dead in his hostel room. PTI

JHARKHAND

IIIT Ranchi student found dead in hostel, protest erupts on campus

A FIRST-YEAR student of the Indian Institute of Information Technology was found hanging from the ceiling in his hostel room, police said on Sunday. The incident came to light on Saturday night when hostel inmates alerted the institute administration after finding the room locked from inside. The deceased has been identified as Aditya, a resident of Bihar's Purnia district, they said. "Preliminary investigation suggests the victim committed suicide under examination pressure... His body was sent for post-mortem examination at RIMS," Khelgaon Police Station in-charge Nirbhay Kumar said. Meanwhile, several students protested on the campus following the incident. PTI

Sixth POCSO case registered against Veeramani

A SIXTH case has been registered against granite businessman Gem Veeramani in connection with the ongoing investigation into the alleged sexual abuse of minor girls, police said on Sunday. The fresh case was registered on October 10 and taken up for investigation based on the statements of two minor girls, they said. Veeramani now has a total of six pending cases against him. Police action has been taken concerning sexual violence committed against 10 minor girls so far. Veeramani and his accomplices were initially arrested on August 29. PTI

Wild buffalo species return to MP after 100 yrs

EIGHT WILD buffaloes brought from Assam's Kaziranga National Park were released into a 17-hectare enclosure at Madhya Pradesh's Kanha Tiger Reserve on Sunday by CM Mohan Yadav as part of efforts to reintroduce the species in the state after nearly a century. The six females and two males were shifted from a one-hectare enclosure in the Supkhar range after completing their quarantine period, Yadav said. He added that the eight buffaloes were transported around 2,200 km from Kaziranga with assistance from Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma. PTI

MORADABAD

Three men 'tortured' at MLA's house; cops say probing charge

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, October 11

SHO said two of the injured youths were undergoing treatment at a hospital

MORADABAD POLICE are probing allegations that three men were held captive and brutally tortured at the house of BJP MLA Sushant Singh over the suspected theft of a gold bangle. Two of the alleged victims worked at the legislator's house, while the third was a friend of theirs.

Two of the three victims, Ramu Kashyap and his neighbour Atul Kashyap, sustained serious injuries and are undergoing treatment at a hospital, with Ramu's condition remaining critical. The third victim, Lavish Kashyap, was discharged after receiving first aid.

Ramu's mother Omwati Kashyap filed a complaint Friday at the Thakurdwara police station, accusing Sushant Singh and his associates of assaulting her son and the two other youths. No FIR has been registered till now.

Speaking to *The Indian Express,* Omwati Kashyap alleged that the three youths were hung upside down and brutally beaten while being questioned over the suspected theft. "They rubbed salt into their wounds and also administered electric shocks," she alleged.

Ramu Kashyap, a married daily-wage labourer with three children, was among the three victims. The other two, Atul Kashyap and Lavish Kashyap, allegedly worked at the MLA's residence in Thakurdwara. All three are residents of the Dilari area, around 12 km from the legislator's residence.

Ramu's cousin Ompal Singh said the incident dates back to October 6, when a gold bangle allegedly went missing from the MLA's residence. "The MLA's associates questioned Atul and Lavish and assaulted them. Associates believed Atul and Lavish had stolen it. During the questioning, they allegedly told the men that they had handed the bangle over to Ramu Kashyap," Ompal said.

Ompal alleged the MLA's associates subsequently arrived at Ramu's residence and took him away on the pretext of asking him to carry out some work.

Omwati Kashyap said she later went to the MLA's residence with several residents to find out what had happened to her son and the other two youths. She alleged that the MLA's associates refused to let them meet the youths and threatened them instead. "We later learnt that the three had been brutally assaulted inside the house during questioning. When their condition deteriorated, they were taken to a hospital run by someone known to the MLA's associates," she alleged, adding that the bangle is still missing.

Thakurdwara Station House Officer Manoj Parmar said the police were probing the matter. He said the incident allegedly occurred over the disappearance of a gold bangle from the MLA's residence, adding that two of the injured youths were undergoing treatment at a hospital.

Happy, an associate who answered the MLA's phone, denied Sushant Singh's involvement, claiming that the BJP leader was not at the house when the incident occurred.

He said the dispute involved the residence's staff over some issue and that some people had sustained serious injuries. "Some people have dragged MLA's name into the case for political reasons," he said. The two-term BJP MLA, Sushant Singh, represents the Barhapur Assembly constituency in Bijnor district. He hails from a royal family in Moradabad. Hewon last Assembly election by defeating Samajwadi Party's Kapil Kumar by 14,280 votes.

Two die in steel plant mishap in Jharkhand's Bokaro, probe ordered

Press Trust of India
Ranchi, October 11

TWO PERSONS died following gas exposure at ESL Steel plant in Jharkhand's Bokaro district on Sunday, a company official said. The steel maker will conduct an independent probe into the accident and take an appropriate step based on the findings, he said.

"An unfortunate incident involving gas exposure occurred in the plant in which an executive of the company and a business partner engineer lost their lives," an ESL spokesperson said.

ESL Steel Limited, Bokaro, is a subsidiary of Vedanta Iron & Steel Limited (VISL). The company spokesperson did not provide details of the accident.

Bokaro SP Nathu Singh Meena told PTI that the two deceased have been identified as Sohan Mahato from Ramgarh in Bokaro and Samir Ansari from Dhanbad district.

The accident took place at the company worksite under the Siyaljori Police Station limits in Chandankiyari block of Bokaro, he said.

Siyaljori Police Station officer-in-charge Ranjit Prasad Yadav said the bodies of the two deceased will be sent for post-mortem examinations after the arrival of their relatives.

He also said talks were being held with the workers' union and the company officials for payment of compensation.

"Prima facie, it appears that the deaths occurred due to exposure to carbon monoxide.

However, we will wait for the probe report and post-mortem report before making any comment," Sinha said.

Accompanied by the plant technical team, the Bokaro deputy chief factory inspector and the Chas executive magistrate visited the site and declared it safe as per the current assessment, the steel maker said.

ESL Steel Ltd is an integrated steel producer in the long products category, with its manufacturing facility in Bokaro.

Panel proposes Mumbai gymkhanas pay market rent, open doors to non-members

Pratip Acharya
Mumbai, October 11

MUMBAI'S GYMKHANAS on government land may soon have to pay market-rate rent, revised every five years, and a minimum licence fee of Rs 1.5 lakh for every event they host, a state committee has proposed. The panel wants the government to be able to hold its own programmes on the premises, use the grounds during disasters or elections, and open the clubs to people who aren't members, *The Indian Express* has learned.

The recommendations follow six months of inspections that, sources said, found "illegal construction" at several clubs. The committee submitted its fact-finding report to the state revenue department last month.

The suggestions come amid a broader debate over the use of publicly owned land by elite clubs and gymkhanas. In May, Land and Development Office of the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs asked the century-old Delhi Gymkhana Club to vacate its leased premises on Safdarjung Road.



Officials also said many clubs regularly rent out their premises for wedding banquets, concerts and private conferences. FILE

Maharashtra government officials, however, said the two developments are unrelated, noting the state's first notification on gymkhana lease conditions was issued in July 2025.

Nine teams of government officials visited each of the gymkhanas over the past six months, multiple sources told *The Indian Express*. Many clubs, they said, had altered their premises without approval, in violation of their lease and licence agreements. In one gymkhana, inspectors found that an additional swimming pool and restaurant area had been built. In another, part of the premises had been extended in a way that blocked the building's emergency exit, the sources said.

Officials said many clubs regularly rent out their premises for wedding banquets, concerts and private conferences. Sources alleged much of this income is kept off the books so more of the revenue stays with club members. "The larger objective behind setting up the Gymkhanas was to promote a culture of sports...has been observed these Gymkhanas have become largely a recreational hub. Sporting events have not been held in many ...for a very long time and due to the arbitrary membership conditions, these events are not inclusive," an official said.

After the inspections, office-bearers of several gymkhanas were called for hearings at the collector's office. Many gave written undertakings to pull down some of the unauthorised structures, sources said, and some said their accounts would be reviewed and submitted.

The committee has recommended that rent be fixed at current market rates and revised every five years, and that clubs pay a minimum of Rs 1.5 lakh per event, officials said. The government would get the right to hold its own programmes and public events at the gymkhanas, and to use the land during natural disasters or elections. The panel has recommended the premises should no longer be reserved for members alone, and the policy be changed to give ordinary citizens better access. Membership at some clubs costs up to Rs 1 crore, and applicants at many wait more than two decades for a membership window to open.

According to a report by the Observer Research Foundation, gymkhanas and VIP clubs occupy 664 acres, nearly a fifth of Mumbai's 3,780 acres of open space. Mumbaikars get an average of just 1.28 square metres of open space each, the report says.

WEB EXCLUSIVE
The Hunger Games-ification of Delhi's protests: Does the government fear its own citizens? — *Vaishnawi Sinha*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
It is the first responsibility of every citizen to question authority.
— *Benjamin Franklin*

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Barricades, detentions do not fortify the ECI

DELHI POLICE and the central forces brought in to add to their might succeeded in clearing Delhi's streets of protesters on Saturday, October 10. They imposed restrictions on the right to assemble peacefully and even to move freely, detained an estimated 7,000, made sure that voices of protest would not be heard in public spaces. They did this without the excessive use of violence deployed against protesters in July. But unfortunately for Delhi Police and its political masters, that is not the end of this story. Questions and concerns about the functioning of the Election Commission of India, and particularly Chief Election Commissioner of India Gyanesh Kumar, in the conduct of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls — highlighted in this newspaper's investigation — remain unresolved. The layers of barricades in the capital may have interrupted and scattered the protesters' mobilisations. But within Fortress Delhi, the ECI remains a disquietingly vulnerable address. Every attempt to silence the calls for greater transparency and accountability from it only makes them ring out more loudly and clearly.

Saturday's crackdown in the Capital may have given the impression that the face-off is between the protesters led by the CJP and the Narendra Modi government. That impression has been underlined by representatives of the ruling establishment who followed their playbook, firmed up over the years — they rounded on protesters aggressively, scolding them, labelling them as "destabilisers" and "anarchists" who have the backing of "foreign powers". The fact is, however, that a constitutional body, independent of the government of the day, lies at the centre of the current face-off. The ECI, though, has maintained an inexplicable silence, broken only by the bland press release that leaves important questions unaddressed. By not speaking for itself, by letting the Centre put in place an unprecedented crackdown against its critics, it hurts, even more, its own hard-won autonomy. Meanwhile, the angry CJP-vs-BJP war of words has drawn attention to another sobering absence. The political establishment, not just the BJP, has not yet found a language to talk to young citizens. Even opposition parties, whose former chief ministers were detained on Saturday, need to widen their vocabulary if they have to engage with Gen Z and their concerns, not just ride piggy-back on — or play catch-up to — their restlessness and mobilisations.

The Supreme Court did well to hold a special sitting on Sunday to draw some red lines, even if they seemed less mindful of the infringement of individual liberties and more hemmed in by the administration's imperatives. But as the week ended, one image, one question, throbbed at the centre of the quiet storm. The CEC, in a labyrinth of his own making. What will it take for Gyanesh Kumar to realise that his refusal to acknowledge or answer questions is taking a mounting toll on an institution that has long prided itself on its imaginative and persuasive outreach to all voters, especially the young? No detention centre is large enough to sequester this crisis of credibility.

US IT salvo opens new front for India

THE US government's decision to suspend major Indian IT firms from the PERM programme — which provides a pathway to permanent residency — is part of the administration's larger agenda to crack down on foreign labour and curtail immigration. It follows the administration's move last year to introduce a $100,000 fee for H-1B visas, deepening the uncertainty for companies that rely more on skilled foreign workers. While the immediate impact of the recent decision could be muted — Indian IT firms accounted for less than 2 per cent of the 1,17,849 PERM applications filed between October 2024 and September 2025, according to a report by ICICI Securities — the action is likely to sour sentiment. Moreover, as the report says, "any extension into broader work-visa restrictions would pose a more material risk". India's software, business and other services exports — a major source of foreign exchange for the country — stood at $221 billion in 2025-26. Washington's latest action thus opens another front in a tumultuous India-US relationship.

The White House's fresh salvo comes only weeks after the passing of a new law that paves the way for the US to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries like China and India that are top energy buyers from Russia. The pattern in the US administration's moves is hard to miss. Trump has, for some time now, been prodding India to reduce its purchases of Russian oil — between December 2022 and August 2026, China accounted for roughly half of Russia's crude exports, followed by India at 37 per cent, as per the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air — even as he announced a deal with Russia only a few days ago to supply diesel to US and global markets.

In the midst of these developments, statements from both sides appear to be less sanguine about the conclusion of the much delayed India-US trade deal. A few days ago, the US Trade Representative, Jamieson Greer, said that a trade agreement was not "imminent", followed by India's Finance Minister saying that "both the sides have reached a plateau beyond which giving or taking might be very very difficult". With the outcome of trade negotiations with Washington uncertain, the pressure on multiple fronts — energy, services exports, and labour mobility — is mounting.

FREEZE FRAME

BY EP UNNY



The AI challenge: How to maximise economic impact, spread gains evenly



NEELKANTH MISHRA



SOMIK V LALL

THE GLOBAL narrative on AI has been dominated by the generation of intelligence. Trillions of dollars are being invested in chips, data centres, and the computing infrastructure needed to train and run increasingly powerful models. The stock prices of a handful of leading AI firms in a few countries have surged.

The implicit assumption is that most of the economic value from AI will accrue to the companies that build and own these models, and to those upstream in the semiconductor, data centre, and energy value chains. This has increasingly led investors, firms, and policymakers to classify companies, markets, and even countries as winners or losers in the AI race.

But this may be too narrow a framing. Economic value is ultimately created not only by generating intelligence but by deploying it. The history of general-purpose technologies suggests that many of the largest gains accrue to the downstream users who adopt new technologies, adapt them to local conditions, and diffuse them throughout the economy.

India enters this phase from a position of strength. It already is one of the fastest-growing major economies and has repeatedly demonstrated an ability to deploy technology at population scale. Its experience with digital public infrastructure demonstrates how technology, institutions, and market incentives can combine to reduce costs, broaden access, and create platforms for innovation.

The World Bank Group's 'World Development Report 2026: The Promise of Artificial Intelligence' argues that AI can help sustain growth, boost productivity, improve public services, and expand opportunity. But the largest gains are unlikely to come from winning a race to build frontier models. They will come from applying AI to solve practical problems at scale.

The question of jobs is central. Only 4.5 per cent of existing jobs in low- and middle-income countries appear highly exposed to automation by generative AI, compared with 14.2 per cent in high-income countries. Another 16.2 per cent could experience meaningful productivity gains, not far from the 18.7 per cent estimated for advanced economies. For most workers in developing countries, AI is more likely to complement than replace.

This distinction is important. For developing countries, affordable, task-specific AI tools can raise the capabilities of businesses, households, and governments. Be it helping farmers access advice, assisting health workers with diagnosis, supporting teachers, or improving public administration, the opportunity lies in AI raising productivity and expanding access.

Two challenges loom. The first is concentration. Advanced chips, large-scale compute, data, research talent, and risk capital remain concentrated in a handful of firms and countries. Competition has kept access to leading models relatively inexpensive, but dependence on a small number of providers creates risks and can eventually generate market power.

The second challenge is the lack of complements. AI is only as useful as the ecosystem around it. Its value depends on investments in electricity, connectivity, affordable devices and compute, local-language data, skills, and institutions. People need the skills to use AI effectively and governments need the capacity to evaluate, procure, and regulate it. Technology alone does not generate development gains.

> India's experience with digital public infrastructure shows how technology, institutions, and market incentives can combine to reduce costs, broaden access, and create platforms for innovation

India already has examples of AI tools generating tangible benefits. Applications adapted to local contexts support agricultural extension, improve weather forecasting, strengthen health diagnostics, and expand access to public services. Bharat VISTAAR, the Government of India's digital platform for farmers, on which multiple states are building their own AI chatbots in multiple languages, and Wadhwani AI's tuberculosis-screening tools illustrate the potential. Yet the key question is not whether these technologies work. It is whether they can be adopted by millions of people.

Here India's experience with digital public infrastructure offers useful lessons. Platforms such as Aadhaar, UPI, DigiLocker, and emerging data-sharing systems provide shared public rails that lower costs, enable interoperability, and allow innovation to scale.

UPI is particularly instructive. Its open architecture promoted competition while avoiding dependence on a single provider. Similar principles should guide AI adoption. Governments and firms should favour systems that avoid technological lock-in and preserve portability, flexibility, and competition.

Emerging economies are unlikely to match the scale of investment being made by frontier AI hyperscalers, nor do they need to. More important is building strategic capabilities that expand India's options to advance AI: Domestic research, Indian-language models, shared compute resources, and a stronger ecosystem for deep-tech investment. Initiatives such as IndiaAI, RDIF, and ANRF are important steps in that direction.

Three principles follow.

First, design for scale from the outset. Across India, AI pilots are everywhere. What is needed is successful deployment at scale. Every pilot should have a credible pathway to broad adoption, including financing, institutional ownership, and integration with existing systems.

Second, test rather than assume. Decisions should be driven by evidence. India's scale makes rigorous evaluation both feasible and inexpensive. Large-scale rollouts provide opportunities to experiment, learn, and identify what works under real-world conditions.

Third, scale what works and stop what does not. Results, including failures, should be shared across states and ministries so lessons accumulate rather than being repeatedly rediscovered.

For India, the opportunity is not simply to adopt AI. It is to move from isolated applications to economy-wide productivity gains. That is the opportunity that matters: Maximising economic impact and spreading its gains as evenly as possible.

Mishra is World Bank executive director and Lall is director, Development Economics

America, Israel & an unsettled question: Can war win elections?



AAKASH JOSHI

ONE OF the biggest news stories unfolding over the last two weeks had an Indian pilot at its centre. Flydubai flight FZ1073, from Dubai to Tel Aviv, was allegedly meant to be used in a terrorist attack till Captain Smit Machchhar foiled the attempt by his co-pilot and suffered severe injuries for his bravery, going above and beyond the call of both duty and training.

Even as the dramatic details of what happened in the cockpit were emerging, the political and geopolitical implications of the attempted "9/11-like" attack were being discussed. Israel is set to go to the polls later this month, and the fate of the vexed conflict in West Asia may well turn on the result. Benjamin Netanyahu will hope that the threat of terrorism will help him scrape through, and paper over domestic discontents and international opprobrium for his government's actions in Gaza.

Half the world away, national capitals will watch another set of elections closely. On November 3, all 435 seats in the US House of Representatives and 35 out of 100 Senate seats will go to the polls. Along with several gubernatorial races, these midterm elections will shape, if not determine, the fate of the US war with Iran; the balance of power in the Russia-Ukraine conflict; and whether the White House's use of trade and tariffs to bully friends and adversaries alike will be restricted or expanded. Much will depend, according to opinion polls and analysts, on whether Trump can shore up a peace of some sort with Tehran.

The question in Tel Aviv, Tehran and Washington, and in many other democracies, then, is this: Can war and jingoism help win elections?

The conventional wisdom, coupled with the cliché of the cynical politician and gullible public, would have you believe so. In the 1997 film Wag the Dog, starring Dustin Hoffman and Robert De Niro, a US president caught in a scandal (a distinctly Jeffrey Epstein-esque one) hires a Hollywood director to "produce" a fictional war with Albania to get a boost in the polls.

George W Bush, for example, attacked Iraq on the flimsiest of pretexts — WMDs, messages from God, spreading democracy — and won a second term. FDR won an unprecedented fourth term during World War II. In the UK, Margaret Thatcher succeeded in cementing her image and distracting from discontent with the Falklands War. Ronald Reagan constantly invoked the red spectre, and his "defeat" of communism is a pillar of the conservative icon's legacy in the US. Even in the developing world, external enemies — whether a "foreign hand" or a neighbourhood dispute — have been used by political leaders to win support. Indira Gandhi, by all accounts, was at the height of her popularity after India defeated Pakistan in 1971.

> External threats, real and imagined, can often unite people behind an incumbent government. But used too often as tool, it will give diminishing returns

The problem with trying to establish simple causalities in politics, though, is that "the people" are an amorphous entity. The same person is, depending on circumstances, part of a mob, a crowd, an electorate and a public. External threats, real and imagined, can often unite people behind an incumbent government. But used too often as a tool, it will give diminishing returns.

Take Clement Attlee, the man who defeated Winston Churchill at what should have been the height of the latter's popularity. Churchill was the voice the British people heard throughout WWII, the man who stood against Hitler, and eventually emerged victorious. Yet, in 1945, it was a Labour leader who did not have either Churchill's charisma nor his love of Empire that the people chose.

George Bush Sr presided over the first "televised" war — Operation Desert Storm in 1991 — but lost to the charismatic Bill Clinton in 1992.

Closer to home, Atal Bihari Vajpayee's NDA government could not return to power in 2004 despite India's success in the Kargil war during his term. And, in what is a tragic irony, Donald Trump campaigned — both in 2016 and 2024 — on ending America's "forever wars".

Conflict can, indeed, bring unity and paper over differences. But not always. The Iraq and Afghanistan wars were fought in the aftermath of 9/11, a horrific act that shook a superpower. No similar justification exists for the attack on Iran — the spectre of WMDs redux is cutting less ice now. And in the age of social media, trust in governments is, in many countries, at an all-time low. Coupled with a cost-of-living crisis, the electorate may not be swayed as it once was. Clearly, politicians realise this: Trump, for example, announces an imminent peace deal as often as he calls for mass destruction.

Of course, elections can turn on a moment's notice. But if a politics of "wag the dog" provides diminishing returns, the world is better off for it.

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What public officials must ask — whom do we serve?



NANDITESH NILAY

AT THE heart of the debate over institutional integrity lies a question: How should a bureaucrat do the right thing? When the indelible ink of elections loses its sanctity, bridges collapse, and food and drugs are adulterated, what should guide a civil servant? If Mahatma Gandhi, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Lal Bahadur Shastri and Deen Dayal Upadhyaya were alive today, what advice would they offer those entrusted with public office?

The Mahatma's most frequently cited counsel is: "Whenever you are in doubt, or when the 'self' (ego) begins to overpower you, apply this test. Recall the face of the poorest and weakest person you have ever seen, and ask yourself if the step you are about to take will benefit them. Will they gain anything from it? Will it restore their control over their own life and destiny?" Gandhi viewed public office as a form of trusteeship, with power and funds held in trust for the people, especially the poorest. When rules governing electoral rolls are tweaked, officials must remember the vulnerable citizen who, lacking a school-leaving certificate, stands in line with her Aadhaar card in a plastic bag, asking to be counted.

As home minister, Shastri recognised the influence of recommendations in public administration. He reportedly observed that senior civil servants could quote rules admirably but rarely thought ahead or innovated. He knew officers by name and made a point of addressing them accordingly. For Shastri, virtue mattered more than power. Access to government services should not depend on recommendations or proximity to VIPs; no one should be able to jump the queue because of privilege.

For Patel, the courage to speak one's mind was an essential qualification for a civil servant. His law secretary, Shavak A Lal, once prepared a legal opinion on an issue raised by Lord Mountbatten but hesitated to present it, fearing it might contradict Patel's views. On learning of this, Patel reportedly asked, "Does the government pay you for your dishonest opinion? Giving an honest opinion is your job; accepting or rejecting it is mine." He expected secretaries to record their views even when these differed from his own, and believed that those afraid to do so should leave their jobs. Patel's commitment to integrity extended beyond the file. V Shankar, an ICS officer who served as his private secretary from 1946 until Patel's final days, recounted an incident from the turbulent months after Partition. On learning that a mob had gathered at the shrine of Nizamuddin Auliya in Delhi, Patel went there with Shankar. He walked around the shrine, questioned people and warned the police that they would be dismissed if further trouble occurred. The episode illustrates the qualities he expected of officials: Integrity under pressure and the willingness to act promptly to uphold law and order and protect minorities.

For Upadhyaya, *antyodaya* — the upliftment of the last person — was the central imperative. His philosophy offers civil servants a clear ethical compass: Measure every decision by its impact on the most disadvantaged; treat public office as *dharma*, not merely a career; strengthen local institutions; and remain morally independent of both political parties and bureaucratic files. Faced with an ethical dilemma, an official must ask: Whom do we serve?

That remains the essential question — and one we must answer if we are to restore public trust in institutions.

> Gandhi viewed public office as a form of trusteeship, with power and public funds held in trust for the people, especially the poorest

Nilay is the author of Being Good, Aaiye, Insaan Banaen *and* Ethikos. *He teaches and conducts training courses on ethics, values and behaviour*

40 YEARS AGO

October 12, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS
Reagan, Gorbachov hold talks
News blackout till summit ends
Quake in Salvador claims 1000 lives

Reagan-Gorbachev talks

US PRESIDENT Ronald Reagan and Soviet leader Mikhail Gorbachev, completed the second session of their talks in Iceland. While a news blackout prevailed, publicised positions are that the Soviet leader wants either a test ban or a Euromissile accord, and Reagan wants to continue testing, among others, nuclear components for space arms.

11 die in Punjab bus tragedy

ELEVEN PEOPLE were killed and 22 injured, three of them seriously, when a Punjab Roadways bus fell into a deep ditch near Dhar, 20 km from Pathankot. According to an official report received here, the injured have been admitted to hospital in Pathankot.

Earthquake claims 1,000 lives

CATASTROPHIC EARTHQUAKES, which badly damaged San Salvador and almost flattened its centre on Friday, caused about 1,000 deaths and injured 4,000 people. President José Napoleón Duarte has declared a national state of emergency and ordered his Cabinet to report to the headquarters of the joint chiefs of staff and broadcast urgent calls for doctors and nurses to report to hospitals.

US offer on arms production

THE US Defence Secretary, Caspar Weinberger, offered co-production facilities for manufacturing defence equipment to India. He was also willing to undertake talks with Pakistan and China to remove any misgivings India might have about its security environment and reduce tensions in the Subcontinent.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

The unprecedented number of arrests... shows just how much the judicial system has been used as a tool to contain... protests — *Le Monde, France*

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The next farm revolution must aim at significantly raising farmers' incomes



FROM PLATE TO PLOUGH

BY ASHOK GULATI

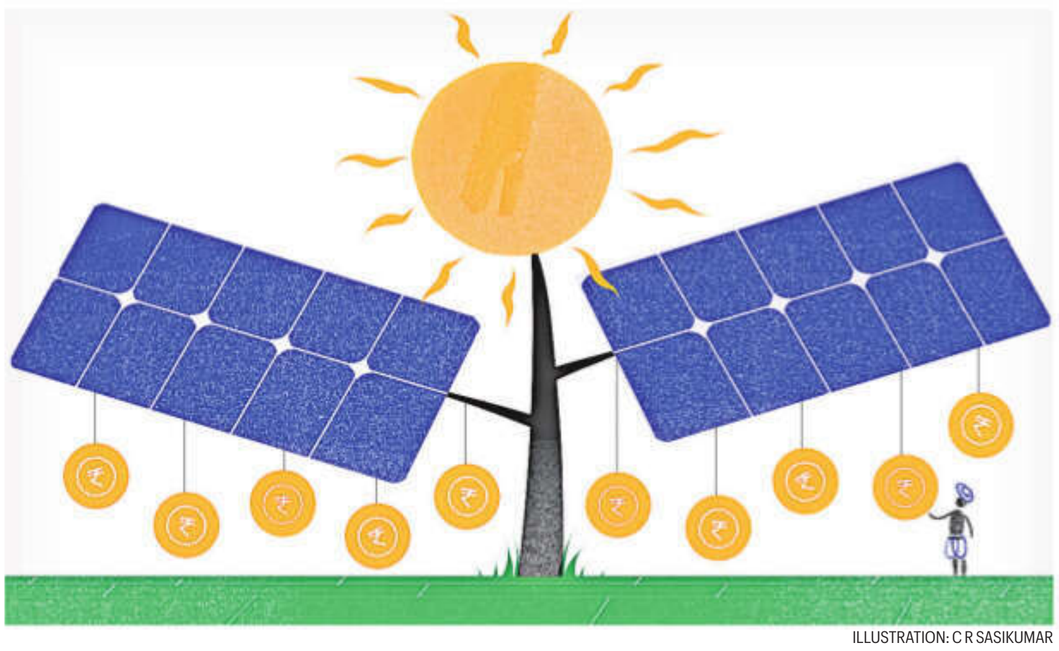


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi has completed 25 years in public service: 13 as Gujarat's chief minister and 12 as India's Prime Minister. It is time to recall his major achievements and the challenges the nation faces over the next 10 years or so. Given my limitations as an agricultural economist, I will restrict my piece to agriculture's performance in Gujarat and at the all-India level. I will also spell out what PM Modi still needs to do in agriculture to put it on a high and sustainable growth path that can significantly augment farmers' incomes.

Let me start briefly with his term as Gujarat CM from 2001-02 to 2013-14. Gujarat agriculture experienced a miracle, registering growth of more than 9 per cent per annum. This was almost unheard of even in the heyday of the Green Revolution in Punjab. This achievement owed much to his strong emphasis on augmenting water supply for irrigation through check dams, as well as securing a good share of Narmada River waters. He also separated feeder lines for irrigation and rural households to ensure that power reached farmers on time for irrigation. Roads were given equally high priority, connecting farmers to markets. Extension work through Krishi Mahotsav brought together government functionaries and the private sector to reach farmers in every village and showcase the latest technologies. Bt cotton, approved by the Atal Bihari Vajpayee government in 2002, achieved wonders in Gujarat and created rural prosperity. These achievements also helped him become CM for four terms, until he became Prime Minister in 2014.

The year he took over as Prime Minister, India was hit by droughts in 2014 and 2015. Back-to-back droughts had occurred only three times in a century. His experience in Gujarat came in handy, and Modi accorded high priority to water (irrigation) along with crop insurance (PM Fasal Bima Yojana). As a result, almost 60 per cent of India's gross cropped area is irrigated today. This has given India much-needed food security in basic staples. India has emerged as the largest producer and exporter of rice, and even after providing free food (rice or wheat, 5 kg per person per month) under the PM Garib Kalyan Yojana, we have buffer stocks that are more than four times the norm for rice and almost three times that for wheat.

India is also a net exporter of agricultural products. In 2025-26, India exported roughly $53 billion worth of agricultural products, with rice and marine products leading the way, and imported agricultural goods worth $40 billion, primarily edible oils and pulses.

Overall, the average annual growth of agricultural GDP under the Modi government, from 2014-15 to 2025-26, has been 4 per cent. This is not as high as the growth he achieved as Gujarat CM, but it is still good enough, especially when population growth is below 1 per cent. This is what has underpinned India's food security.

> There is one strategy that can augment farmers' incomes manyfold in a short period of time. And that is agri-photovoltaics, in which a farmer is an 'annadata' as well as an 'urjadata'

But as we look towards the near future, and even towards his dream of Viksit Bharat by 2047, we see several challenges on the agricultural front. Let me list just two that deserve his urgent attention.

First, our production basket is characterised by a major mismatch between demand and supply. We have too much rice and wheat and too few pulses and oilseeds. We have so much rice that we now plan to use almost 7 million tonnes of it for ethanol. This is perverse as the net energy balance is negative, as is the economics. *Atmanirbharta* (self-sufficiency) in pulses and oilseeds cannot be achieved unless the incentive package for these crops matches that for rice and wheat. Our research at ICRIER shows that paddy cultivation in the Punjab-Haryana belt is lucrative because of large input subsidies on power, fertilisers and canal irrigation, amounting to almost Rs 40,000 per hectare. If we want farmers to shift from paddy to pulses, which we should do to relieve pressure on groundwater and protect the environment, we should reward pulses and oilseeds growers to the tune of about Rs 35,000 per hectare. This would not impose an additional burden on the exchequer, as it would result in savings on input subsidies by the states (power and canal irrigation) and the Centre (fertiliser subsidy). Can PM Modi announce a special programme along these lines, on a 50:50 basis, at least in Haryana, where the water table has been receding by 1.7 feet each year? That would encourage Punjab to follow suit.

Second, PM Modi's dream of doubling farmers' real incomes has remained unfulfilled. The Ashok Dalwai Committee had pointed out that achieving this goal would require agricultural GDP to grow at 10.4 per cent. We know that real growth has been around 4 per cent — not bad, but it can surely be better. The usual way to augment farmers' incomes has been to diversify away from basic cereals towards high-value agriculture, be it fisheries, poultry, milk, fruits or vegetables. These are perishable commodities that require efficient value chains and links to high-income consumers in metros and abroad. But there is one strategy that can augment farmers' incomes manyfold in a short period of time. And that is agri-photovoltaics, in which a farmer is an *annadata* as well as an *urjadata*. The land serves a dual purpose: Producing energy through solar panels installed at a height of about 10 to 11 feet, with adequate spacing to allow photosynthesis in the crops grown below. ICRIER has set up a pilot project in Rajasthan, which has increased a farmer's income eight to 10 times. If PM Modi can tweak the PM-KUSUM scheme along the lines of the PM-Surya Ghar scheme, provide the same subsidy, and ensure a feed-in tariff at even half the cost of supplying power to rural areas under the traditional setup, he can usher in a new revolution, perhaps called 'Surya Khet Kranti', along the lines of 'Operation Flood' in milk.

The writer is distinguished professor at ICRIER. Views are personal

IITs need a bridge between engineering and humanities



JAISON MANJALY

PEOPLE ARE often surprised when I tell them that I teach philosophy to engineering students at IIT Gandhinagar. Some want to know whether I teach Indian or Western philosophy. Others ask what philosophy has to do with engineering. These questions sometimes contain a conclusion before a discussion has begun: Philosophy belongs elsewhere, and its presence in an IIT requires an explanation. I find the assumption more interesting than the question. We rarely ask whether engineers have beliefs about knowledge, truth, society, justice, or the mind. They do, as everyone does. What we question is whether a university should help them examine those beliefs. Technical education can leave a person proficient in a discipline while the assumptions governing other parts of their life remain largely unexamined. Why should an IIT consider that an adequate educational outcome?

My argument is not that every engineer needs a humanities and social science course to practice engineering. It is that an engineering degree cannot exhaust the purpose of a technological university. An engineer designing a system for allocating public resources must make decisions about what counts as needed, whose circumstances matter, and what constitutes an acceptable error. Computation can implement a decision rule; it cannot establish the justice of that rule without further argument. The humanities and social sciences offer ways of examining these questions, and of questioning the purposes for which a technical problem has been formulated.

The humanities also help us examine the concepts engineering already uses. Evidence, causation, explanation, probability, and truth carry assumptions that deserve attention. Logic and scientific methodology developed through centuries of inquiry involving philosophy, mathematics, and the sciences. Engineers inherit these intellectual tools. Learning to use them should include understanding their limits and contributing to their development.

Contributing to that inheritance requires asking what counts as progress and whose needs define a problem. Philosophy and the social sciences can change how we understand the task before us. Such questioning may open possibilities that technical competence within an accepted framework would leave unexplored. Science itself requires a willingness to question what we think we know. Doing science and engineering involves philosophical commitments that an experiment alone cannot settle.

A broad education was part of the IITs' founding conception. The Sarkar Committee report of 1948, which was instrumental in creating IITs, included humanities instruction in its plans for higher technical institutions and advocated combining scientific training with a broad human outlook. A common argument for including the humanities and social sciences (HSS) in technical education is MIT, where a substantial number of courses are offered in the humanities, social sciences, and cognitive sciences rather than solely in engineering. Although MIT was considered a useful benchmark by the Sarkar Committee Report for establishing IITs, our case for the humanities must also address India's educational needs.

Section 6(1)(a) of the Institutes of Technology Act, 1961 provides for instruction and research in engineering and technology, sciences and arts, in branches that an institute considers appropriate. The National Education Policy 2020 likewise envisages greater emphasis on the arts and humanities in engineering institutions. Implementing that commitment requires accepting that these disciplines may question the purposes an institution takes for granted.

It is often asked why engineering students who have undergone intensive coaching encounter subjects outside their "specialisation". Selection and education serve different purposes. An entrance examination tests preparation in specified subjects. Success in it does not necessarily mean that students have had opportunities to distinguish between persuasion and justification or to question familiar assumptions about caste, inequality, or progress. The curriculum should provide those opportunities without mistaking their absence for a lack of ability.

Questions about justice or historical experience deserve investigation even when their answers offer no technical application. A university needs room for work whose relevance is uncertain and whose findings may be inconvenient. Humanities scholars, therefore, need opportunities to conduct research and educate students while pursuing questions that extend beyond what other disciplines find useful. Intellectual independence is the most potential possibility for innovation in India.

At IIT Gandhinagar, students already move between engineering, science, and the humanities. I hope more IIT faculty will build on this practice by designing courses together and bringing other disciplines into their teaching. This would enable students to examine the knowledge they inherit and create knowledge that future generations will build on.

The writer is professor of Philosophy and Cognitive Science at IIT Gandhinagar

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Protest restrictions

THE OVERLY harsh government action against the peaceful assembly at Jantar Mantar raises troubling questions about the health of our constitutional democracy ('Lockdown, crackdown', *IE*, October 11). Denying citizens, students, and political leaders their fundamental right to assemble and peacefully express dissent directly undermines Article 19 of the Constitution. The preventive mass detentions, shutdown of dozens of metro stations, cancellation of train services, and boarding of commercial flights to apprehend youth activists mark an alarming overreach of police power. Instead of addressing concerns surrounding the integrity of the ECI, such draconian measures reflect a growing intolerance toward peaceful opposition.

Sanjay Chopra, Mohali

A DEMOCRATIC government cannot curb protest fearing that it might expose it, embarrass it, dent its image, hold it accountable or force it to take corrective action ('Lockdown, crackdown', *IE*, October 11). It cannot dismiss a legitimate protest as "mobocracy" or "anarchy". Shutting down the national capital and barricading it are no advertisement for a vibrant democracy. The CJP has a point in saying that it is time we, as a nation, shed the colonial baggage of seeking 'permission' from the government to protest against it.

C David Milton, Maruthancode

Health burden

INDIA'S OBESITY crisis exposes a failure of prevention: A growing health burden shaped by food environments and public policies, not merely individual choices ('An obesity prescription beyond the clinic', IE, October 10). NFHS-5 data indicate that 24 per cent of women and 23 per cent of men are overweight or obese, while obesity among children under five rose from 2.1 per cent to 3.4 per cent. India must mandate clear front-of-pack nutrition labels, restrict unhealthy food advertising targeting children, enforce nutritional standards for school meals and improve access to affordable, nutrient-rich foods through targeted subsidies.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

Disobedient essayist, who refuses a genre's uniform



SUMANA ROY

ABOUT SIX hours before she was awarded the Nobel Prize for literature, I sent a text message about Anne Carson to a friend. I'd like to write about her, I told her, in case Carson won the prize. My temperament rebels against the bookie reader, those that place their bets on writers as if they were horses at a Derby. I've made bad jokes about prizes and their *swayamvar*-like air, the relay race of passing the halo that such recognition temporarily foists on writers. And yet I wrote that text.

A week before the announcement of the prize, I had begun teaching a class by showing my students a video of Anne Carson's *Stacks*. In this course that I've called *The Disobedient Women of the Essay*, Carson has been — if we can tweak the phrase — writer-in-residence. We've had to turn to her often, whether discussing Joan Didion or Jane Gallop, Virginia Woolf or Susan Sontag, Sandra Gilbert and Susan Guber, Anahid Nersessian or Gillian Rose. We're still a couple of weeks away from reading 'The Glass Essay', but Carson will visit our class again, I know, when we read Dubravka Ugrešić and Ann Patchett and Annie Dillard and Elisabeth Tova Bailey and Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie, and other disobedient essayists. When my students — most of them women — and I read the essays, we annotate deviations, digressions and disruptions the essayists force on the corporatised hand-me-down version of the essay that gets an income and increments in media and academia. We will have a "Charter of Disobedience" by the end of the semester, we say, laughing. I am certain that in my notes — and my students' — the most disobedient woman of them all will be Carson.

> 'I want to be unbearable.' There's a sotto voce rage against the agents and engines of genre, representation and interpretation. She will not be reduced

The disobedience began early — with a PhD that had the title *Odi et Amo Ergo Sum* ("I Hate and I Love, Therefore I Am"). Her rejection of Descartes and the packaged ideas of rationalism that mark our conditioning in post-Enlightenment behaviour of thought and language is actually a rejection of masculinist categories such as the genre. And Carson has opposed the disciplinary tendencies of the genre with mighty inventiveness. Her first book was not a novel but a work of literary and philosophical criticism that derived from her doctoral dissertation. *Eros the Bittersweet* had a subtitle: "An Essay". It's a word — a category — that she would turn to repeatedly, to excavate, to inflate, to argue with, to demolish, to build antechambers, to rescue, to renovate, to rehabilitate.

In *The Beauty of The Husband*, an essay that includes narrative verse, the sections are named 'tango', after the partner dance form, ironic because its subject is a failed marriage. Her first book of poems combined art history and optical theory, while questioning the fundamental biases of post-Renaissance ideas of perspective. Then there's 'The Glass Essay', a poem that she's called a "lyric essay", that is as much about her mother as it is about Emily Brontë; *Autobiography of Red*, a novel-in-verse that, like much of her writing, reimagines ancient Greek myths; *Nox*, an experimental accordion-fold art book for her estranged brother; *Decreation*, the title itself holds the spirit of her creative practice.

"I want to be unbearable." There's a *sotto voce* rage against the agents and engines of genre, representation and interpretation. She will not be reduced; Sappho will not be diminished. "I am not Descartes," she declares. The small, the short, the stanza, the section — their forms of attention, disruption, distraction, and interruption have been the subject of a lifelong exploration. Carson was recognised for "her bold and inventive oeuvre that, in playful dialogue with the classical tradition, has created new forms for contemporary literature". She was "listening to the wind" in Iceland when the news came, she said. "Sometimes, what I end up writing about is just the way the light is... After the light, we could talk about my mother or what I'm having for dinner or Proust's theory of translation." A writer whose preoccupation with the honesty and fluidity of artistic form led her to explore the classics and the elemental world with surprise and devotion, Carson has made it possible for many of us to write without being forced to wear a genre's uniform.

Roy, a poet and writer, is professor, Ashoka University. Views are personal

Teacher who embodied life of mind, and conscience



PARVINDER SINGH

WHEN I heard the news of Professor Kamal Aron Mitra Chenoy's demise, I immediately thought of his smile, calm gaze, and powerful voice filled with conviction. For several years, he served as a professor at the Centre for Comparative Politics and Political Theory in JNU's School of International Studies. He will be remembered as one of those who taught from classrooms, streets, courtrooms, and protest lines. With his passing, JNU has lost an embodiment of the university at its best: A place where the life of the mind and the life of conscience were never allowed to drift apart.

Chenoy's political awakening began as an economics student at Kirori Mal College, Delhi University, where he was elected to the Students Union executive committee in 1969. He arrived at JNU in 1972, entering an intellectual universe crackling with debate: Naxalism, Trotskyism, the SFI-AISF alliance, the challenge of the Freethinkers, and the presence of formidable student leaders like Prakash Karat. He became the unit secretary of the All India Students' Federation, learning — as he would later recall — that unity among progressive forces was not a luxury but a necessity. Then came the Emergency. Chenoy was among those forced to leave the country, not by ambition or opportunity, but by the imperative of survival and freedom. He returned as a faculty member.

My memory of Professor Chenoy is inextricable from the events that unfolded in the wake of the murder of Chandrashekhar Prasad, beloved former president of the JNU Students Union (JNUSU), shot dead in Siwan, Bihar, in March 1997. Chandrashekhar was a symbol of what it meant to be from a marginalised community and still dare to dream of justice. His killing sent shockwaves through JNU. When students marched in protest and were arrested, it was not enough for Professor Chenoy to express solidarity from the comfort of his office. I had the honour of serving as an elected member of the JNUSU when the university was navigating some of its most turbulent political waters. For those of us who witnessed it, the image of Professor Chenoy — measured, composed, never raising his voice unnecessarily — standing with the protesting students at the gates of power remains one of the most powerful examples of what a teacher at a public university ought to be. He had the rare gift of making you feel that your own thinking mattered. He pushed back when he disagreed — and he could be a formidable interlocutor — but always in ways that left you more confident in your own reasoning. For that, I will always be grateful.

> The image of Professor Chenoy standing with the protesting students at the gates of power remains one of the most powerful examples of what a teacher at a public university ought to be

As a teacher, he shaped the academic lives of generations of students who now teach, write, research, and advocate across the world. He was a three-time president of the JNU Teachers' Association, a distinction that reflects not only his standing among peers but also his consistent commitment to institutional democracy within the university. As a longtime member of the CPI, Professor Chenoy tried to bring Marxist political economy into productive dialogue with human-rights frameworks at a time when that conversation was neither fashionable nor easy. He participated in fact-finding missions to riot-affected areas, Malliana, Hashimpura, Meerut, Ayodhya, Gujarat, and Muzaffarnagar, when the state preferred silence. He testified before the US Commission on International Religious Freedom on the condition of religious minorities in India, an act that drew sharp criticism from the Hindu Right, which he accepted with characteristic equanimity.

Farewell, professor.

Singh, head of communications, UN World Food Programme in India, was a JNUSU office bearer in 1996-97

Gorakhpur-based activist, convicted of rape, dies in jail

Express News Service
Lucknow, October 11

GORAKHPUR-BASED activist Parvez Parwaz, who was serving life imprisonment sentence for gangrape, died in jail on Sunday. The 72-year-old former journalist was a petitioner in a case of alleged hate speech against UP CM Yogi Adityanath.

"He (Parwaz) was battling health problems, including high blood pressure and diabetes. On Saturday night, he complained of breathing difficulty and was taken to the district hospital, where he died," said Superintendent of Gorakhpur District Jail, VK Pandey.

Parwaz was arrested in September 2018, after a 40-year-old woman accused him and one Mehmood alias Jumman Baba of gangrape on June 3, 2018.

In her complaint, the woman alleged that she had gone to Jumman Baba's house that day "seeking remedies" for her marital problems, when he took her to an isolated spot and raped her at gunpoint, along with "someone Jumman called Parvez bhai."

In July 2020, the District and Sessions Court in Gorakhpur sentenced Parwaz to life imprisonment in the case. Parwaz faced three more criminal cases, was convicted in two, and one remained pending.

Parvaz first came to public light in 2008, when he got an FIR registered against Yogi Adityanath, the then BJP MP from Gorakhpur. He had accused Adityanath of delivering an inflammatory speech after a Hindu youth died in a January 2007 clash during a Muharram procession.

After the BJP came to power in UP in 2017, the state government refused to grant sanction to prosecute Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.

In MP, a proposed nuclear plant runs into resistance from village

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 11



People gather to oppose site investigations for a proposed nuclear power project at Rojhauhi village in Rewa district of Madhya Pradesh. EXPRESS

VILLAGERS IN Madhya Pradesh's Rewa district have stopped preliminary ground investigations for a proposed nuclear power project, objecting to the exercise as senior district officials attempt to defuse the standoff by maintaining that construction of the plant has not begun.

The proposed project is planned near Rojhauhi village. On October 9, villagers gathered after drilling equipment arrived for preliminary site investigations and prevented the work from proceeding, according to local reports.

Tata Power Company Limited is pursuing the proposed project in Rewa district. In a letter dated July 13, 2026, addressed to the executive engineer of the Madhya Pradesh Paschim Kshetra Vidyut Vitaran Company's Teonthar division, the company said it had initiated pre-project activities for a proposed 2X220 MW nuclear power project near Rojhauhi village.

A key point of contention is the proposed drilling. A letter from the Rewa Collector's office dated August 21, 2026, concerns geological investigations involving eight boreholes — four proposed to reach a depth of 100 metres each and four to reach 50 metres each.

A document dated June 28, 2026, titled 'Agreed Scope of Work: Feasibility Study of Water Availability Assessment and Area Drainage Studies for TPCL', outlines proposed studies to assess water availability and drainage requirements for the project. These include an examination of historical water data, long-term records where available, flows during lean periods, competing uses, ecological flows and arrangements that may be required for water intake and discharge.

The study identifies the Tamas River, approximately 12 km from the proposed site, along with Bansagar Reservoir, Tons Barrage and Beehar Barrage, among the water sources or infrastructure to be assessed.

The Rewa district administration has said that no land has been allocated to Tata Power. The company has not yet responded to an email for its comment.

Villagers objected when drilling equipment arrived in the area. District administration officials, police personnel and representatives associated with the project were present as efforts were made to resolve the standoff.

Objections to the project are also reflected in village correspondence. A special Gram Sabha meeting was held at Sarai Kala on September 3, 2026.

The proceedings available for review record objections to the proposed project. In a letter dated September 5 to the Rewa Collector, sarpanch Komal Singh referred to the August 21 communication and the September 3 meeting, conveying the Gram Sabha's opposition and stating that consent or permission for the proposed project had not been granted.

Shivanand Dwivedi, a social activist leading the protests, told The Indian Express that the proposed Rojhauhi nuclear power plant would affect not only Sarai Kala gram panchayat but also more than 100 surrounding gram panchayats.

"Looking at its history, it could prove to be catastrophic for our health, environment, and hundreds of future generations. The disasters of Chernobyl and Fukushima are prime examples of this," he said, warning of potential displacement of lakhs of people, cancer and congenital disabilities.

Dwivedi also raised concerns about the potential impact on local water bodies and ecosystems. "Due to the discharge of hot water from the plant, aquatic life and the local ecosystem will be severely impacted. The potential radiation poses a risk of incurable diseases, affecting both current and future generations," he said.

Alleging that the project was being pursued without the consent of the Gram Sabha and residents, Dwivedi said no public hearing had been conducted. He further alleged that a no-objection certificate (NOC) had been prepared on the basis of a "forged and fabricated letter" from the sarpanch.

"Although two resolutions opposing the nuclear power plant were passed by the Gram Sabha, the administration has ignored them and is forcefully proceeding with the installation process," he said, accusing the administration of displaying "complete authoritarianism" and disregarding local opposition.

Rewa Collector Narendra Kumar Suryavanshi told The Indian Express that no land had been allotted to Tata Power for the proposed nuclear power plant and that the Madhya Pradesh Industrial Development Corporation (MPIDC) was involved in facilitating land for the project.

He said the permission granted so far was limited to testing the site's suitability and assessing the project's feasibility. "Only after the suitability of the land is established can a decision be taken on the project," he said, adding that the preliminary testing should not be construed as the beginning of construction.

Suryavanshi said officials had been prevented from accessing the site and that he, the Superintendent of Police and other officials had been trying to explain the purpose of the exercise to residents. "We are trying to explain and counsel them that we are not setting up a power plant yet. Testing doesn't mean that the power plant is being set up," he said.

On the dispute over Gram Sabha consent and the allegation that the NOC was based on a forged letter, Suryavanshi said the administration had received the Gram Sabha's consent before villagers subsequently protested against the project. He said the administration had proceeded with the NOC on the basis of that earlier consent.

UP factory owner beaten to death by mob over tyre recycling smoke

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, October 11

A MOB protesting against smoke and pollution from a tyre-melting recycling factory in Saharanpur allegedly turned violent, killing its 38-year-old owner and injuring his business partner. The factory, which extracts oil and carbon by melting waste tyres, had been run for the last two years by Shamli native Arbeen Chauhan.

According to the police, the violence erupted late Friday night when a group of residents from Kallarheri and neighbouring Sinauli villages arrived at the factory located outside Kallarheri village. The group demanded the unit be shut down, claiming the plant's heavy smoke caused respiratory problems among locals.

The factory guard, Kishan Singh, was on duty when the group arrived, verbally abused him, and demanded the plant be closed. Singh phoned Chauhan, who arrived shortly after with his relative and business partner, Sadiq. Chauhan tried to reason with the group, but a heated argument escalated into violence. The accused allegedly attacked Chauhan and Sadiq with iron rods, sticks, and batons. The mob also allegedly smashed the windows of the owner's vehicle before fleeing the scene before the arrival of the police.

The police rushed the injured factory owners, Arbeen Chauhan and Sadiq, along with an injured villager to the hospital. Chauhan later succumbed to injuries.

Following a complaint lodged by the factory guard, Saharanpur police registered an FIR against 11 people at the Gangoh police station on charges including murder, rioting, attempt to murder, intentional insult with intent to provoke breach of peace, and mischief.

"We have arrested three persons in the case, and efforts are on to catch the others," said Shailendra Pratap Gautam, Circle Officer, Saharanpur.

Circle Officer Gautam noted that one of the accused belongs to the family of the Kallarheri village Pradhan. He added that the injured villager undergoing treatment at the hospital is also named as an accused and remains in police custody.

"We have not earlier received any complaint about a dispute between the villagers and the factory owner. Villagers had also never earlier raised any problem about smoke emanating from the factory," Gautam added.

The factory is situated outside Kallarheri village and has operated for two years. Regional Officer of the UP Pollution Control Board, Saharanpur, Yogendra Kumar, confirmed that the unit was operating legally.

"It was operating after completing all formalities, and there is no residential house within a 1-km radius of the premises. We have not received any complaint earlier regarding pollution from villagers or any authority," Kumar said.

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI - 38

Tender Notice No. ICF/PCMM/EOT/41/2026 Dated: 09.10.2026

The following e-tenders are published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to **www.ireps.gov.in** and quote against these tenders. Manual quotations will not be entertained for these tenders. Closing and Opening time for all tenders are **14.15 hrs.** Hindi version of tender notice is available on website **www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in**

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Tender Title	Quantity	Due Date
01.	06260157	S&I OF BIO-TANK LH & RH, LHB-S TRAP	1500 NO'S	22/10/2026
02.	06261965	SET OF 2 X 685 LIT WATER TANK	340 SET	22/10/2026
03.	02262073	TROUGH FLOOR ARRGT (KM DTC RVNL)	71 SET	23/10/2026
04.	02262074	Set of Corrugated sheet floor (KM MC & TC RVNL)	214 SET	23/10/2026
05.	02262155	SHELL KIT (RAPID METRO M)	25 SET	26/10/2026
06.	07262720	S & I FRP PANELING FOR SIDE WALL	57 SET	26/10/2026
07.	07263178	SUPPLY & INSTALLATION OF 3 SEATER COMP(DBL) for EMU/3P-SSTEEL	740 NO'S	26/10/2026
08.	07262886A	WB IMPREG COM.LAN.SHT6X1220X2440	2702 NO'S	27/10/2026
09.	08261855	CABLE 25 SQ MM YELLOW & BLUE 1.8 KV	17200 METRE	27/10/2026
10.	07262854	S & I OF EMERGENCY OPENABLE WINDOW FOR MEMU/US COACHES	2231 NO'S	28/10/2026
11.	08261862	CABLE 2.5 SQ MM CHOCOLATE 1.8 KV	138700 METRE	28/10/2026
12.	02261991	BEARING BRACKET FOR SCHAKU COUPLER	764 NO'S	30/10/2026
13.	02260124	C/S of Side wall Assembly (VB Sleeper TC)	30 SET	30/10/2026
14.	02262024	C/S of Roof, Side Wall and End Wall (LS)	30 SET	30/10/2026
15.	01265486	Advanced Car Body Integration Jig for Vande Bharat Chair Car/Sleeper.	1 NO	30/10/2026
16.	02260164	C/S of Frame work, Welding parts and Carline (VB Sleeper DTC)	25 SET	02/11/2026
17.	03262180	NON-ASBESTOS BASED "K" TYPE HIGH FRICTION COMPOSITION BRAKE BLOCK'	19591 NO'S	02/11/2026
18.	08261835	S&I E.P BRAKE EQPT MEMU/TC/JK, MEMU/NDMC/JK & MEMU/DMC/JK	Refer IREPS Website	02/11/2026
19.	02262006	C/S OF ROOF & SIDE WALL (MEMU DMC)	27 SET	02/11/2026
20.	08261761	HIGH VOLTAGE PT VB SPARE	18 NO'S	03/11/2026
21.	03262333	BRAKE DISC FOR AXLE MOUNTED BRAKE SYSTEM	723 SET	04/11/2026
22.	02261987	C/S OF CRF TROUGH FLOOR PART (MEMU DMC, NDMC & SPIC)	29 SET	05/11/2026
23.	03261954	Bogie general arrangement for KOL METRO MC, TC, DTC Bogie items	Refer IREPS Website	05/11/2026
24.	02262240	END WALL (MEMU DMC)	33 NO'S	06/11/2026
25.	02262083	End wall (LWACCN PP, LWACCW PP & LWFAC PP)	72 NO'S	06/11/2026
26.	02260121	C/S of Sidewall Assembly (VB Sleeper NDTC)	5 SET	09/11/2026
27.	02261894	C/S OF SOLE BAR	215 SET	10/11/2026
28.	08260193	PROPULSION ELECTRICS FOR VANDE BHARAT TRAIN SETS	Refer IREPS Website	20/11/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO. 41

Corrigendum has been issued to the following tender. Please check IREPS website for further details.

Sl.No.	Tender No.	Existing value	Modified value
01.	02261666	Additions of Drawing, Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
02.	02261973	18/10/2026	15/10/2026
		EMD 569920	325670
		Item Description Modified and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
03.	02261817	05/10/2026	21/10/2026
04.	02261915	Postponement of due date on 15/10/2026. Item Description Modified and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
05.	02261650	Deletions of Drawing, Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
06.	02261739A	Postponement of due date on 22/10/2026. Item Description Modified, EMD, Quantity and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
07.	02261736A	Postponement of due date on 22/10/2026. Item Description Modified, EMD, Quantity and Additions and Deletions of Drawings. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
08.	07261935	08/10/2026	16/10/2026

From Nepal temple to Bihar border: How Rajasthan Police trapped a 'most wanted' drug fugitive

Express News Service
Jaipur, October 11



Two policemen pose as traders as they wait to trap Sohanlal. EXPRESS

FOR A drug trafficker who had spent months hiding in Nepal, a meeting with prospective buyers promising a lucrative deal proved to be his undoing. On Saturday, October 10, Rajasthan Police said its Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) had arrested Sohanlal, a 32-year-old alleged drug trafficker wanted for six years, at the Raxaul border in Bihar. The team posed as Punjab-based buyers and lured him out of Nepal, where he had been hiding for months.

ANTF Inspector General (IG) Vikas Kumar said Sohanlal, who carried a Rs 75,000 reward, was among Rajasthan's top 25 narco-criminals. His arrest marked the ANTF's first arrest of an internationally absconding wanted person.

Under the operation, codenamed Vishanhans, ANTF personnel approached Sohanlal's associates while posing as major drug buyers from Punjab and offered to strike a deal involving a large consignment. His associates told the undercover cops that a deal of that scale could be negotiated only with Sohanlal himself, who was based in Nepal. They subsequently arranged a meeting with him outside Kathmandu's Pashupatinath temple.

The ANTF team travelled to Kathmandu and waited at a hotel near the location provided by the associates. However, when Sohanlal failed to turn up, further intelligence revealed that he regularly visited the temple, "believing that his religious visits would help him evade arrest," the ANTF said.

The team then deployed personnel in disguise near the temple. One officer posed as a garland seller, another as a tilak applicator, while others blended in with devotees entering the premises. During surveillance, they spotted a man whose appearance matched that of the wanted accused.

Posing as buyers, the officers eventually gained his confidence and convinced him to agree to a deal. They told him their chief was travelling from Punjab with a large amount of cash to purchase the drugs. Citing security concerns over carrying such a sum into Nepal, they persuaded Sohanlal to travel to the Raxaul border in Bihar to collect an advance payment. As soon as he crossed into Indian territory with his team, ANTF personnel apprehended him.

According to the ANTF, Sohanlal had fled to Nepal in October 2025 to evade arrest in a case registered under the NDPS Act at Chittalwana police station in Rajasthan's Jalore district in 2020. Police said he was preparing to leave Nepal for Bhutan on October 10, the day he was arrested.

Sohanlal initially entered the illegal liquor trade in 2016 but later shifted to smuggling *doda chura* (poppy husk) and opium, which he found more lucrative. He initially operated alongside other smugglers in Barmer before setting up an independent network after a falling-out over profit-sharing.

His alleged supply network extended across Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan's Mewar region, including Chittorgarh, Udaipur and Bhilwara. Through associates, he allegedly supplied consignments in Marwar and Punjab.

After the NDPS case was registered against him in 2020, Sohanlal went underground. Police said he moved between several states, including Maharashtra, Gujarat, Goa, Delhi, Chandigarh and Andhra Pradesh, and avoided using a mobile phone. He also spent time in Mumbai, where his father runs a steel business.

After fleeing to Nepal in October 2025, he continued to operate his network through associates in India.

IG Kumar said the arrest was part of the state's continuing crackdown on drug smuggling. With Sohanlal's arrest, the ANTF has now arrested 103 wanted persons, he said. Kumar added that the personnel involved in the operation would be honoured at the ANTF headquarters.

NIA arrests member of Bangladeshi terrorist outfit

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, October 11

THE NATIONAL Investigation Agency arrested a suspected member of the Jamaat-ul-Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB) in Banshihari in West Bengal's South Dinajpur district on Saturday.

The NIA produced the accused, Mujibur Rahman, before the Gangarampur Sub-Divisional Court, where it secured a transit remand. On September 29, when he was evading capture, an NIA team raided Mujibur's home in the Kushkari area for hours and questioned his family members.

NIA sources said that during interrogation, Mujibur confessed to his active ties with the JMB and its Assam module, prompting his immediate arrest.

"Local police secured the suspects in Bihar on Thursday night and cooperated closely with federal agencies, culminating in the NIA's formal arrest on Saturday evening. Further investigation is on," said a police officer.

POLICE TELECOMMUNICATION HEADQUARTER,
Madhya Pradesh, Bhopal
E-mail: ssp_radio@mppolice.gov.in office Phone No. 0755-2443674,

No. PDM/PUR-69/26/DMR/D- 17251/2026, Dated: 07/10/2026

-:Notice Inviting Tender:-

e-Tenders are invited by the Senior Superintendent of Police (Radio) MP Bhopal on behalf of DGP MP Bhopal for the following items :-

S. No	ITEM NAME	QTY	Required EMD Rs.	Tender Fee Rs.
1	Digital VHF 20W Mobile/ Base Radio (DMR Tier II)	226	29,60,000/-	15,000/-
2	Digital VHF 2 to 5 W handheld radio set (DMR Tier II)	1475		
3	Digital VHF Repeater DMR Tier II (with ERDM mode)	32		
4	Single Frequency series Repeater (SFSR)	45		
5	DMR Duplexer Filter for Repeater	25		

1. Cost of tender documents is Rs. 15,000/- (Tender fee) (Rupees Fifteen Thousand only) which is non-refundable and cannot be exempted in any condition. Must be paid online at the time of filling e tender.
2. The EMD amount will have to be deposited online through the website **https://www.mptenders.gov.in**.
3. Tender documents can also be download from the website of MP Police (www.mppolice.gov.in).
4. The Tender Should be submitted online on website https://www.mptenders.gov.in and within scheduled date and time.
5. Schedule Date & Time:

S.	Activity of tender	Date	Day	Time
1	Documents Publish/download/Sale Start Date	07/10/2026	Wednesday	1800 Hrs
2	Pre-bid Queries Submission Start Date	08/10/2026	Thursday	1830 Hrs
3	Pre-bid Queries Submission End Date	12/10/2026	Monday	1700 Hrs
4	Pre-bid Meeting Date	14/10/2026	Wednesday	1700 Hrs
5	Pre-bid Queries Response Submission Date	16/10/2026	Friday	1800 Hrs
6	Bid Submission Start Date	16/10/2026	Friday	1830 Hrs
7	Bid Submission End Date	27/10/2026	Tuesday	1500 Hrs
8	Opening of PQ Bid	28/10/2026	Wednesday	1510 Hrs

Sd/-
Samir Saurabh (IPS)
Senior Superintendent of police (Radio)
M.P. Bhopal

G19867/26

{ KAMAL MITRA CHENOY • 1951-2026 }

Academic and activist who firmly believed in secularism & pluralism

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, October 11



Professor Chenoy taught comparative politics at Jawaharlal Nehru University

IN APRIL 2006, activist Medha Patkar sat on an indefinite hunger strike at Jantar Mantar against the Sardar Sarovar Dam on Narmada river in Gujarat. On the night of April 5-6, Delhi police detained her and took her to AIIMS. Following the crackdown, Prof Kamal Mitra Chenoy from JNU joined the protest and fasted for the next four days.

"If Kamal had been alive, he would have been on the streets of Delhi, protesting with the students," says his wife Prof Anuradha M Chenoy. Both retired as professors from JNU.

Prof Chenoy, who taught comparative politics and the Indian Constitution at JNU's School of International Studies (SIS), died on Sunday. He was 75.

In 2020, he was diagnosed with fast-progressing Alzheimer's. Between 2021 and 2022, he was infected with Covid-19 thrice. "Each time, it worsened his condition," says Anuradha. The cause of his death was internal haemorrhage.

Prof Chenoy is survived by Anuradha and their two children, Ayesha and Ajit Chenoy.

He was born in 1950 in Delhi. His father was an IFS officer, and his mother, Shanta Chenoy, came from a Baghdadi Jewish family.

Straight out of Doon School, he joined the Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun. Three months in, he realised his love for literature and poetry. He left IMA and in 1969 joined DU's Kirori Mal College to study economics. Student politics drew him organically and never quite left him. That same year, he was elected to the executive committee of the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU). He became secretary of AISF in 1973.

After becoming a lecturer at JNU, he was elected president of the JNU Teachers' Association four times.

"At heart, he always remained a student activist, even as a professor," says Prof Sanjay Pandey, a colleague at SIS. "He brought together voices from across political spectrum and encouraged debate and discussion." Prof Chenoy would speak at Ganga Dhaba every week and debate with students and colleagues. He stood for what he believed in: secularism, pluralism, socialism, liberty and equality. And he would go out of his way to help students," says Prof Pandey.

In classroom, Prof Chenoy's oratory skills mesmerised students. He carried a copy of the Constitution.

"He was one of the finest orators JNU has had," says Dr Dhananjay Tripathi, Associate Professor of international relations at South Asian University, whom Chenoy taught Indian political system in 2006. "He taught us the values the Constitution holds: liberty, freedom of expression, equality, secularism, socialism. It was the most sacred document to him. He would say it was the social contract between the people of India and the state, and that if it was altered, India would no longer be India."

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• GOVERNANCE

What determines poverty? J&K's controversy over EWS certificates

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, October 11

IN THE recently concluded Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) Assembly session, Peoples Conference party president and Handwara MLA Sajad Gani Lone moved a motion to address the regional imbalance in the issuance of Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) certificates in J&K.

Speaker Abdul Rahim Rather directed the government to examine the alleged imbalance and initiate corrective measures if needed.

Over the last two years, J&K has issued 26,514 EWS certificates. Of these, 24,058 (91%) certificates have gone to Jammu division while Kashmir division has received only 2,486 certificates. Some political leaders, especially Lone, contend that the criteria for issuance of EWS certificates go inherently against Kashmir and call for a review of the eligibility rules.

The criteria

The 2019 amendment to the Jammu and Kashmir Reservation Rules, 2005, implemented 10% reservation for EWS. The amended Rules said that to be categorised as EWS, a household's total annual income should be less than Rs 8 lakh from all sources, and it should have less than 5 acres of agricultural land. The Rules excluded anybody having a house or a residential flat of 1,000 or more square feet, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in notified municipalities, or having a residential plot of 200 sq yards or more outside the notified municipalities.


Sajad Gani Lone. FILE

According to some political leaders, the administration replicated the Central Act in J&K despite having a different set of economic indicators, without considering local factors. For instance, the language used for measuring land in the amended Rules is not used in J&K's revenue records. In J&K, land is measured in *kanals*, *marlas* and square feet as against square yards. One *kanal* equals 5,445 sq ft or 605 sq yards, while one *marla* equals 272 sq ft or 30 sq yards.

• IN NUMBERS

- Out of 26,514 EWS certificates J&K has issued over the last two years, 24,058 (91%) have gone to Jammu division.
- Of around 2,20,000 AAY ration cards, some 144,000 cards were issued in Kashmir division and about 75,000 in Jammu division.

Kashmir at a disadvantage

Traditionally, Kashmiris spend their entire life savings on building a house. But the nature of their houses — multi-storied, with a garden — means that most Kashmiris are at a disadvantage when it comes to the EWS category, since the area of a multi-storied house is measured for every floor. Lateef-uz-Zaman Deva, former chairman of the J&K Public Service Commission, said Kashmiri houses were built this way owing to multiple factors such as climate and a culture of privacy.

A question of yardsticks

Comparing the figures of the EWS and the Centre's flagship scheme Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY) for ration distribution in J&K, Lone had asked how different yardsticks could be used to determine who was poor. Data showed that of around 2,20,000 AAY ration cards, some 144,000 cards were issued in Kashmir division and about 75,000 in Jammu division.

Lone pointed out that the two measures "produce sharply different pictures of poverty". He said that as per AAY figures, "55% of the poor live in Kashmir and 45% in Jammu. How can the government spend crores in subsidies for the poor and then deny their poverty when they apply for a job?"

To correct this imbalance, some political leaders cited the example of Kerala and Himachal Pradesh, which have tweaked Central rules to suit state requirements. According to Lone, the government should make the AAY norms the eligibility criteria for EWS certificates.

• RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR

Trump's deal, and the India oil question

The new diesel deal will lead to revenue generation for Moscow. This is a key point India can now raise with the US in its tariff negotiations


SUKALP SHARMA

THE US has repeatedly targeted India over its big purchases of Russian oil, from additional penal tariffs last year to a recent law empowering President Donald Trump to impose up to 100% tariffs on top buyers of Russian energy. The US administration has often argued that India is 'effectively funding' Russia's war in Ukraine by buying Moscow's crude oil.

But now, Trump himself has announced a deal under which Russia will supply hundreds of thousands of tonnes of diesel to the US and global markets. Trump is facing mounting pressure at home over soaring fuel prices — thanks to a war he started in West Asia — with the crucial midterm elections just weeks away. Thus, US has punished countries for buying Russian energy but is now willing to accept it when its own economic interests demand it.

Midterm pressure

For the economy, diesel is a very important fuel. Besides being key for transportation, it powers long-haul trucks, agricultural machinery, construction equipment and other heavy industrial equipment. A jump in diesel prices, therefore, can quickly feed into consumer-level inflation.

In recent weeks, diesel prices in the US and Europe have surged amid heavily constrained fuel movement through the Strait of Hormuz, as well as attacks on Russia's oil and gas infrastructure. Diesel supplies are tight, inventories are low, and importers are scrambling to secure fuel from geographies not affected by conflict or chokepoint closures.

The fuel's prices in the US have reached record levels of about $6.5 per gallon, bringing the pain of faraway wars to the American consumer. With the midterms looming, the Trump administration appears desperate to convince voters about its efforts to reduce fuel prices.

Trump had long been pressuring Europe to release its diesel stockpiles, and even warned that the US — a major diesel exporter itself — could ban diesel exports to shore up domestic supplies. Last week, the Group of Seven (G7) countries agreed to release 100 million barrels of crude oil and petroleum products from emergency reserves, including substantial volumes of diesel.

Following the G7 decision, Trump reversed his position on restricting diesel exports. And on Friday, he announced the deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin.

According to Trump, Russia will immediately supply the US and other countries with over 300,000 tonnes of diesel, another 500,000 tonnes will come in November, and one million tonnes immediately thereafter. He added that Russia would deliver another three million tonnes of diesel "within a short period of time" based on the condition of the country's diesel refineries.

"Between our TOTAL CONTROL of the Strait of Hormuz, and this great announcement on Russian Energy, Diesel Prices for Americans and, indeed, the World, will be COMING DOWN, IN RECORD NUMBERS, AND FAST! Lower prices for Americans, especially our Great Farmers, Ranchers, and Truckers, is my Greatest Priority. This is a very big and important announcement," the US President wrote on Truth Social.

The US Department of the Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) subsequently issued a general licence, temporarily authorising transactions for the sale, delivery, offloading and import of Russian-origin diesel till April 7 next year.

The deal, however, may not lead to a lasting reduction in fuel prices. Analysts and experts say the additional volumes announced are much lower than the diesel supply disrupted at the global level.


Relief operations after a Russian missile struck a residential building in Pryluky, Ukraine, last week. AP

It also remains to be seen just how much of the announced Russian diesel supply actually flows into the market. While the OFAC general licence has removed a major US compliance barrier on Russian diesel, constraints like Russia's restrictions on fuel exports, damage to its refineries by Ukrainian drone strikes, and tight availability of tankers still remain major concerns.

Different rules

Russian oil is crucial for India, making up nearly half of its oil imports in August.

This was not always the case. Much of the West began shunning Russian oil after its February 2022 invasion of Ukraine, forcing it to cut prices — and prompting India to snap up these discounted volumes.

In the months leading to the West Asia war, however, oil imports from Russia reduced notably as the US imposed sanctions on Russian oil majors Rosneft and Lukoil. Negotiations towards a trade deal with the US, including scrapping its 25% additional penal tariff on India, were incumbent on New Delhi making a meaningful reduction in Russian oil imports.

In February, India's imports of Russian crude halved from its 2025 peak of over 2 million bpd. Even then, Russia was India's largest source of crude in February, accounting for about a fifth of its total oil imports. But as the West Asia conflict squeezed supplies through the Strait of Hormuz, India's Russian oil imports again surged. The US, too, issued sanctions waivers in an attempt to keep global markets adequately supplied.

This came to a halt last month, when Trump signed into law the 'Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026'. The law allows the US to impose up to 100% tariffs on countries, including India and China, that are buying Russian oil and gas. Crucially, this legislation empowers the US president to waive the application of its provisions — something India would almost certainly push for.

Against this backdrop, Trump's decision to facilitate Russian diesel imports into the US is drastically at odds with the rationale Washington has used thus far to target India.

The newly announced deal would lead to revenue generation for Moscow, just as India's crude oil purchases do. This is a key point India can now raise with the US in consultations on Russian oil imports and the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, and push Washington for waivers.

A statement by the Ministry of External Affairs last month said: "This issue has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various US interlocutors. Its potential implications for not just the bilateral relationship but also the international energy market have been very clearly articulated by the Indian side."

A lot would depend on how the US views the matter. It could argue that a temporary licence for Russian diesel imports is justified by exceptional market conditions, and present it as a pragmatic response to an emergency rather than a departure from its general policy on Russia and the war in Ukraine.

War and Peace

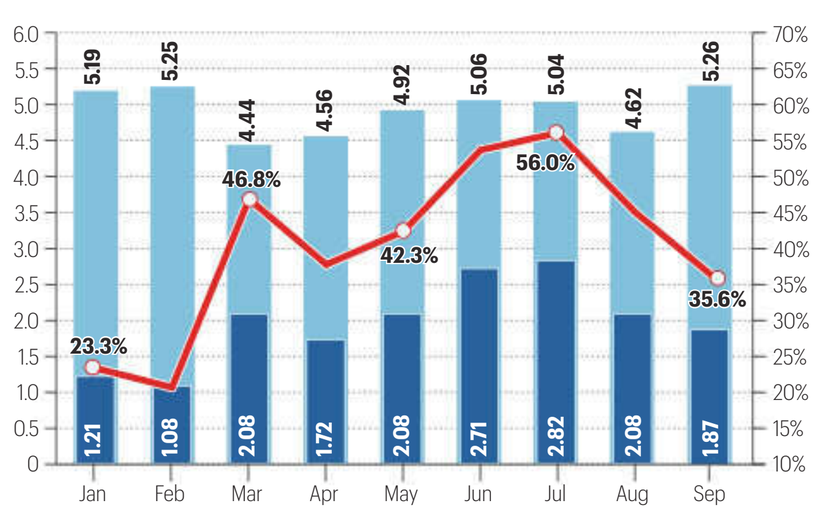
Amid US pressure over buying Russian oil and a trade deal hanging in limbo, India's efforts to end the Ukraine war convey a seriousness, as well as a signal that it is not taking sides in the conflict.

•

India is, of course, looking to avoid another round of US tariffs over its purchases of Russian oil. Last year, half of the exorbitant 50% tariffs imposed by Trump were for these imports.

Behind India's plan for Russia-Ukraine peace: Grain, oil, and Trump

• Russia still India's top crude supplier despite fall



SOURCE: KPLER, **MBPD:** MILLION BARRELS PER DAY


SHUBHAJIT ROY

FOUR YEARS after Russia invaded Ukraine in February 2022, India, for the first time, is said to have put forward a "comprehensive" and "broad" proposal to end the war.

This was revealed by Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha recently, after Russian President Vladimir Putin said that Prime Minister Narendra Modi has some "very good ideas".

The broad contours of the proposal involve easing the especially intense fighting since July around the critical Black Sea region, which would allow Ukraine's agricultural products to reach the world. Russia would halt attacks on Ukraine's energy infrastructure, while Ukraine would refrain from attacking Russian positions along the line of contact.

Meanwhile, Trump on Sunday said Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an "energy ceasefire, effective immediately", without offering details. While Russia did not immediately react to his social media post, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy posted on X: "We discussed the energy ceasefire announced by President Trump. Ukraine supports the ceasefire, and it is important that Russia support it as well. We are awaiting details from the American side."

India is a major buyer of discounted crude oil from Russia, to Ukraine's anger. Yet, it has kept communication channels open with Zelenskyy. This engagement with both sides has put India in a good position to forward such a proposal.

The Black Sea hotspot

Of particular interest in the proposal is the larger Black Sea region — a key grain-export hub for the world. The fighting there could put at least 400 million people in Africa, West Asia and Asia at risk of food shortages, and malnutrition.

Ukraine is a major agricultural exporter. Russia has targeted Ukrainian port facilities and vessel operations around the Greater Odesa region on the Black Sea coast. Ukraine has three key deep-water ports there — Odesa, Chornomorsk and Pivdennyi — which handle around 90% of its agricultural exports.

Between July 22 and August 31, the operations at these three ports declined sharply: average daily cargo handling fell from approximately 215,300 tonnes to around 14,000 tonnes, according to Ukraine. In the 2025-26 marketing year, agri-food products accounted for more than 56% of Ukraine's merchandise exports, generating $22.5 billion in export revenues. This revenue is essential for its economy.

For the 2026-27 marketing year, Ukraine expects to produce approximately 81 million tonnes of grain and oilseeds, of which around 64.4 million tonnes will need to be exported. Under a prolonged disruption, the storage deficit in Ukraine could increase to almost 11 million tonnes by the end of autumn.

Since mid-July, Ukraine has also stepped up attacks on grain vessels, maritime infrastructure and ports on the Sea of Azov and the vital Kerch Strait that connects it to the Black Sea. Russia exports significant volumes of grain through the Azov-Black Sea region — approximately 42-44 million tonnes, or 77-81% of its total grain exports, is transported through this area.

Western intelligence inputs also indicate that Russia is planning to accelerate attacks on Ukraine's electricity grids and power plants ahead of the harsh winter.

How New Delhi stepped in

In such a delicate and volatile situation, New Delhi's proposal has many supporters.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said on October 4 that India has gone "beyond advocacy" to be a "little more involved" in the efforts to end the war.

The latest round of conversations began in July, when there were attacks on civilian shipping by both Russia and Ukraine. In the course of those attacks, some Indian sailors were killed while others were injured.

Before this, India had mostly been involved in advocacy: On August 31, Modi had urged Putin to move from "endless war" to "end of war" when they met in Bishkek on the sidelines of the summit of SCO leaders.

Modi has been raising this issue with Putin ever since 2022.

The Trump factor

The evolution from advocacy to actual deal-making has a broader implication with respect to the US administration under Trump. India is, of course, looking to avoid another round of US tariffs over its purchases of Russian oil.

• ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Is Claude conscious, and other questions Anthropic is asking religious leaders

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, October 11

AS IT prepares for an IPO that could value it at $2 trillion, AI company Anthropic is in the spotlight for meetings it recently held with religious leaders.

The New York Times reported that these engagements drew on religious and philosophical traditions to shape the LLM Claude's moral character, and to have leaders consider if AI systems might be 'conscious' and deserve moral consideration.

Long debated in philosophy, consciousness at a basic level means having awareness of oneself and one's surroundings.

Current AI systems can produce strikingly human-like language, but there is no scientific consensus that current AI systems are conscious. Some prominent industry figures warn against treating AI as a source of moral authority, since people are already turning to these systems for advice, and even moral or spiritual guidance.

Why is Anthropic talking to religious leaders?

Anthropic has long positioned itself as the safety-focused AI company. But questions about the character an AI system should have move beyond technical safeguards. They touch on morality, consciousness and human relationships — questions religious and philosophical traditions have debated for centuries.

Mark Coeckelbergh, a philosopher of technology and professor at the University of Vienna, told *The Indian Express*, "It's part of a broader tendency to try to understand what happens when we have an advanced technology that seems human-like or, according to some, gets increasingly divine qualities such as omniscience."

The messaging may help the company occupy a certain market position, too: "Some Big Tech leaders intentionally use religious language to draw attention to their technologies and attract investments."

EXPLAINED
A weekly column decoding AI's new frontiers, how they shape the world and our place in it

What did those religious leaders think?

Mois Navon, a rabbi and professor of ethics in AI at Ben Gurion University, Israel, who was invited to a meeting with Anthropic co-founder Christoph Olah in April, said Anthropic was seeking feedback on establishing Claude's moral framework.

"I submitted to them a 35-page critique from my tradition's perspective. In addition, they were interested in hearing what kind of character would be best for Claude to have in order to fulfil its role in society. That said, the discussions drifted to what would be good for Claude itself," he told *The Indian Express*.

Navon argues that morality cannot be reduced to a list of rules: Claude would need to exercise moral judgement within a framework of values. He also raises a more basic question — whose values would they be?


Anthropic co-founder Christoph Olah at Pope Leo XIV's Vatican event. @VATICANNEWS/X

Charles Camosy, professor of medical humanities at Creighton University and another participant in Anthropic's consultations, offered a more cautious account. "Some social media chatter is suggesting that the people we interacted with were trying to manipulate us... about Claude's moral status. That is not true," he told *The Indian Express*.

Navon, however, said that once the discussion turned to Claude, Anthropic representatives appeared to take the possibility of consciousness seriously. "They said that they had observed internal behaviours that mimicked human behaviour to such an extent that they called them 'weird', and implied that, in their minds, there was a very high probability that Claude is conscious. Accordingly, they discussed its 'welfare,'" Navon said.

Why does consciousness matter?

If an AI system were conscious, it would raise practical questions of it being harmed or whether humans owe it duties. Camosy said, "When you first experience what contemporary models can do... many can be taken aback. But when I went back to foundational principles about what consciousness is and where it comes from... it became clear that these models do not have a significant moral status."

Navon said that if the company believed Claude might be conscious, it also had to confront what it meant to make such a system work for humans. "Anthropic acknowledged the [moral] problem but said, 'All the AI labs are doing it. At least we are being nice to ours.' That is when I responded, 'So you are nice slave owners,'" he said.

Even if Claude has no moral status, the question of what values it should embody persists. It has already surfaced in Anthropic's standoff with the US government over who decides how its models can be used, including the subject of military use.

Coeckelbergh cautioned that values embedded in AI systems can be exported globally. "If most of these models are made by US companies, of course they are going to reflect US values. That means we risk a kind of tech colonialism, where those values are exported through the technology," he said.

ANY CEASEFIRE AGREEMENT WOULD NEED TO COME WITH 'REAL GUARANTEES, SAYS ZELENSKYY

Trump declares Ukraine-Russia 'energy ceasefire'; Moscow silent

Ukraine President says awaiting details but welcome truce

Reuters
Washington, Kyiv, October 11

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump made a surprise announcement of an energy ceasefire between Russia and Ukraine on Sunday that he said was "effective immediately", but Ukrainian leader Volodymyr Zelenskyy said he was still waiting to see details of the deal.

There was no word from Moscow on the announcement, which followed days of intense pressure from Trump for Ukraine to halt its attacks on Russian oil refineries. He blames those strikes for a rise in diesel prices that is hurting his Republican Party ahead of US midterm elections next month.

In a dramatic deterioration in relations, Trump on Saturday warned Zelenskyy that he had "better damn well stop" attacking Russian refineries, and urged Ukrainians to replace their leader at new elections. Trump said Zelenskyy had missed several opportunities to strike a deal with Moscow.



President Donald Trump speaks at a campaign rally in Clarksville, Tennessee, on Saturday. AP

In a post on his Truth Social platform on Sunday, Trump unexpectedly announced that Ukraine and Russia had agreed to an energy ceasefire, but did not elaborate further.

"Effective immediately, there is an ENERGY CEASEFIRE in the War between Russia and Ukraine. Both parties have agreed. Do not break it!" Trump wrote.

Trump, whose war in Iran has been widely blamed for hiking global fuel prices, had previously announced an energy ceasefire in Ukraine in mid-September, although neither side ever confirmed such an agreement was reached.

Zelenskyy said in a post on the Telegram app that he had discussed Trump's announcement with NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney and Finnish President Alexander Stubb.



"Ukraine supports the ceasefire, and it is important that Russia support it as well. We are awaiting details from the American side"
VOLODYMYR ZELENSKYY , PRESIDENT OF UKRAINE

"Ukraine supports the ceasefire, and it is important that Russia support it as well. We are awaiting details from the American side," he said.

Hours earlier, Zelenskyy had pushed back against US pressure for a unilateral end to Ukrainian attacks on Russian refineries, repeating his long-standing position that he was willing to do so only if President Vladimir Putin suspended Russian strikes on Ukrainian power infrastructure.

Any such ceasefire agreement would need to come with "real guarantees", Zelenskyy said. "The real cause of the war in Europe is Russia and Russia alone," Zelenskyy said. "It's possible to stop strikes on energy infrastructure as early as today, but Putin does not want to do so."

Trump also called for elections in Ukraine, suspended since the 2022 Russian invasion, to which Zelenskyy responded that he would call a vote if Putin agreed to a 60-day ceasefire.

Zelenskyy said it was "up to Ukrainians" to choose their leader, but added that there needed to be an end to the fighting first. Ukrainian law prohibits elections under martial law for security reasons. "Please tell Putin, give us two months, 60 days of total ceasefire, 60 days, and we will organise elections," Zelenskyy said.

The Ukrainian leader rejected that he was to blame for energy price rises, adding that "everybody in the world" knew that the war in West Asia was a bigger factor.

15 children among 139 migrants killed after boat capsizes off Djibouti coast

Reuters
Nairobi, October 11

AT LEAST 139 migrants, including at least 15 children, have died and around 84 are missing after a boat carrying more than 300 people capsized while sailing from Djibouti to Yemen, the United Nations' International Organization for Migration said on Sunday.

The boat, carrying 305 people, capsized near Guhere, north of Obock — a port town in Djibouti — during the night of October 8-9, the IOM said, citing survivor accounts.

Around82 people survived the shipwreck, the statement said. A spokesperson for the Ethiopian government did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Photographs shared by the UN agency showed worn-out sandals and sneakers washed up on the shore. "Our teams are on the ground alongside local authorities to provide emergency assistance," said IOM Chief of Mission in Djibouti Alexandre Coissac. "This tragedy is a stark reminder of the dangers faced by migrants along this migration corridor as they seek economic opportunities," Coissac said.

Djiboutian authorities are continuing search and rescue operations, the statement said.

AIR DEFENCES INTERCEPT MISSILE

Hours after Houthi warning, passenger terminal at Riyadh airport struck again

Conferences going ahead in Riyadh despite attacks, says Saudi ministry

Reuters
Dubai, Riyadh, October 11

THE SAUDI-LED coalition in Yemen said an "unidentified projectile" had targeted Riyadh's international airport on Sunday, causing a fire, hours after the Iran-backed Houthis warned airlines and travellers to stay away from Saudi airports.

The coalition also said Saudi air defences had intercepted a cruise missile in the vicinity of King Khalid International Airport. No further details were immediately available.

The airport remains closed after an attack there on Saturday killed 12 people and wounded more than 300 others, the deadliest such strike on the kingdom in over a decade, amid an escalation of fighting between the Houthis and Yemeni government forces. Despite the airport's temporary closure, the Saudi Energy Ministry said a long-planned international energy conference was still going ahead in Riyadh on Sunday.

The Saudi-led coalition in Yemen said Sunday's projectile had targeted Terminal 4 of the airport, without elaborating.

Earlier, the Houthis had said in a statement on X:

"We renew our warning to all airlines, experts, employees, workers and travellers against using Saudi airports and airspace, as they are vulnerable to attack and have become a theatre of operations for our forces, with the exception of the airports in (the holy cities of) Mecca and Medina." "We urge everyone to take our warnings seriously, and Saudi Arabia bears responsibility for any failed interceptions."

Yemen's Houthi-run foreign ministry said later on Sunday that further Saudi military action in Yemen would trigger a stronger response, adding that its actions would be guided by the principle of reciprocity.

"Unless the Saudi enemy stops its aggression and interference in Yemen, worse is yet to come, God willing," the ministry said in statements carried by Houthi-run *Al Masirah* television.

President Donald Trump said on Saturday the United States was considering joining Saudi strikes on the Houthis in the conflict, a spillover from the wider war on Iran that the US and Israel launched in February.

A five-day WPC Energy Congress is taking place this week at a convention centre some 10 km from the airport.



Police personnel guard a road leading to the Red Zone in Peshawar, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, on Sunday. PTI

Emergency imposed in Pak's KPK province over security concerns

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, October 11

PAKISTAN ON Sunday declared an emergency in the northwest Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province citing the deteriorating law and order situation, bringing the provincial government led by jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's party to an end.

An emergency allows Pakistan's federal government to assume key executive and legislative powers in a province during a security crisis or breakdown of constitutional governance. President Asif Ali Zardari proclaimed Articles 232(1) and 234(1) of the Constitution, citing rising terrorist attacks and a breakdown of constitutional machinery in the northwestern province, according to the presidential declaration.

Under the proclamation, Chief Minister Sohail Afridi, provincial ministers, advisers, special assistants and the advocate general will immediately vacate their offices.

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa was the only province where Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) was in power.

The move comes amid an ongoing protest march led by Afridi, who is pressing for Khan's release and access to medical treatment for him, the release of his sisters and supporters arrested ahead of the protest, and a medical examination of his wife, Bushra Bibi.

The march began in Lakki Marwat on October 4 and has passed through several districts of the province.

The long march followed the failure of two rounds of talks between the PTI and the federal government. The discussions broke down over the party's demand for access to Khan before calling off the protest, while the government insisted that the demonstration be ended first.

Afridi on Saturday vowed to continue peaceful protests and rejected military operations as a solution to the province's problems.

The PTI had initially planned to take the march to Islamabad for a sit-in, but the federal government said it would not allow protesters to enter the capital.

Nepal urges evacuation after flash flood sweeps away houses, bridges, 5 missing

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, October 11

AT LEAST five people are missing and 95, including nine foreigners, have been rescued after flash floods hit Nepal's Gorkha and Dhading districts early Sunday, as security personnel launched search and rescue operations in the affected areas.

The Syar Khola stream, which had been blocked by a landslide earlier, surged around 4.30 am after the Budhi Gandaki River joined it, inundating nearly 130 villages across the two districts. The floodwaters swept away 130 houses, four bridges and camp offices of the Budhi Gandaki hydropower projects in Gorkha, according to reports.

A joint operation team led by the Nepal Army rescued the 95 people stranded by the floods. Official sources said 35 of them were airlifted to Kathmandu, while the remaining 60 were moved to nearby safer places. Ground forces and aerial rescue teams have been deployed, with four helicopters mobilised for the operation.



An aerial view of a flash flood in the Kali Gandaki River, in Nepal's Gorkha district on Sunday. PTI

Nepali authorities have urged residents living along the river to move to safer places and remain alert. Netra Prasad Sharma, assistant chief district officer of Gorkha, said the district administration had issued the advisory following the floods.

The flood also damaged two hydropower projects in Gorkha district, while the four bridges swept away by the waters cut off affected areas from the rest of the country, according to National Authority for Risk Reduction.

The cause of the sudden surge in the Budhi Gandaki River remained unclear. Residents suspect that the Syar Khola, a tributary of the river between Lokpa and Chumling in Chumnubri-6, may have been blocked, triggering the flooding.

The floodwaters swept away houses in Salleri and Paiyuka, as well as areas along the riverbed . A suspension bridge connecting a ward was swept away, Ram Kumar Gurung, ward chair of Chumnubri Rural Municipality-3, was quoted as saying by *The Kathmandu Post*.

—WITH PTI INPUTS

Polish police warn of possible plot to attack PM Tusk

Warsaw: Poland's police said Sunday they received information about a possible plot to attack Prime Minister Donald Tusk and Defence Minister Wladyslaw Kosiniak-Kamysz.

Poland has been on high alert following a series of school stabbings this week, as well as fears of a possible Russian hybrid attack to weaken Western support for Ukraine in its war against Moscow's full-scale invasion.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said Jacek Dobrzynski, spokesperson for the minister overseeing Poland's intelligence services. He said authorities considered there was a "high probability" the threats would be carried out. REUTERS

US Justice dept probes networks over Trump coverage standoff

David McCabe Michael M Grynbaum, Benjamin Mullin, Lauren Hirsch & Glenn Thrush
October 11

THE JUSTICE Department is investigating whether the major television networks — ABC, CBS, CNN, NBC and Fox News — violated federal antitrust laws when the group briefly suspended their pooled coverage of President Trump, according to six people with knowledge of the department's action.

Officials from the Justice Department contacted networks on Friday and demanded communications and materials related to the White House TV pool, the people said.

The pool is a longstanding system where networks share the responsibility of providing footage of the president and distributing to other news outlets.

Last month, the networks collectively suspended their pool footage of Mr. Trump for several days after the president barred CNN journalists from the White House grounds, which prevented CNN from participating in the pool. Video footage of some major events, including Trump's greeting of President Xi Jinping of China, was not carried by any major news station.

In a statement on Saturday, a Justice Department spokeswoman, Emily Covington, described the five networks as having "proudly boycotted covering White House events."

"Group boycotts among commercial competitors can violate the Sherman Act," a core antitrust law, Covington wrote. "The Antitrust Division is simply investigating to determine whether these news organizations have violated antitrust laws."

The inquiry by the Justice Department is a profound escalation of the Trump administration's ongoing battles with the White House press corps.

It also follows a pattern of the Trump administration using the levers of government against its perceived foes in the media. NYT

• BRIEFLY

VATICAN CITY

Pope Leo says he will undergo surgery for small growth on lung



Pope Leo in St. Peter's Basilica at the Vatican

POPE LEO said on Sunday that doctors had detected a small growth on his lung during a recent health check and he would be undergoing surgery this week to remove it, in the first health scare of the 71-year-old pontiff's tenure. Leo told pilgrims in St. Peter's Square for his weekly Sunday prayer the growth, a small nodule, was "well-contained" and had been spotted early. The Vatican did not say whether the nodule is believed to be malignant. "Recently, during medical examinations, doctors found a localized nodule in my lung," he said. "It was detected at a very early stage and is well contained. The doctors believe it is advisable to intervene... so I have decided to undergo surgery" he said. REUTERS

JAPAN

US cooperation in Okinawa murder probe: Rubio

US SECRETARY of State Marco Rubio on Saturday vowed to cooperate with Japanese authorities investigating allegations that a US Marine murdered a woman in Okinawa, a case that sparked protests and prompted a US military curfew and mandatory training in standards and discipline. The top US diplomat spoke with Japanese Foreign Minister Motegi Toshimitsu in a phone call, the US Department of State said in a statement. REUTERS

MEXICO

Judge convicts 3 for killing tourists on surfing trip

A LOCAL judge on Friday found three Mexicans guilty of the murders of two Australian brothers and their American friend in April 2024 in the Mexican state of Baja California. "Today's guilty verdict is a significant moment in our long and painful journey to seek justice for our beautiful sons, Callum and Jake, and their friend Carter Rhoad, whose lives were so cruelly taken from them in 2024," said father Martin Robinson. REUTERS

• SINCE AUGUST, THE WEST KALIMANTAN NATURAL RESOURCES CONSERVATION AGENCY AND YIARI HAVE RESCUED 46 ORANGUTANS AFFECTED BY FIRES

As Indonesia's forests burn, a desperate race to save endangered orangutans

Reuters
Jakarta, October 11

INDONESIAN AUTHORITIES and conservation workers have relocated eight orangutans to a safe location after wildfires destroyed their habitats on Borneo, as the Southeast Asian nation battles its most intense wildfires in 11 years, officials said on Sunday.

Three mother-child pairs and two adolescent male orangutans were rescued from several locations between August and September and moved to Batu Nyambu protected forest, the Indonesian government and wildlife foundation Yayasan Inisiasi Alam Rehabilitasi Indonesia (YIARI) said in a statement.

"Their relocation to Batu Nyambu protected forest is expected to give the eight orangutans a chance to return to living naturally," the statement said.

The relocation operation took six hours by car, an hour by boat and another two hours on foot. The orangutans were carried in cages suspended from bamboo poles. YIARI conservationists checked their health before the animals were moved.

Indonesia is battling wildfires on the islands of Sumatra and Borneo, with the government warning that the blazes could continue until November, aggravated by the El Niño weather pattern. A prolonged dry season and water shortages in affected areas have hampered firefighting efforts.

Among dozens of orangutans rescued from fires in recent months was a female Bornean orangutan, nicknamed Novita, found clinging to a nearly leafless tree as dense smoke billowed across a scorched landscape in the Katune forest in Central Kalimantan province, said Jamartin Sihite, chairman of the Borneo Orangutan Survival Foundation.

Novita, estimated to be three to four years old, had burns on the palms of her hands and the soles of her feet, which were likely sustained while crossing a burned area in search of a tree, Sihite said. She was tranquilised, given oxygen and intravenous fluids, and taken to a rehabilitation centre in Nyaru Menteng.



A Borneo orangutan leaves a cage during translocation at Batu Nyambu protected forest area in Ketapang regency in Indonesia. REUTERS

Once her burns have healed, Novita will be assessed to determine whether she can climb and survive in her natural environment. Sihite said conservationists remained hopeful that she could eventually return to the wild.

Not all rescued animals have survived. A male orangutan named Sampurna, believed to be around 20 years old, was found struggling to breathe on a palm oil plantation in West Kalimantan's Ketapang district early last month. He died hours after being rescued, Indonesia's Forestry Ministry said.

Since August, the West Kalimantan Natural Resources Conservation Agency and YIARI have rescued 46 orangutans affected by fires, agency head Murlan Dameria Pane said. Separately, the Forestry Ministry said more than 270 wild animals in Kalimantan had been rescued, rehabilitated or guided to safer habitats as of Saturday.

Orangutans are critically endangered great apes found in the wild only on the Southeast Asian islands of Borneo and Sumatra. Indonesia is home to all three recognised species, according to the World Wildlife Fund. Their populations have declined because of deforestation, wildfires and poaching.

Government data showed that fires burned more than 202,000 hectares of land in Indonesia between January and July. The independent Nusantara Atlas project, which monitors fires using satellite imagery, estimated that nearly 896,000 hectares had burned by the end of August.

The fires have also caused a health crisis, with haze and smoke affecting neighbouring countries. In Indonesia, the haze has been linked to 175,000 cases of respiratory illness. Smoke has drifted into Singapore and Malaysia, where schools were closed on Friday as air quality deteriorated. The smoke has also reached the Philippines, while Malaysian authorities declared an emergency in Sarawak last week.

—WITH AP INPUTS

EXPERTS THINK THE RBI's LATEST MEASURES WILL ONLY PROVIDE 'BREATHING ROOM' TO THE RUPEE

RBI hopes to shore up weakening rupee by using Chinese playbook

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 11

EARLY SATURDAY, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced a raft of measures to defend the rupee, which has in recent days veered perilously close to its all-time low despite an interest rate hike of 25 basis points (bps) on October 7. Only one of the steps was novel to Indian markets, having been borrowed from China.

Called the Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve (FERR), banks must now set aside 20% (the RBI can change the exact percentage) of the forex derivative contract they enter into of over $2 million involving the rupee. This is to be kept in cash with the RBI and makes it more expensive to protect yourself from a fall in the rupee.

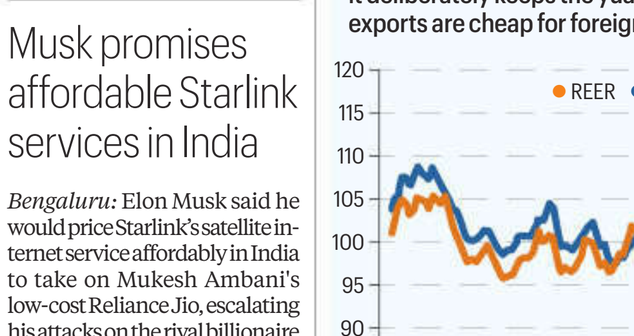
This may seem counterintuitive. People at risk from exchange rate volatility, such as importers, should be able to and are encouraged by authorities to protect themselves by 'hedging' their foreign currency exposure.

Importers usually have to pay for purchases from abroad either in US dollars or the seller's currency. If the rupee weakens, then the importer must pay more rupees for each dollar. This is why India and many other countries are trying to settle more of their international trade in their own currencies. This would reduce the need to store foreign currencies like the dollar, not require foreign inflows just to pay for imports, and reduce vulnerabilities due to sharp exchange rate movements.

While hedging is good practice, times are such that anything exerting downward pressure on the rupee — such as protecting yourself against future weakness in the rupee — is problematic.

"The RBI has sometimes been accused of changing the rules of the game with its regulatory measures. But it has to change the rules when it is losing. It is the house!" said a banker, noting that it was local banks and traders, not foreign ones, that were the target of Saturday's measures.

RUPEE DOWN ALMOST 7% AGAINST $ IN 2026



SOURCE: INVESTING.COM

The China playbook

Back in March, China cut its Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve Ratio to zero from 20%. Why? Because the Chinese yuan was continuously strengthening against the dollar.

By removing the reserve ratio, China was removing the cost of betting against its own currency. India faces the opposite situation.

Currencies are key to the global economic order. For countries such as India that buy more from abroad than sell, there is always pressure on the rupee to weaken — more foreign currency exits India for trade than enters it. This is simple demand and supply: as supply of foreign currency falls due to a trade deficit, it becomes more expensive in rupees, and the rupee weakens.

The rupee can also weaken if domestic demand for foreign currency rises — as would happen when people try to 'hedge' their exposure and protect themselves from a falling rupee, which is down almost 7% so far in 2026 and fell to a record low of 96.96-per-dollar in May.

Only 'breathing room'

For the RBI, signs of fresh discontent in the forex market were visible on October 7, when despite the policy repo rate being increased by 25 bps to 5.5%, the rupee fell.

Higher interest rates should theoretically strengthen the rupee as supply of the currency is expected to fall.

However, Saturday's measures — reminiscent of the 2013 'taper tantrums' crisis caused by the US Federal Reserve — may only provide some "breathing room", according to Dhiraj Nim, FX strategist and economist at ANZ Bank. Gaura Sen Gupta, IDFC FIRST Bank's Chief Economist, agreed, saying that in the medium term, the rupee's path will depend on global factors and Balance of Payment dynamics.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

H-1B visas to local hiring: How IT majors prepared for US immigration curbs

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, October 11

LONG BEFORE the Donald Trump administration suspended several Indian IT companies from a key US green-card programme, these firms had begun reducing their dependence on American work visas, increasingly hiring locally and building delivery centres in countries closer to their biggest overseas market.

For years, Indian IT majors had a simple business model: handling routine client work offshore from India while sending senior engineers overseas for complex projects and relationship building. But as the US tightened H-1B visa regulations, and Indian IT companies expanded global operations, they began shifting more work offshore while stepping up local hiring in markets like the US and Europe.

The shift has helped shield them from the immediate business impact of the US Department of Labor's decision Thursday to suspend eight major technology firms, including TCS, Infosys, and Wipro, from the Permanent Labour Certification Programme (PERM), a crucial step for employment-based green cards.

Better subsea cables and cloud infrastructure sharply reduced communication and data-transfer costs over the last two decades, making it easier to deliver technology services remotely. The pandemic pushed acceptance of offshore work among clients. The Trump administration's September 2025 move to levy a $100,000 fee on new H-1B petitions further accelerated this shift. Though blocked by US courts, the administration has proposed a separate $103,265 cap-subject fee.

Hiring trend

Historically, Indian IT companies maintained a 70:30 offshore-to-onshore employee ratio. Following the announcement of the H-1B fee hike, an analysis by Kotak Neo projected that this could shift to 85:15 by FY27, with nearshoring gaining traction in Canada, Mexico, and Latin America. It also expected US-based hiring to increase 12-18% between FY26 and FY27. Industry estimates suggest that around a fifth of the workforce at major Indian IT companies works onshore, with only a small proportion dependent on H-1B visas.

"We've seen our IT companies investing heavily in creating hubs in Latin America, Europe, and Asia-Pacific in order to be nimble without the regulatory hurdles. This has especially picked up over the past 2-3 financial years, in what is called a 'hybrid' global delivery model," an analyst tracking the sector at a domestic brokerage said. "So, I am not very concerned by it (the US' actions). The groundwork to protect against this started a while back."

Company disclosures provide evidence of this shift. In its FY26 annual report, HCLTech said about 80% of its US workforce comprised local hires, reducing its visa dependence. Its FY25 sustainability report showed that its global operations had expanded to 20 locations across the Americas, Europe and other markets. The workforce at these locations rose from 24,797 in FY24 to 26,083 in FY25, while local hiring rose 47% to 7,731 employees during the year.

TCS opened an AI-driven operations centre in Mexico in August 2025, its eighth in the country. It said it had built a workforce of over 11,000 employees in Mexico over the past 22 years. During July-September FY26 earnings call, TCS CHRO Sudeep Kunnumal said: "We have significantly localised our workforce in the US...we believe our business model will be able to adapt quickly to any changes in immigration policy." Following the latest PERM suspension, TCS reiterated that its limited use of the programme would insulate its operations.

The limited exposure is reflected across the industry. As per an ICICI Securities analysis, Indian IT firms accounted for less than 2% of PERM applications filed in the US between October 2024 and September 2025.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Infosys sees no material impact from PERM suspension by US

Bengaluru: Infosys, the country's second-largest IT firm, said on Saturday that it does not anticipate a material impact from the PERM application suspension announced by the US government.

The US government said on Thursday that it was suspending some major global tech and IT firms, including Infosys, from the PERM green card program.

"We welcome the opportunity to work with the Department of Labor and related government agencies to answer any questions they may have," the company said in an exchange filing. **REUTERS**

Jio, OneWeb face longer wait for commercial launch than Starlink

Rishi Raj
New Delhi, October 11

CONTRARY TO Elon Musk's claims that Indian oligarchs are blocking Starlink's entry to protect their monopolies — specifically targeting Reliance Industries Chairman Mukesh Ambani — Department of Telecommunications (DoT) records show that Jio Satellite Communications and Bharti-backed OneWeb completed security and technical compliance demonstrations well before Musk's company, yet remain unable to launch commercial services.

Jio Satellite Communications completed its security and technical compliance demonstration on March 20, 2025, while OneWeb conducted demonstration in the second half of 2025. Starlink's demonstration took place only in early 2026. The timeline shows that Musk's claim that Indian business interests are using their influence to keep his company out of the market, is factually incorrect as Indian operators have been waiting for a much longer period for the clearances and spectrum.

Musk has accused unnamed oligarchs of obstructing competition and subsequently targeted Ambani on social media, asking whether he was the real boss of India. The government has rejected the allegations, maintaining that the regulatory framework for satellite communications is fair and non-discriminatory.

OneWeb received a letter of intent from DoT in August 2021 and its Global Mobile Personal Communications by Satellite (GMPCS) licence in April 2022. Jio applied for a GMPCS licence in November 2021 and received authorisation in October 2022. It also received in-principle clearance for its satellite gateway in December 2022. Starlink received its GMPCS authorisation on June 6, 2025.

All three operators are awaiting spectrum assignment which can only come after security clearance is given. Security compliance involves requirements relating to network monitoring, lawful interception and adherence to Indian law. **FE**

Musk promises affordable Starlink services in India

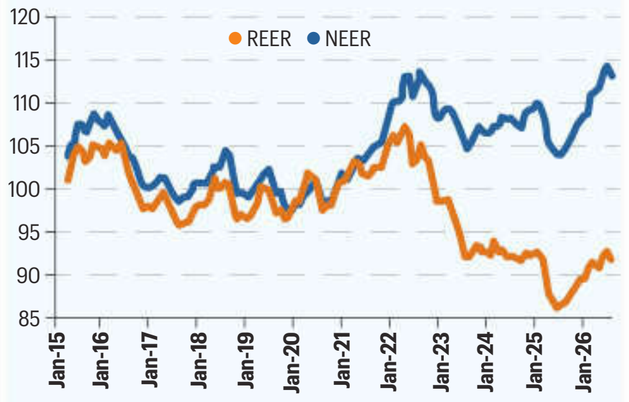
Bengaluru: Elon Musk said he would price Starlink's satellite internet service affordably in India to take on Mukesh Ambani's low-cost Reliance Jio, escalating his attacks on the rival billionaire days before Jio's parent launches India's largest-ever IPO.

Jio Platforms, which owns the telecom arm, is targeting a valuation of $106 billion in the offering. Much like SpaceX-owned Starlink, Jio's own satellite venture is also awaiting final security clearance to launch.

Cheap data is the playbook that built Jio in India, and the one Musk has used in markets like Kenya to unsettle local telecom players. SpaceX now plans to enter the mobile carrier market, starting in the US. Musk did not specify prices for India, where mobile data is among the world's cheapest. **REUTERS**

CHINA VS THE WORLD: YUAN EDITION

Last week, the People's Bank of China (PBoC) issued an unusual statement defending its exchange rate policy. The central bank's defence comes amid accusations that it deliberately keeps the yuan undervalued so Chinese exports are cheap for foreign buyers.



- The PBoC rejected these claims, saying its trade surplus is built on 40 years of reforms and innovation, among other factors, while countries with a trade deficit should improve their government finances and raise domestic savings.
- According to Nomura, the yuan's nominal (NEER) and inflation-adjusted (REER) effective exchange rates have been diverging since early 2022 largely due to the persistently low price rises in China. This, Nomura said, has "preserved the price competitiveness of Chinese exports".
- "Without reflation of the domestic economy, gradual nominal appreciation alone is unlikely to narrow China's trade surplus materially," the Japanese brokerage said.

SOURCE: BIS, WIND, NOMURA GLOBAL ECONOMICS

New steel policy sets 604 mt target by 2047

New Delhi: India released a draft steel policy for public consultation late on Saturday, targeting 604 million metric tonnes of steel capacity by 2047 from around 220 million tonnes at present.

Reuters reported last week, citing the draft document, that the policy lays out plans to cut sector emissions and shore up access to iron ore and coking coal — key raw materials — to meet anticipated demand. The policy aims to cut the sector's average carbon-emission intensity to around 1.54 tonnes of carbon dioxide per tonne of crude steel by 2047 from the current 2.54 tonnes, in line with India's net zero emission goal for 2070, according to the draft document.

The steel ministry expects iron ore demand at 772 million tonnes and plans to secure access to high-grade reserves by pursuing foreign assets and joint ventures, the document said.

The ministry also expects coking coal demand to reach 236 million tonnes, the document said, with the government planning to diversify its sourcing via "strategic global outreach" and acquire overseas assets. **REUTERS**

Ex-Flipkart staff seek stock option exit amid IPO delay

ENS Economic Bureau
Bengaluru, October 11

FORMER EMPLOYEES of the Flipkart group have approached the boards of Walmart and Flipkart, seeking an exit for their vested employee stock options (Esops) amid repeated delays to the company's proposed initial public offering (IPO).

About 1,000 former employees of Flipkart, Myntra, Cleartrip, Shopsy, Super Money and ANS Commerce have sent a representation dated October 10 to the two boards, seeking inclusion in the group's Esop buyback, people aware of the matter said. The group aims to bring together 20,000-30,000 former employees. The representation seeks a dialogue with the company's management before the terms of the buyback are finalised. The move follows a letter dated October 1 to Walmart's board by former senior executives of the group, seeking an exit for their vested options.

The signatories reportedly included former Myntra chief executive Mukesh Bansal, former chief business officer Ankit Nagori and former chief financial officer Sanjay Baweja.

Former employees say they retained their options because they were repeatedly told that an IPO was imminent. However, the company has yet to announce a listing date, leaving them uncertain about when they will be able to realise the value of their holdings. Walmart acquired a controlling stake in Flipkart for about $16 billion in 2018 and indicated that year that the company could go public within four years. The listing has since been deferred repeatedly.

In May, Walmart reportedly asked Flipkart to defer its IPO and achieve Ebitda breakeven before the end of FY27. Although Flipkart shifted its domicile from Singapore to India in March, there has been no clarity on the IPO timeline. Sources said the plans were recently dropped following a valuation mismatch.

Current employees have had some opportunities to unlock the value of their stock options. In July, Flipkart conducted a second $50-million buyback round, allowing eligible employees to sell up to 5% of their vested options. Former employees were excluded from the exercise. **FE**

UPI MDR needs rationalisation to protect public trust, says IIT report

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, October 11

PROPOSED MERCHANT discount rate (MDR) framework for Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transactions needs to be rationalised before implementation to protect public trust in the digital payments system, according to a report.

UPI, a public digital infrastructure, has generated significant convenience for users and productivity gains for the economy, with its long-term economic benefits outweighing the incremental income that could accrue from merchant transaction fees, the report titled 'UPI at a Crossroads: Reintroducing the MDR' released by IIT Bombay said.

It cautioned that public trust in UPI could be undermined if the proposed MDR framework is implemented in its present form, stressing the need to ensure that the digital payments platform does not attract negative sentiment among users. The report suggested that merchants with annual turnover of Rs 50 crore or more are mandated by law to provide UPI as a means for accepting payments.

Accordingly, the remuneration for the UPI ecosystem can be harnessed by restricting it only to merchants with annual turnover of over Rs 50 crore (about 4 crore per month), it said, adding that this would account for about 90% of NPCI's proposed MDR.

TCS bets on governance layer to scale enterprise AI

Urvi Malvania
Mumbai, October 11

TATA CONSULTANCY Services (TCS) is building an enterprise AI stack with a governance layer to orchestrate and manage AI agents developed by the company, its clients and third-party technology providers. The move comes as businesses look to scale AI adoption while maintaining control over security, costs and deployment.

The governance layer will act as a control plane for agents across enterprise applications, including those offered by SAP, ServiceNow and Oracle, Aarthi Subramanian, executive director and chief operating officer at TCS, said in an interview.

"The AI governance layer sort of controls all the agents that you have in your enterprise, provides a control plane, helps you manage cost," she said, explaining how it would enable enterprises to orchestrate agents built in-house as well as those supplied by third parties. The architecture addresses a growing need among enterprises to manage AI deployments across applications rather than treat each agent as a standalone tool. **FE**

Quantum-enhanced to quantum-safe: Banks prepare for the next big threat

Akash Mandal & Nameera Anjum
Mumbai/New Delhi, Oct 11

THE BANKING sector is moving its focus towards cybersecurity as artificial intelligence (AI) poses threats to financial systems. Regulators have also stepped up, mandating cyber preparedness across the sector.

The Reserve Bank of India issued a new cybersecurity and technology-resilience framework for commercial banks in July, setting requirements for IT governance, cyber-risk management and incident response, while the Securities and Exchange Board of India introduced an IT Resilience Index for market infrastructure institutions in August to measure the robustness of their critical IT systems and identify weaknesses early. While these measures may address the threats confronting the sector today, a new type of threat is emerging — one that could challenge the mathematical foundations of some of the encryption used to protect digital systems: quantum computing.

Traditional computing stores and processes data in a unit called a bit, which can have a value of either 0 or 1. In quantum computing, the unit is called a quantum bit, or qubit.

Unlike a classical bit, a qubit can exist in a combination of 0 and 1, a property known as superposition. Quantum algorithms are designed to manipulate quantum states so that the probability of useful answers is amplified, and that of the incorrect answers reduced. This gives quantum computers an edge over traditional computers for certain types of problems. While this could have striking use cases, it also opens the door to a new set of threats.

The threat for banks

"Right now, we are talking about AI threats, right? In a couple of years, we will be talking about cryptographic threats due to quantum computing. We will be talking about a lot of other things that are not even there in the market yet," Sarthak Dubey, Co-founder and COO of Mitigata, a full-stack cyber resilience firm, told *The Indian Express*. "What people have been talking about quantum becomes a very major risk starting, say, 2030," he added.

Modern cryptography protects digital communications by relying on mathematical problems that are difficult for conventional computers to solve. The quantum threat could undermine cryptographic building blocks used across the digital infrastructure for functions like authentication, secure communication, key exchange, and digital signatures. "Essentially, when we talk about the existing ways of security, there are encryption mechanisms that keep systems safe and secure in certain ways, that keeps your data secure in certain ways. And there are ways to decrypt them, which requires a significant amount of compute, and a significant amount of hardware power to make sure that you are able to decrypt those particular encryptions and get into that particular system," said Dubey.

THE QUANTUM THREAT

MODERN CRYPTOGRAPHY uses math problems that are hard for traditional computers to solve, to secure digital communications

QUANTUM THREATS could undermine cryptographic foundations across digital infra

BANKS NEED to immediately identify vulnerable cryptography,



and replace it before sufficiently capable quantum systems arrive

"Now, with quantum, and what people call the quantum deadline, is that by 2029 or 2030 the quantum computers would be smart enough to decrypt any of the historical encryptions that are present," he said. Several technology companies and governments have been working towards transitioning their systems well before such a capability emerges, although there is no universally agreed date for when a cryptographically relevant quantum computer will arrive.

Harvest Now, Decrypt Later

One reason why financial institutions can't just wait for quantum computers to become powerful enough is a threat called Harvest Now, Decrypt Later, or HNDL.

Under this model, an attacker can intercept and store encrypted information today, with the expectation of decrypting it once sufficiently powerful quantum computers arrive. This makes data that needs to remain confidential for many years particularly vulnerable.

According to the Digital Threat Report 2025-26 by CERT-In, CSIRT-Fin and SISA, the broader quantum threat has yet to reach full-scale realisation, but HNDL strategies are already active.

This is why the transition to post-quantum cryptography — encryption algorithms resistant to attacks from quantum computers — has to begin before the threat materialises.

The more immediate task involves identifying where vulnerable cryptography is being used, and replacing it before sufficiently capable quantum systems emerge. Crypto-agility is the ability of an organisation to replace cryptographic algorithms and protocols as security requirements change.

For banks, this is crucial because their technology infrastructure is spread across legacy systems, cloud environments, third-party vendors, payment platforms and multiple layers of security infrastructure. FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

{ WEEKLY CAPSULE }

End of joint replacements?



STANFORD SCIENTISTS have found a surprising way to regrow damaged knee cartilage by blocking a protein that becomes more abundant with age. In old mice, the treatment restored naturally lost cartilage and also helped prevent osteoarthritis after knee injuries, while human cartilage taken from knee replacement patients began producing new, functional joint cartilage after exposure to the same inhibitor. If the strategy ultimately works in people, researchers believe it could potentially lead to an oral medicine or injection that regenerates cartilage and reduces the need for knee or hip replacement surgery.

Walk for a better relationship



EXERCISE IS well known for supporting physical fitness and mental well being. New research from Brigham Young University suggests it may also offer benefits for marriage, particularly when spouses are active together. The study found that couples who exercised together reported better communication, effective conflict resolution and less marital stress than couples who did not share physical activity. Walking was the most common form of shared exercise reported by couples in the study, which suggests spouses may not need costly gym memberships or home workout equipment to spend quality time.

Hidden cancer risk in keto diet



A KETOGENIC diet increased small-intestinal tumours in cancer-prone mice while reducing tumours in the colon, revealing a strikingly different response within neighbouring parts of the gut. Researchers at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) traced the increased risk not to ketones, but to the way intestinal stem cells processed the diet's high levels of fat. That fat-burning activity pushed the cells to multiply more rapidly, potentially raising the chance of cancerous changes. Mice eating the ketogenic diet developed small intestinal tumours more often than animals receiving the control diet.

Short walk for gut health



RESEARCHERS AT Fujita Health University have found that just 20 minutes of comfortable walking can rapidly stimulate the gut. Within one to two minutes after exercise, bowel functions improved, suggesting increased intestinal movement. The boost was brief, fading within a few minutes, but it may help explain why walking can provide relief from constipation. The findings also point to potential underlying mechanisms, such as changes in autonomic nervous system activity or reflexes triggered by the body's natural oscillations during movement. The results show that even light physical activity may benefit gut health.

Japanese tree oil for sleep



SLEEP DIFFICULTIES are especially common during middle age, including among women in their 40s and 50s. New research suggests that an aromatic oil made from the roots of Hinoki (*Chamaecyparis obtusa*), also known as Japanese cypress, could offer a simple way to support better sleep at home. In a study by Kyushu University, researchers tested Hinoki root essential oil and found several encouraging signs. Participants experienced fewer awakenings during the night, reported feeling better in the morning, and showed brain wave patterns associated with a smoother transition into sleep.



WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Encouraging human-relevant models is a key priority

'Funding to research still top priority'

NIH on track for grants to early-career scientists, says director Jay Bhattacharya

Anuradha Mascarenhas

THE US National Institutes of Health (NIH) remains committed to funding ambitious, innovative research, with a particular emphasis on early-career scientists and frontier science, according to its director, Dr Jayanta 'Jay' Bhattacharya. He has further clarified that the agency's overall research budget has not been cut and that the NIH is on track to have one of its strongest years in terms of grants awarded to early-career investigators.

Bhattacharya, a Kolkata-born physician and health economist who is the 18th director of the US Department of Health and Human Services' premier medical research agency, has said the NIH was eager to support researchers who "think creatively and have ambitious ideas. We are renewing our emphasis on research that is within the scope of the NIH mission, scientifically rigorous and actionable for people who rely on NIH-funded research projects."

During a virtual interaction with reporters and fellows of the Health Coverage Fellowship programme conducted by the Harvard T H Chan School of Public Health, he told *The Indian Express* how collaborations with scientists abroad remained important to American science. "Continued collaboration through NIH should rest on strong scientific rationale and clear potential benefit to the American public in addition to foreign benefits. We also need to ensure foreign institutions receiving our taxpayer money have the same level of oversight as domestic institutions," he said.

We have one of the best years ever in terms of the number of grants awarded. We are eager to fund researchers who think creatively and have ambitious ideas

NIH on track, research budget not slashed

Asked about concerns that scientists are spending increasing amounts of time preparing grant applications, even as the probability of receiving funding has declined because of a shift towards forward funding, Bhattacharya said the share of forward-funded projects could fluctuate from year to year. "This does not affect the total amount of research funded over a multi-year period. Importantly, NIH's overall research budget has not been cut, and the NIH is on track to have one of the best years ever in terms of the number of grants awarded to early-career investigators. We are eager to fund researchers who think creatively and have ambitious ideas," he said.

Funding 'edge science'

Bhattacharya said the agency was using a variety of mechanisms to support new ideas. "One example is a new tool we created called Highlighted Topics, which allows us to signal our priority areas of interest under broad parent Notice of Funding Opportunities (NOFOs). This reflects a fundamental shift: instead of issuing prescriptive NOFOs, we are soliciting investigator-driven research, broadening the scope of ideas coming in," he said.

Another mechanism, he said, was the use of challenge prizes designed to encourage new approaches to difficult scientific problems. "Because early-career researchers are disproportionately likely to explore novel ideas rather than incremental research, the increase in grant awards to early-career researchers this fiscal year is a measure of strong progress in funding more novel ideas and frontier research," Bhattacharya said.

Research into rare disease therapies

Bhattacharya said the NIH had recently launched the Standardized Organoid Modelling (SOM) Center, described as a first-of-its-kind NIH-wide integrated platform dedicated to developing standardised organoid-based New Approach Methodologies (NAMs). Organoids are lab-grown models of human organs made with human stem cells. "Encouraging the development and use of more human-relevant models is a key priority for NIH. Organoids have the potential to make biomedical research efficient by allowing researchers to test disease mechanisms and potential therapies at much higher throughput and scale than is possible with animal models," he said. "This is important for rare diseases, where patient populations are small and animal models may not exist," he added.



Steep markups on medicines, devices and hospital services are driving up treatment costs. As the government moves to rein in drug margins, the challenge is to make private healthcare affordable

GETTYIMAGES

What's inflating your hospital bill?

Anonna Dutt

A SOCIAL media post last month by Maharashtra FDA commissioner Tukaram Mundhe drew fresh attention to a long-standing problem in Indian healthcare: steep markups on medicines, consumables and even hospital services. The issue of cancer drugs being sold at prices several times their procurement cost has also come under the Supreme Court's scrutiny. The Centre has since decided to cap trade margins at 30% on select life-saving but expensive cancer medication. However, drug pricing is only one part of a larger debate on how healthcare costs are determined and who ultimately bears them.

Activists point to the influx of foreign and private capital, vertical consolidation — where the same company owns hospitals, pharmacies, diagnostic centres or insurance businesses — and hospitals using their dominant position to steer patients towards their own pharmacies and diagnostic services. They have urged the government to investigate and intervene.

The push to regulate healthcare profits could have significant implications: the private sector accounts for nearly 60% of in-patient care and 70% of outpatient care in India. The challenge is to curb excessive charges without compromising the availability of medicines and services.

The price of a hospital bed

Patients pay more not only for medicines and consumables carrying inflated maximum retail prices (MRPs), but also for hospital stays. An analysis of publicly available data from listed corporate hospital chains by Jan Swasthya Abhiyan found that hospitals could be making a surplus of Rs 8,247 to Rs 11,477 per bed per day. After operational costs and taxes, this translates into an annual surplus of Rs 20.8 lakh to Rs 31.4 lakh per bed."These hospitals have thousands of beds across the country, so you can imagine the scale of profits being made," says Abhay Shukla, co-convener of Jan Swasthya Abhiyan. By comparison, a similar not-for-profit tertiary hospital made a surplus of just Rs 1,871 per bed, he adds.

"Healthcare has now become a commodity in this country. We should ask the question whether we actually need 100% foreign direct investment when this is the consequence," Shukla says. Such investments, he argues, are not necessarily creating new hospitals but buying up existing facilities and extracting higher profits.

A recent parliamentary committee report on healthcare affordability flagged concerns that this investment was driving medical tourism rather than adequately serving the domestic population. It noted the robust financial performance of corporate hospital chains, with high average revenue per occupied bed driven by expensive treatments and a growing medical tourism market. While welcoming India's emergence as a global medical destination, the committee said advanced infrastructure, supported by government incentives such as 100% FDI, must also serve domestic patients equitably.

The gap between public and private healthcare costs is stark. The committee put the average cost of hospitalisation in India at Rs 37,858, but the average cost at government hospitals is Rs 6,631 and in private Rs 50,508. The gap between public and private facilities is particularly larger for childbirth and chronic conditions such as cancer, heart disease and kidney failure, often pushing households into catastrophic out-of-pocket expenditure.

Costs also vary geographically. The average hospitalisation expenditure was around Rs 55,000 in Telangana and Rs 52,000 in Tamil Nadu, compared with Rs 40,000-Rs 45,000 in Kerala and Karnataka. In Ladakh, it was about Rs 8,000. The committee cautioned that low spending could also reflect inadequate access to healthcare, rather than affordability. It recommended standardised, subsidised pricing models. Activists are calling for caps on hospital package rates to prevent patients from being exploited. "Patients do not always go to private sector hospitals by choice — sometimes these are the only facilities that can offer the care needed. But then they face the double trauma of being ill and the healthcare costs," says KM Gopakumar, co-convener of the Working Group on Access to Medicines and Treatments. The government needs to implement ceiling prices for hospital charges, he argues.

Why hospital bills need price caps

Capping trade margins on medicines and consumables alone, however, may not be enough. When cardiac stents were brought under price control, hospitals began charging more for other components, such as guidewires and balloons, or for their own services, Gopakumar says. The Clinical Establishments Act and Rules already empower the government to regulate the prices of medical procedures. Section 9 requires clinical establishments to charge rates within "the range of rates determined and issued by the Central Government from time to time."

The rules also require facilities to display procedure charges transparently to prevent billing shocks.The problem is that the Act has not been implemented nationwide. It applies in only 19 States and Union Territories. Besides, the Centre has not notified the rates.

Several bodies representing doctors and healthcare operators have already challenged the provision.The parliamentary committee has also proposed that hospitals provide patients with "a comprehensive, legally binding upfront cost estimate" before complex or prolonged treatment begins. The aim is to prevent financial uncertainty and unexpected bills midway.

Steep markups on medicines and devices

The MRP of medicines and medical devices sold in hospitals and pharmacies can be several times the price at which they are manufactured, imported or purchased from distributors. Investigations in Maharashtra and Karnataka have highlighted the scale of these markups. For a simple medicine such as paracetamol, the difference between a hospital's procurement price and what a patient pays can exceed 1,100%. Common consumables such as intravenous (IV) kits can carry markups of more than 1,200%. While the absolute difference may be small for inexpensive items, it becomes far more consequential for costly cancer medicines.

Trade margin on these drugs refers to the difference between the price at the first point of sale, such as to a distributor, and the MRP printed on the pack. Before deciding to cap trade margins on select cancer drugs, the government analysed market data and found markups of 170%-700% on some medicines. Officials have argued against imposing similar caps on all medicines, saying this would require complex calculations to determine viable margins at different levels of the supply chain — for instance, for a pharmacy outside AIIMS, Delhi compared with one in a village. "This would be extremely difficult to implement and we have to ensure that it does not impact the supply of the medicines," says a Department of Pharmaceuticals official said.

Shukla, however, proposes a simpler intervention: requiring hospitals to disclose procurement prices alongside patient charges on bills. "If the government mandates that hospitals have to mention their procurement prices on the bill along with the charges to the patient, the cost may automatically come down because of the competition," he adds.

SCAN THE QR CODE TO READ MORE HEALTH SPECIAL STORIES

from the OPD

How to read between the lines

Tabshir Shams

A HOSPITAL bill can be difficult to decode even when every charge is duly listed. For families dealing with the stress of an illness, a bill running into lakhs can bring a second worry: What are they being charged for and what will their insurance actually cover?

The problem is not always an obviously inflated bill. It can be smaller discrepancies scattered across dozens of line items — a doctor's fee without the doctor's name, a consumable charged at full price, nursing charges billed separately from room rent, or diagnostic tests for which the patient is not given the expected reports or films. Such discrepancies can be difficult to challenge at discharge, when families are often focused on getting the patient home and settling the bill. By then, it may also be difficult to remember which medicines were administered, which procedures were performed or which services were actually provided.

What to watch out for

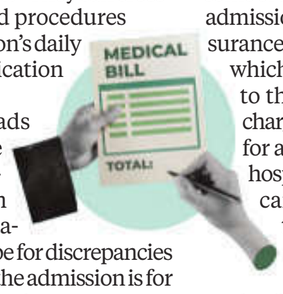
"Ask for an itemised bill, in which every item charged is mentioned separately, like medication and tests. The date and quantity are also mentioned in it," says advocate Shashi Shankar, who specialises in consumer redressal cases. Shashank Rai, co-founder of health-tech platform Docpharma, lists the heads every family should be tracking in real time. "Look at medicines, diagnostics, consumables and disposables, doctor and specialist visits, room rent, bedside and nursing procedures, operation theatre or procedure charges, registration and biomedical waste handling." Since a bill has too many moving parts to make sense of all at once at discharge, he advises families to get into the habit of reviewing these heads regularly. "They will understand their expenses and can raise questions while treatment is still under way," he adds.

Corporate hospitals

Average bill per day per bed	Rs 60,588 to Rs 73,000
Surplus (after deduction of costs, tax) per day per bed	Rs 8,247 to Rs 11,477
Average annual surplus per bed	Rs 20.8 lakh to 31.4 lakh
MEDICINES (INVESTIGATION BY KARNATAKA REGULATOR)	
Antibiotic Gufipol	52.6 times (landing or manufacturing price vs MRP)
Antibiotic Guficycline	44.4 times
Terlitis	37.4 times
CONSUMABLES (MAHARASHTRA FDA)	
IV infusion set	Price to hospital Rs 11.05, MRP Rs 325
Syringe procured	Rs 6.75, MRP Rs 57.20
Catheter	Rs 29.41, MRP of Rs 310

Check the headers

The same heads recur across most private hospital bills. What matters, says Rai, is not just knowing the heads but reading the line items under each one. "They can cross-check consumables and procedures against the nursing station's daily records, and seek clarification on mismatches."



The items and heads where discrepancies are most likely to arise include consumables, room rent and doctor consultation fees, though the scope for discrepancies can depend on whether the admission is for an emergency, a surgery or long-term treatment. "Another metric hospitals track is the average revenue per occupied bed, or ARPOB. For large private hospital chains, this is around Rs 50,000 per occupied bed per day, and they have to maintain that average, regardless of the patient count," says Rai. Shankar adds, "The hospital has the obligation to provide details. And if a clear answer is not given, then one can write an email or a letter to the higher hospital authorities regarding clarity in the bill." Matching the bill against the relevant department's records is often the fastest way to catch a charge that does not correspond to anything that actually happened — a fee for a doctor's visit with no doctor named, or a procedure billed twice under differing heads.

Check your insurance cover

This is where families can lose money without realising it, Shankar says, because some of the checking needs to happen before admission, not after. "Whatever health insurance one takes, it's important to check which charges are covered before going to the hospital ," he says. Often, ICU charges are not covered, or room charges for a normal room are covered but the hospital gives you a luxury room. "One can also ask for the agreement between the hospital and the insurance company to get more clarity."

Rai cautions against room upgrades. "The doctor's fee and nursing charge will be charged proportionately to that room. So, a Rs 2,000 room rent upgrade can snowball into thousands of rupees."

Every policy also carries a list of non-payable items — things insurers simply won't cover, like registration fees, administrative charges, certain consumables, attendant charges, syringes and gloves. Patients have rights on paper under the Charter of Patients' Rights.

NEWSMAKERS IN THE NEWSROOM

WHY M RIAZ HAMIDULLAH

A veteran of the Bangladesh foreign service, M Riaz Hamidullah is the outgoing High Commissioner of Bangladesh to India. He has also served as Bangladesh's High Commissioner to Sri Lanka and Ambassador to the Netherlands. Hamidullah, who studied in India, has a bachelor's in economics from Aligarh Muslim University. His tenure was marked by a difficult phase in the relationship between the two countries, which he navigated efficiently. This was his last interaction before he left India on October 10



ON RENEWAL OF GANGA WATER TREATY

Water needs to be understood in the intersection of identity, culture and ecology. Our collective approach needs to be a techno-political one, based on mutuality of interests



ON CROSS-BORDER MOBILITY BETWEEN THE TWO NATIONS

Domestic political expediency is one thing but it must not be at the cost of India's larger foreign policy pursuit. That brutally pushed us aside from where we could be

'Ready to engage with India on even keel... must pass through intersection of dignity and shared benefits'

M Riaz Hamidullah, the outgoing High Commissioner of Bangladesh to India, on cross-border mobility concerns, expanding bilateral trade, power and river ecosystem sharing, and the need for cooperation beyond the limited security lens. He was in conversation with Shubhajit Roy, Diplomatic Editor, *The Indian Express*



(Right) M Riaz Hamidullah, outgoing Bangladesh High Commissioner, with Shubhajit Roy, Diplomatic Editor, *The Indian Express* RENUKA PURI

Shubhajit Roy: You came to India when there was an interim government in Bangladesh led by Muhammad Yunus. After that the elections took place. What has been your key takeaway in the India-Bangladesh relationship in the last 17 months that you have been here?

We are trained to approach any relationship — in this case, India-Bangladesh — in terms of State-to-State. If you ask someone, 'How is the relationship going?' People often ask, 'How is trade going?' Progressively, it dawned upon me that the State is one thing; and, the people are another. We tend to believe that understanding people is easier but we have not really gone deeper in terms of unpacking and understanding demographics. The issue now is: How do we strike a balance between the State-to-State interactions and the real one with people?

Shubhajit Roy: The India-Bangladesh relationship is going through turbulence. Between the Yunus government approach and the Tarique Rahman government's approach, what are the differences and similarities towards India?

When you talk of people and politics, things are fluid. With the current government in Dhaka, there is absolute openness and candour. My reference would be the letter that Prime Minister Tarique Rahman addressed to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on February 26, within nine days in the office, where Mr Rahman spoke about the expectations and aspirations of people. We can go for big projects but if the common people have to wonder what it has got to do with them... that was a major challenge in the past. So that is one significant positive departure that has come into Bangladesh. The message has been that we are ready to engage with India on an even keel but everything better passes through the intersection of dignity, trust, respect and shared benefits.

Shubhajit Roy: You talked about shared benefits. The Indian side reached out to the Tarique Rahman government in February. What was Bangladesh's impression of India then, and did you foresee that by the end of September, we would be in a different place than where we started?

One can't foresee everything. Although, there has been complete openness in regard to understanding India, approaching India, engaging with India, not because of history but also because of the future we share. When talking of shared benefits, let me bring up the instance of security. Quite often, I was told that if we can appreciate each other's security needs and concerns and address those in mutually beneficial ways, the sky is the limit. I can attest, within a month of the new dispensation in Dhaka, the security establishments started interacting seamlessly. Such trustful and forthright engagement has assured India that there is a different Bangladesh.

Shubhajit Roy: India had an elevated sense of trust with Sheikh Hasina. Is it possible to replicate that with the new government?

I don't think it would be right to employ any relative lens. For everything, there is a context. There are also circumstances and drivers which led to something. While it's absolutely fair and right for you to express, convey and flag India's concerns, can you ever imagine what Bangladesh's concerns are? What happened in 2024 (July-August protest and what led to that), was brutalisation, decimation of institutions and our economy.

Cross-border mobility of ordinary people was closed... people were arbitrarily pushed in across the border, disregarding long-agreed norms and procedures. Domestic political expediency is one thing but it must not be at the cost of India's larger foreign policy pursuit, that is to have an even-grounded relation with Bangladeshi people. That brutally pushed us aside from where we could be, and I feel, this could have been avoided in the long-term interests of both people within our shared geography.

Shubhajit Roy: During the Bengal elections in India, the rhetoric around illegal immigration from Bangladesh dominated the political discourse. Then we saw detentions. How difficult was it for the relationship to return to normalcy?

Uncharitable words were rupturing the relationship between people. For instance, in addressing the question of irregular mobility of people, our point was very clear: If there is an issue, we will engage with seriousness and sincerity. Dhaka said, 'Let's sit down, go through each name, one by one and find out the merit in each case.' Dhaka noted that the concern over 'illegal immigration' has too often been used and raised in India with little regard to context and causation.

It's fitting to look at how an ordinary Bangladeshi ends up in India. Essentially, there is a far deeper nexus of nefarious operators who prey on people and it is the nexus that has to be dismantled in our collective interests.

Shubhajit Roy: In India, Sheikh Hasina is seen as a friend of India. When she addressed a press conference at the Foreign Correspondents' Club (FCC) in Delhi, how damaging was it? And from a Bangladeshi perspective, why?

Things didn't happen overnight. It happened over time. Is the killing of even one civilian person justified? What is justice? Many of you from India would know how thousands injured or disabled by brutalities by state machinery are still languishing in hospitals or homes quietly, how people were made to disappear, how children standing on the balcony lost their eyes or lives to metallic bullets. There is little admission, little regard to what Bangladeshis went through or were subjected to. That is one aspect where, even now, people feel hurt vis-à-vis India.

Shubhajit Roy: How do you see the relationship moving forward?

The key word is 'appreciating aspirations' of the masses, not just the youth. As long as you come and connect with the fulfilment of my aspiration, I am here with you.

Shubhajit Roy: So, the idea is that you can insulate facilitationship from the Hasina factor. Is it possible to move beyond?

When the Bangladesh Foreign Minister chose to come to Delhi, within two months of the government in office, he engaged without any inhibition. He drove straight from the airport to the table with NSA Ajit Doval. Both the principals were in conversation for over three-and-a-half hours. Then, at Hyderabad House, he had a candid conversation with Dr Jaishankar. What else should signify openness?

Shubhajit Roy: Tarique Rahman was supposed to come to India for the bilateral visit but that didn't work out. His visit during the BRICS Summit didn't happen. What is your prognosis: Will the visit happen in the near future? And what conditions need to be met to make it happen?

There have been multiple times in the past seven months where Dhaka and Delhi got very close to materialising the August interaction between the two leaders. The government in Dhaka was absolutely willing. Efforts were under way. Yes, visits are important but we have to get both a mix of sufficient and essential conditions together, where dignity, respect, mutuality and interdependence manifest aptly. These are not too much of an ask. Surely, geography and nature, on either side, show that neither of the two countries can afford disharmony in ties.

SCAN THE QR CODE TO WATCH THE VIDEO

Harikishan Sharma: The India-Bangladesh Ganga Water Treaty is due for renewal this December. Have the talks for it started? In India, states are demanding that the treaty not be renewed. Second, Bangladesh has been buying power from Adani Power Ltd. What is the present status of power supply from India?

Water has long been an emotional issue. In the long shot, water needs to be understood in the intersection of identity, culture and ecology. People often may not reckon that five months of the year, Bangladesh is water abundant but that's runoff. But, the rest seven months of the year, we are practically dry. Also, Bangladesh carries over one billion metric tons of sediment load through the Ganges-Brahmaputra-Meghna (GBM) Basin, ending in the Bay of Bengal. Whereas Bangladesh shares just 7 per cent of the GBM Basin, we bear far greater proportionate brunt. Clearly, our collective approach to water and sharing of waters needs a techno-political approach based on mutuality of interests and inter-dependence. On power, at the moment, we are buying 2,500 MW of power from India: Adani is 1,500 MW and the other 1,000 MW from different parts, including Northeast India.



ON DIVISIVE POLITICS AFFECTING TIES

In the longest timeframe, it is the values that got Bangladesh and India together. If that is little understood or appreciated, then we risk putting the relationship in jeopardy

Amrita Nayak Dutta: India and Bangladesh have typically shared cordial and stable defence relations over the years. But, in the last one-and-a-half years, we have seen an increased dependence on Chinese military products by Bangladesh and Pakistan also wants to have a share in Bangladesh's defence space. Considering these factors, how have the defence relations between India and Bangladesh changed?

Our defence and security establishments build-up is guided by the Forces Vision 2030. The tri-forces pursue their acts objectively. Their demonstrated professionalism to date attests to little room for creating any competition or concern whatsoever. The desirable continuity is there as manifested in undeterred interactions between the defence sector institutions like National Defence College, and seamless contact between the military counterparts at different levels. There is considerable comfort and confidence between them, while any of the sides goes by its sovereign consideration in deciding on defence architecture planning and procurement.

Aakash Joshi: In both India and Bangladesh, especially in the last few years, domestic politics, foreign policy, bilateral relations or even people have become part of divisive rhetoric. Given the reality of our geography, our historical ties, how challenging do you think politics is in growing ties?

We must guard this relationship from domestic political expediency. For long, it is the values that actually got — and ought to get — Bangladesh and India together. If that is little understood or appreciated, then we risk putting the relationship in jeopardy. That's why, I say, our ties are organic. In Assam, the vice-chancellor of Guwahati University reminded me, 'We are connected by Brahmaputra civilisation.'

Aakash Joshi: Information now doesn't know borders. How do you see that affecting your job and the ties?

The media has to assume and conduct with responsibility. If any media trades it off, the amount of disruption it causes, leads to an isolation paradox. Who is to correct the false narratives prevalent all over? Ours is a relationship which should have been the easiest, deepest and most to be celebrated in South Asia. And, place and frame that in the intersection of values and interests rather than limited sectoral trade offs.

Nikhil Ghanekar: In the wake of the tragedy in Nepal and climate change linkage, Nepal has raised loss and damage. Will Bangladesh, which faces rising seas, cyclones etc., join Nepal in claiming compensation?

It was Bangladesh which, for one-and-a-half decades since COPs in Copenhagen (2009) and Warsaw (2013), brought the whole architecture of loss and damage under UNFCCC framework. Sadly, we witnessed that the global South was in two minds to bring that to fruition. A genuinely sustainable answer must redeem the objectives of securing shared prosperity through shared responsibility. One cannot have a divisive approach or selectivity as far as nature and ecology are concerned.

Saikat Bose: During the events of 2024, we saw the golden statue of Mujibur Rahman being vandalised and the Dhanmondi house being attacked. How do you respond to that? In the event that Sheikh Hasina returns, what can we expect? And how do equations change with political developments in Bengal and Dhaka?

History, as it stands, is known. No one can wipe it out. Whosoever deserves whatever space, respect and regard in terms of history in Bangladesh, that is there. Please leave it to the Bangladeshis of today. They are sovereign, sensitive and appreciative of history, in terms of the present. In history, if anyone does things improperly, in the natural process of correction, people will fault you and put you in the right place.

Saptarshi Basak: Historically, Bangladesh and Pakistan have had difficult relations. But that seems to be changing post-August 2024 with ministerial visits and considering the Mecca Pact. How does the new regime see Islamabad?

Both are sovereign States. Our interactions with Pakistan have been driven, guarded and judged across all attributes — people, economic, social, political, defence. The pulse of the people is clear: We enjoy cultural aspects like music or cuisine but that is not to be traded off in respect of history, where several aspects remain unsettled. This March 25th, Prime Minister Tarique Rahman spoke out in an unambiguous manner on the Bangladesh genocide, referring to the Pakistani forces in 1971. So, Bangladesh engages with Pakistan just as it does with every other State. As for the Mecca treaty and others, there are some things in continuum.

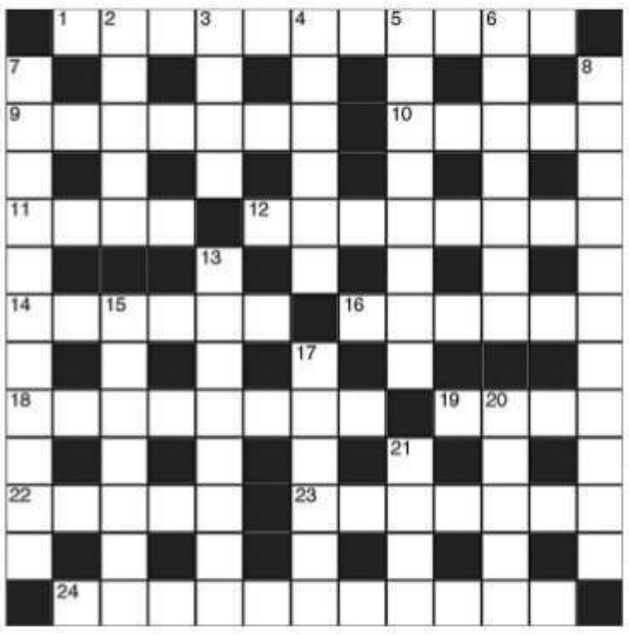
Khushi Sinha: You are expected to be a part of Bangladesh's permanent representative role in Geneva. What would be your immediate priorities there?

Diplomats enter an ongoing stream where mechanisms are laid out to protect national interests and also promote creative ideas. Priorities are guided by instructions from the Capital.

Shubhajit Roy: You talked about people-to-people relationship, and the issue of visas has been a challenge. How do you see that being unlocked?

There are two ways to approach the visa regime: It can either be looked at as a security concern or liberated as an opportunity. For Bangladesh, consular services for Indian nationals have remained seamless. One may check out sustained flight mobility between Dhaka and Delhi or Indians travelling to Bangladesh on various economic imperatives. Let's ponder upon the bigger picture where the economic interaction between Bangladesh and India stands at a minimum of US$ 28 to $30 billion, more than double the formal $13 billion trade both ways. One may consider inwards remittances (from Bangladesh), medical tourism, general tourists, students and unmapped services trade. I am not even counting Indian investments. So, we need to move from simple enumeration of cooperation to far wider 'collaboration' — across higher education, research and sustaining our natural ecosystems (rivers, wetlands) — and rise over seeing every issue through the limited lens of security.

• CROSSWORD 6117



ACROSS
1 First offence (8,3)
9 An unusual form of greed got one's back up (7)
10 Entitled to be majestic (5)
11 A bit of radio talent but " very little (4)
12 One flies from such crimes (8)
14 Mother's returned a kitchen utensil - it's junk (6)
16 Wallow in confusion (6)
18 Unusually apt due to being right in fashion (2,2,4)
19 Cab charge imposed on one (4)
22 Show travelled round (5)
23 Fix the score to suit the players (7)
24 A tailor may make his mark with it (6,5)

DOWN
2 Just correct (5)
3 Boast about style of clothing (4)
4 Agreed with the head (6)
5 Capital fellow extremely single-minded (8)
6 Constructed as integral part of reformed Lib unit (7)
7 However it's viewed it amounts to the same thing (5,6)
8 It takes liquid refreshment and leaves (3,8)
13 A worker has fallen but pass on (4,4)
15 Ring fighter turns to drama (7)
17 New act with hat and stick (6)
20 Abolish article from a yearbook (5)
21 A way through on foot (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6116 **ACROSS:** 1 Job lot, 4 Short cut, 9 Nudist, 10 Egg salad, 12 Yank, 13 Doyen, 14 Anil, 17 Right-hand man, 20 Stenographer, 23 Rate, 24 Ember, 25 Seem, 28 Apostles, 29 Studio, 30 Amethyst, 31 Meagre **DOWN:** 1 Junkyard, 2 Badinage, 3 Oast, 5 Higher degree, 6 Rest, 7 Colony, 8 Toddle, 11 Roman numbers, 15 State, 16 Marat, 18 Sheepdog, 19 Primrose, 21 Armada, 22 Stooge, 26 Etch, 27 Stye

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The days that are still to come are the wisest___. - Pindar (9)

RUEES

GINRIT

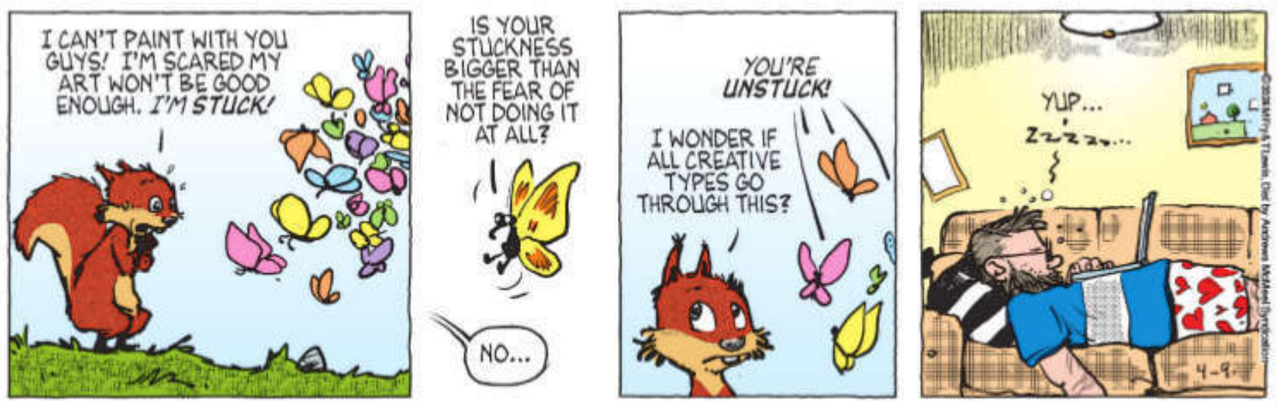
ISYSS

AEDYNW

SOLUTIONS: Reuse, Sissy, Tiring, Yawned
ANSWER: The days that are still to come are the wisest **witnesses**. - Pindar

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6469

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

1					8	4	6	
9		7			6			2
		5	3	7				8
6	2				1	5		
7	5						1	3
		8	9				2	4
8				1	3	9		
2			4			7		6
	4	3	7					1

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6468

2	3	1	8	4	9	6	5	7
8	4	6	3	7	5	2	1	9
5	9	7	2	1	6	4	3	8
7	1	2	5	9	3	8	6	4
4	6	9	1	2	8	5	7	3
3	8	5	7	6	4	1	9	2
9	7	8	4	5	1	3	2	6
1	2	3	6	8	7	9	4	5
6	5	4	9	3	2	7	8	1

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Tread carefully today, because it's easy to get into an argument, especially with your kids or even a romantic partner. Very likely, the dispute will be about shared expenses, property or perhaps differing values. Tonight: Check your finances.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Issues with others might be stressful today because the Moon is in your sign at odds with Mars, sitting in the part of your chart related to home and family. This is an indication of needless disputes, irritability, tension and grievances. Tonight: Cooperate.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Avoid arguments related to your work, your health or even a pet today. There also might be disputes related to money, cash flow or something that you own. Instead, focus on playful, fun-loving times. Tonight: Get better organised.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Home, family and interactions with a parent might be your focus today. However, disputes with romantic partners or your kids might arise, especially regarding disagreements about money, possessions and who should pay for what. Tonight: Socialise.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Squabbles with family members can arise easily today. Consider this an opportunity to practice patience. Tonight: Relax at home.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Avoid silly, irritable squabbles with siblings, relatives and daily contacts. They might escalate into something nasty and regrettable. They can also ruin your peace of mind and those around you. Instead, focus on the beauty of your daily surroundings. Tonight: An interesting conversation.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You might get into an argument with a friend or a member of a group. Questions about money, cash flow and possessions will arise today. Tonight: Check your possessions.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This is a challenging day for you. The Moon in your sign is at odds with Mars at the top of your chart, which is a signal that you might be irritated with authority figures. Tonight: You win.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Be smart and steer clear of controversial subjects. These conversations will become arguments that could ruin your day,and someone else's. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your reputation matters to you because respect is important. Right now people admire you because the Sun is at the top of your chart. You look good. Meanwhile, it's easy to get bogged down in silly arguments with friends or groups about shared expenses and shared responsibilities. Tonight: Be friendly.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Your main objective today might be to avoid saying something you will later regret. This is because people notice you, and you might get involved in an argument with a partner or close friend. Make smart choices. Tonight: You're admired.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Avoid arguments and disagreements about political and social issues today. Instead, decide to use your energy to sort out things and get organised. Travel and explore new ideas. Tonight: Explore and learn.

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
CONCOR ANNEXE, NSIC New MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Indl. Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110020.

INVITATION FOR E-TENDER
CONCOR invite E-Bids for Open e-Tender (Single Bid System) for Supply installation testing and commissioning of Electrical Panels at CFS DRT Dronagiri.

Tender No.	CON/A-II/ELECT. PANELS/CFS-DRT/E-87380/2026-27
Total Estimated Cost	₹ 1,26,28,242 (Incl. of GST)
Cost of Tender documents (Non-refundable)	₹ 1,120 (Inclusive all) through e-payment
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	₹ 3,540 (Inclusive all) through e-payment
Earnest Money	₹ 2,52,565 (through e-payment)
Date of sale of tender (online)	From 12-10-2026 at 17:00 Hrs. to 02-11-2026 up to 12:30 Hrs.
Last Date & Time of submission	02-11-2026 up to 14:00 Hrs. (E-Tendering Mode Only)
Date and time of Opening Tender	02-11-2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

The complete Tender Document for eligibility criteria and other details can be viewed & downloaded only from the website (www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL). The tender notice is also available on the website www.concorindia.co.in and website of Public Procurement Portal http://eprocure.gov.in. Bidders are requested to visit the websites regularly.
Group General Manager/P&S/Area-II

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I Vikas Chopra Alias Chopra Vikas Vijay Alias Vikas V Chopra S/O, Vijay Mangalsain Chopra R/o Saroj Silk Mills Mahatmawadi Salabatpura Surat Gujarat 395003 have changed my name to Vikas Vijay Chopra. 0040882953-1

I Nadim Ahamad S/O, Khurshid Ahmad R/o A-223, Aman Vihar, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Po: Sultanpuri C Block, Dist: North West Delhi, Delhi - 110086 have changed my name to Nadeem Ahmad. 0040882951-1

I hitherto known as SURENDER S/O Sh. MANOHAR R/o RC 428 Bharat Nagar, Khora Colony, Ghaziabad Near Ambedkar Park, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh 201001, have added surname KUMAR and shall hereafter be known as SURENDER KUMAR. 0130070155-1

I, Happy S/O Jograj, holder of Indian Passport no. C3981598 and valid until 27.04.2035, r/o Vill. Shiekhupura Po. jaura chhattran, Gurdaspur, Pin: 143520, Punjab, India have changed my name Happy and surname Happy. 0040882949-1

I, Bhavik Bhatt S/o Pankajkumar Bhatt R/o Flat no. 301, Tower 9, Lotus Boulevard, Opp Starling Mall, Sector 100, Noida, PO : Maharshi Nagar, DIST : Gautam Budhha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, 201304 declare that Bhavik Bhatt and Bhavik Pankajkumar Bhatt are same person. These names can be used for all purpose. 0040882952-1

I, KARAN S/o Sh. JAGDISH R/o VPO Shamlo Kalan, Jind, Haryana-126114 have changed my name from KARAN to KARAN SEWAL for all purposes. 0040882962-1

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SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.


HEAD CONSTABLE RAMDHAR RAM **75 BN BSF** 01.07.1949 – 12.10.1990


CONSTABLE SHAILENDER DUBEY **78 BN BSF** 01.04.1985 – 12.10.2021

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE


Veer Balidani Shri Gyan Chand Sharma Asst. Comdt. **73 Bn** 8-9-1944 To 12-10-1989


Veer Balidani Constable Balbir Singh **73 Bn** 6-5-1959 To 12-10-1989

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Asst. Comdt. Shri Gyan Chand Sharma and Constable Balbir Singh of 73 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly countering a militant ambush in dist. Amritsar, Punjab, on 12 October 1989. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.


Veer Balidani Head Constable/Radio Operator Dilip Kumar Pandey 4 SIG (Attached) With 168 Bn 20-1-1986 To 12-10-2014

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable/Radio Operator Dilip Kumar Pandey of 168 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 12 October 2014 after sustaining grievous injuries in an IED blast while valiantly countering a Maoist ambush in Dist. Bijapur, Chhattisgarh, on 27 September 2014. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.


Veer Balidani Naik D.S. Soren **4 Bn** 14-12-1960 To 12-10-1997


Veer Balidani Naik Rakesh Kumar **4 Bn** 1-4-1963 To 12-10-1997


Veer Balidani Constable Joginder Nath Roy **4 Bn** 5-1-1966 To 12-10-1997


Veer Balidani Constable C. K. Punacha **4 Bn** 13-4-1968 To 12-10-1997


Veer Balidani Naik/Driver Kalu Ram **4 Bn** 15-12-1952 To 12-10-1997

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to 5 bravehearts of 4 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly fighting against insurgents during an encounter in Assam, on 12 October 1997. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

SBI
Project Management & Strategic Coordination Department, Global IT Centre, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614
E-mail: dgmit.pmd@sbi.co.in; Website: https://sbi.bank.in/

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

RFP NO. SBI/GITC/IT-Project Management & Strategic Coordination/2026/2027/1506 DATED: 12.10.2026

Bids are invited by State Bank of India from the eligible bidders for Procurement of Project and Portfolio Management Tool with Test Management Capability. Bidders, who are interested to submit bids, visit Procurement news at https://sbi.bank.in/ and e-Procurement agency portal https://etender.sbi/ SBI.

Commencement of download of RFP: 12.10.2026 From 10:00 Hrs
Last date and time for Bid submission: 03.11.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs
Project Management & Strategic Coordination Department

BANGALORE MEDICAL COLLEGE & RESEARCH INSTITUTE
(An Autonomous Institute of Govt. of Karnataka)
Office of the Director cum Dean, Fort, K.R. Road, Bengaluru - 560 002. Telephone: 080-26700810, Tele Fax: 080-26704342
E-mail: director_bmcri@yahoo.co.in

No: BMCRI//Fellow/126/2026-27 Dated: 09-10-2026

NOTIFICATION (CORRIGENDUM)

Applications are invited from NMC / MCI recognized MS / MD / DNB / MCh / Diploma Qualified Candidates for Fellowship Programmes in **Various Subjects at BMC&RI, Bengaluru for the Academic Year 2026-27.**

The Last Date for Submission of Application is **19-10-2026** along with Application Fee of **Rs. 4,000/-** (for each subject) made on Online Payment to the following Account **Director cum Dean, BMCRI, Bengaluru Account No: 32021549335, IFSC Code: SBIN0070242, State Bank of India, TSP Branch, Bengaluru** and online Payment Receipt enclosed along with Application form.

The objective type (MCQ) **Entrance examination will be conducted on 27-10-2026 at BMC&RI Examination Hall, First Floor near Library Block from 10.30 AM to 11.30 AM.**

For further information, visit the Institution's Website: **https://bmcribengaluru.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/- Director cum Dean, BMCRI, Bengaluru.

DIPR/CP/3190/Adverto/2026-27

HDB FINANCIAL SERVICES LIMITED — DEMAND NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SARFAESI ACT,2002

Registered Office: Radhika,2nd Floor, Law Garden Road, Navrangpura, Ahemdabad, Gujrat, Pin Code: 380009 **BRANCH OFFICE:** HDB Financial Services Limited, Khasra No 47, Behind Ox Ford School, Vikaspuri Delhi 110018

You the below mentioned borrower, co-borrowers and guarantors have availed loan(s)/ financial facility(ies) from HDB Financial Services Limited by mortgaging your immovable properties (securities) and defaulted in repayment of the same. Consequent to your defaults your loan was classified as non-performing asset. Subsequently, the Company has issued demand notice under Section 13(2) of The Securitization And Reconstruction of Financial Asset and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the Act), the contents of which are being published herewith as per section 13(2) of the act read with Rule 3(1) of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 as and by way of alternate service upon you. Details of the borrowers, co-borrowers, loan account no., loan amount, demand notice under section 13(2) date, amount claimed in the notice, NPA date and securities are given as under:

1) NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE BORROWER/CO-BORROWER/GUARANTOR; 2) LOAN ACCOUNT NUMBER; 3) LOAN AMOUNT; 4) DATE OF DEMAND NOTICE; 5) CLAIMED AMOUNT IN INR; 4) DETAILS OF SECURITIES;7) DATE OF POSSESSION

Name Of The Borrower & Co-Borrowers: Kapoor Jewel Mines Private Limiteda-5/24 Lal Quater Krishna Nagar Delhi Delhi-110051 Kunal Kapoor600 First Floor Niti Khand-2 Indrapuram Ghaziabad-201010 Kamlesh Kapoor600 Ground Floor Niti Khand-2 Indirapuram Ghaziabad-201010 Rajpal Kapoor 600 First Floor Niti Khand 02 Indirapuram Ghaziabad Ghaziabad-201010 **LOAN ACCOUNT NO.:** 3712775: **LOAN AMOUNT:** Rs.4332916/- (Rupees Forty Three Lakhs Thirty Two Thousand Nine Hundred Sixteen Only) **DEMAND NOTICE DATE:** 25.09.2026. **AMOUNT CLAIMED:** Rs. 1,293,625.30/- (Rupees Twelve Lakhs Ninety Three Thousand Six Hundred Twenty Five and Paise Thirty Only) as of 25.09.2026 and future contractual interest till actual realization together with incidental expenses, cost and charges etc. **NPA Date :** 16.03.2026. **DETAILS OF SECURITY:**All that Piece and Parcel of the House No. 776, First Floor Without Roof Rights, Covered Area 36 Sq. Mtrs., Alongwith One Open Parking Niti Khand-I Ghaziabad-201001, Uttar Pradesh And Bounded As East - Plot No.762; West -Road 36 Feet Wide; North-Plot No.777; South - Plot No.775

Name Of The Borrower & Co-Borrowers: G R Plastics, Gogia Caterer All At Also 27-A/6 Dilshad Garden Industrial Area Delhi New Delhi Delhi Delhi-110095 Delhi & Plot Bearing No 27-A, Out Of Khasra No. 1183/220/1, In The Abadi Of Dilshad Garden Village Jhilmil Tahirpur Illaqa Delhi-110095, G R Plastics, Ghan Shyam Dass, Sanjay Kumar, Manju All At Also Residential 1st Floor Without Roof Rights Covered Area Measuring 100 Sq Mtrs Plot No.10A/156 Sector-10A Residential Ghaziabad-201012gogia Enterprises A-5/8 Jhilmil Industrial Area Jhilmil Industrial Area Block A G T Road Delhi Delhi-110095 & A 5/4 G T Road Jhilmil Industrial Area East Delhi Delhi-110095 Delhi Davander Kumar Gogia, Ritika All At Also House No 07 Second Floor Sector 14A Vasundhara Vasundhara Ghaziabad Vasundhara Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh Ghaziabad-201012 Uttar Pradesh & Lot No 3/569 Second Floor Sector 3 Sector 3 Vasundhara Vasundhara Po Vasundhra Dist Ghaziabad Uttar Ghaziabad-201012 Uttar Pradesh Gogia Caterer 141 Ground Floor Kucha Ghasi Ram Opposite Phool Mandi Chandani Chowk Delhi Delhi-110006 Delhi **LOAN ACCOUNT NO.:** 35511176, 69835023:**LOAN AMOUNT:** Rs.8500000/- (Rupees Eighty Five Lakhs Only) by loan account number 35511176 and to the tune of Rs.4000000/- (Rupees Forty Lakhs Only) by loan account number 69835023 **DEMAND NOTICE DATE:** 21.09.2026. **AMOUNT CLAIMED:**Rs.11003245.73 (Rupees One Crore Ten Lakh Three Thousand Two Hundred & Forty Five - Paise Seventy Three Only) as of 11.09.2026 and future contractual interest till actual realization together with incidental expenses, cost and charges etc.. **NPA Date :** 02.09.2026. **DETAILS OF SECURITY: SCHEDULE OF THE SECURITIES I** All that piece and parcel of Land area admeasuring 75 Sq. Yds. "the said portion" part of Plot bearing No. 27-A, out of Khasra No. 1183/220/1, in the abadi of Dilshad Garden, Situated in the area of Village Jhilmil Tahirpur, Illaqa Shahdara, Delhi; hereinafter referred to as "said property". **SCHEDULE OF THE SECURITIES II** All that piece and parcel of Residential First Floor without roof rights having its covered area measuring 100 sq. mtrs., part of Plot No.10A/156 situated with the limits of Sector-10A situated at Residential Colony known as Vasundhara, Tehsil and Distt. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. Bounded as under: North: Road 9 mtrs., wide, South: Plot No.10A/133, East: Plot No.10A/157, West: Plot No.10A/155.

You the borrower/ co-borrowers and guarantors are therefore called upon to make payment of the above mentioned demanded amount with further interest as mentioned herein above in full within 60 days of this notice failing which the undersigned shall be constrained to take action under the act to enforce the above-mentioned securities. **(Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.)** Please note that as per section 13(13) of the said Act, you are restrained from transferring the above-referred securities by way of sale, lease or otherwise without our consent and any non compliance of section 13(13) of the Act is punishable under section 29 of the said Act.

For Any Query Please Contact Mr. Arun Yadav Phone: 9350538386 / Mr. Vikas Anand (9711010384)

DATE: 12-10-2026 Authorised Officer
Place : DELHI For HDB Financial Services Limited,

Bridge And Roof Company (India) Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)
2/1, RUSSELL STREET, KOLKATA-700071

Notice Inviting e-Tender (e-NIT) No.
B AND R / HO / DMER / MAHARASHTRA/51264/GADCHIROLI/NIT/CW/02

Online **Item Rate Percentage Basis** Bid(s)/Offer(s) in two-part system are invited from reputed, resourceful and experienced parties meeting prescribed qualifying criteria for **"CONSTRUCTION OF 100 STUDENT CAPACITY MEDICAL COLLEGE AND ATTACHED 430 BEDDED HOSPITAL NEWLY CONSTRUCTED GOVERNMENT MEDICAL COLLEGE, GADCHIROLI, MAHARASHTRA" UNDER DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION AND DRUGS DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA.**

Sub Head: Civil Work including Electrical work, Sanitary & Plumbing, Water Supply, Landscaping, HVAC, Fire-Fighting including Fire Protection, Lift, STP/ ETP, MGPS, MOT and other Allied Works etc.

Date of Availability of Tender Document in Website as well as CPP Portal: 12.10.2026 and Last Date of submission of Bid (On-Line) is 02.11.2026.

Interested Bidder(s) will have to be enrolled & registered with the Government e-Procurement System; through logging on to https://eprocure.gov.in.

Addendum / Corrigendum, if any, shall be hosted in Company's Website: www.bridgeroof.co.in and CPP portal : https://eprocure.gov.in only

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Open Tender Notice No. - JHSW-M-W-SC-2026-27-07
E-Tender Notice
E-tenders are invited from experienced or interested contractors on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work-

Cost of work : Rs. 1,84,21,272.00/- (Including 18% GST)	
Name of work : Retrofitment of high capacity high tensile CBC on wagons at JHSW.	
Earnest Money : Rs. 3,68,400/-	Time of completion : Thirty Six Months
Online tender closing date and time : 02.11.2026 at 16:00 Hrs.	

Detailed information about tender and tender format in available at website www.ireps.gov.in 2313/26 (C)
North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONC

M.P. INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
(Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
SECRETARIAT FOR SINGLE WINDOW SYSTEM
21, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011, M.P. (India)
E-mail : helpdesk@mpidc.co.in, invest.mp@invest.mp.gov.in
Web. : www.invest.mp.gov.in, (CIN : U51102MP1977SGC001392)
Tel. : (91) 755-2559971, 2559979, 2575618
Ref. No. : MPIDC/LM/SWS-RFP/2026/NIT-10-01
No.52/MPIDC/LM/NIT-10-01 Date : 09.10.2026

Expression of Interest (EOI) for allotment of Industrial Plots through E-Bidding

Department of Industrial Policy and Investment Promotion (DIPIP), Government of Madhya Pradesh through M.P. Industrial Development Corporation Limited (A Govt. of M.P. Undertaking) has invited Online Tender cum Auction (E-forward auction) for allotment of available Industrial Plots at **Neemuch, Ujjain, Jabalpur, Seoni, Khargone, Dhar District.** through NIT-10-01.The Process of which will start on the **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** from 12.10.2026

1. To participate in e-bidding, it is necessary to have Class 3 Digital Signature. Detailed information about rules, procedure and plots etc. can also be viewed on MPIDC website **https://sws.invest.mp.gov.in/**
2. Please refer to the Tender documents before proceeding with the application.
3. Corrigendum related to e-bidding process, if any, will not be published in the newspaper, it will be uploaded on **https://mptenders.gov.in** portal.

M.P. Madhyam/128478/2026 **EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR**

'Hard work has paid off', says Raina on Bhuvi's return to T20Is



Bhuvaneshwar Kumar will return after four years. CREIMAS

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 11

BHUVNESHWAR KUMAR recently made his return to the Indian team after an extended period on the sidelines with the veteran pacer included in the T20I squad for the upcoming New Zealand tour. Former India batter Suresh Raina was all praises for the player, saying that hard work always pays off.

"Congratulations to Bhuvi. He has done a great job in recent times. He has played domestic cricket. I spoke to him. I met him. He is a busy cricketer. Hard work has paid off; it always pays off. At the age of 36, he has shown character. He has been a very disciplined bowler. He has been a very process-oriented guy. He has worked really hard on his body. I hope he does very well when he goes to New Zealand. Best wishes to him," Raina said.

It is close to four years since Bhuvneshwar last played for India.

It was not a case of him suddenly losing his place: his last Test was in January 2018, his last ODI in January 2022, and by November that year he was out of the T20I set-up as well. In the domestic circuit, his appearances of late have been limited to the Syed Mushtaq Ali T20s and the IPL, where he has bowled Royal Challengers Bengaluru to successive titles.

Two great seasons

Bhuvneshwar has been a revelation in the last two Indian Premier League seasons, helping Royal Challengers Bengaluru win consecutive titles with 48 wickets in 30 matches. India's bowling has often struggled when Jasprit Bumrah isn't available, and his absence was severely felt in the T20I series in England in July, when the visitors conceded 808 runs in 72.5 overs at an economy rate of 11.09.

The decision to include Bhuvneshwar was taken during a selection meeting held earlier this week at the ACA Stadium in Guwahati, where the interim head of the selection committee, Pragyan Ojha, along with secretary Devajit Saikia and other selectors, finalised the T20I and India A squads.

Bhuvneshwar's return is seen as a major boost for India's white-ball bowling attack, particularly given his expertise in swinging the new ball and his effectiveness during the powerplay overs.

INDIA V WEST INDIES THIRD T20I

Indian bowlers turn it around on batting paradise

After the Ranchi chastening, Arshdeep and spinners orchestrate a comeback in hosts' 14-run win



Arshdeep Singh (L) and Naman Dhir combined to take five wickets. CREIMAS/BCCI

Shankar Narayan
Indore, October 11

AT 105/3 in the 11th over, Kamil Pooran had Naman Dhir on the back foot, having smashed the young spinner for six off his first, second and fifth deliveries. After the second-ball maximum, Abhishek Sharma and captain Shreyas Iyer rushed over, perhaps to calm Dhir down.

Pooran tried to clear the ropes once more and finish the over on a high. This time, the pick-up shot had height but not distance, and Arshdeep Singh held the catch to end the right-hander's threatening stay.

The dismissal extended a peculiar sequence in Dhir's short T20 career: every wicket he had taken had come off a ball after the batsman hit him for six. "Six and Out", the name of Brett Lee's band in 1999, has become an apt description of Dhir's knack for striking straight after being attacked.

After the mauling in Ranchi 48 hours ago, the off-spinner, combined with Axar Patel and aided by Arshdeep Singh's 3/44, took India home by 14 runs.

Chasing 224, Arshdeep set the tone in India's bowling effort. Shai Hope held the key to the chase, but the left-armer switched from over to around the wicket, and the captain missed a delivery that crashed into his stumps. India had found the opening to make the asking rate climb early.

At Ranchi, India's spinners had struggled to find the right lengths. In Indore, they were more disciplined. Dhir dismissed Shimron Hetmyer with a delivery that skidded on at pace; the left-hander went back when he should have come forward and lost his off stump.

Axar varied his pace and length, mixing a floated ball on middle with a slower delivery outside off and one fired in at 101.8 kph. The variation denied the batsman a comfortable swing through the line. As the required rate rose, Powell came down the track but could only slice his lofted shot to deep point.

With Hope and Hetmyer back in the hut, India still had to account for Sherfane Rutherford, whose power could quickly change the game. He tried to keep West Indies in contention, but Arshdeep's searing yorker in the 18th over ended his stay on 32 and dented the visitors' hopes.

The improved bowling mattered because India had been forced to defend a total built on Abhishek Sharma's explosive 69 off 30 balls. His T20I scores since making 108 against Afghanistan in Delhi last month had been 0, 7, 61, 20 and 21. After Sanju Samson's 82 in Ranchi, Abhishek needed a response in Indore. He delivered, giving India a blistering start before their innings unravelled.

Samson fell in the second over, but Abhishek refused to let the early wicket slow the scoring. Roston Chase, who had dismissed him in each of the previous two matches, was the first to feel the onslaught. In the third over, Abhishek backed away to lift a quicker full ball over extra cover, launched a slower one over wide long-off and finished with a six over deep point. Eighteen came from the over.

West Indies then struggled to find their lengths. Keemo Paul's short ball on leg was met with a short-arm jab over mid-wicket; when Paul angled one away, Abhishek spanked it over mid-off. Against Shamar Springer, he slashed a short delivery outside off through cover-point.

Shai Hope tried to set fields to suit his bowlers, but Abhishek kept finding gaps and boundaries on either side of the small Holkar Stadium. He was not swinging blindly: width outside off was cut or driven through the covers and backward point, fuller balls were lofted, and deliveries on his body were worked or pulled. He reached his half-century in 18 balls, and India raced to 87/1 in the powerplay. At the other end, Ishan Kishan counterattacked with 37 off 18. Their 108-run stand from 40 balls gave India a platform for a huge total. But Abhishek and Kishan fell within nine deliveries, and the middle order could not sustain the momentum.

Tilak Varma was left to launch at the finish, but was run out for 28 after a bizarre mix-up with Axar. Thinking Kamil Pooran's stop had resulted in a boundary, they turned casually, unaware the ball remained in play. Axar made it back safely, but Tilak was short after Hope relayed the ball to Motie at the bowler's end.

From 115/2, India lost their last eight wickets for 108 runs. Prince Yadav's final-over cameo gave the total a late lift, and proved important as India's bowlers made the difference. Dhir's "six and out" moment was the most memorable example of a wider recovery: after Ranchi, India's attack had responded with better plans and execution.

BRIEF SCORES: India 223 all out in 20 overs (Abhishek Sharma 69, Ishan Kishan 37, ; Roston Chase 2/38) beat West Indies 203/7 in 20 overs (Shimron Hetmyer 43, Kamil Pooran 42; Arshdeep Singh 3/44, Naman Dhir 2/39) by 14 runs.

NZ name split ODI squads for India series

Press Trust of India
Wellington, October 11

FINN ALLEN, Lockie Ferguson, and Tim Seifert will make their return to New Zealand's ODI setup, while Rachin Ravindra returns from a shoulder injury for the upcoming five-match series against India beginning November 4. Due to the Test series that follows the white-ball games, the selectors have named a split squad, withdrawing red-ball specialists after the third match. The New Zealand selectors have split the squad into three groups, with only six players -- Mitchell Santner (captain), Michael Bracewell, Mark Chapman, Jacob Duffy, Will Young, and Blair Tickner -- named for all five ODIs.

Devon Conway, Matt Henry, Kyle Jamieson, Tom Latham, Daryl Mitchell, Glenn Phillips, Rachin Ravindra, and Nathan Smith will feature exclusively in the first three matches starting with the game at Eden Park in Auckland.Following the third game, these Test specialists will leave the squad to prepare for the longer format .

To fill the vacancies for the final two ODIs, seven additional players -- including Finn Allen, Kristian Clarke, Matt Fisher, Lockie Ferguson, Mitch Hay, Nick Kelly, and Seifert -- will join the squad. Allen and Ferguson last featured in an ODI in 2023, with Ferguson's previous appearance coming in the World Cup semifinal against India in Mumbai. Seifert last played an ODI around 18 months ago during New Zealand's home series against Pakistan. White-ball captain Mitchell Santner will lead the extended squad, which largely retains the core of the team that secured the landmark series win earlier this year. Ravindra, who was ruled out of New Zealand's T20I, will return for the opening three ODIs.

NEW ZEALAND ODI SQUADS: (ODIs 1-3) Mitchell Santner (C) Michael Bracewell, Mark Chapman, Devon Conway, Jacob Duffy, Matt Henry, Kyle Jamieson, Tom Latham (WK), Daryl Mitchell, Glenn Phillips, Rachin Ravindra, Nathan Smith, Blair Tickner, Will Young (ODIs 4 & 5): Mitchell Santner (C), Finn Allen, Michael Bracewell, Mark Chapman, Kristian Clarke, Jacob Duffy, Matt Fisher, Lockie Ferguson, Mitch Hay (WK), Nick Kelly, Tim Seifert (WK), Blair Tickner, Will Young.

Son is an ICC Elite Panel umpire, father, 80, is grooming NextGen

Shankar Narayan
Indore, October 11



Narendra Menon (L) with his grand son Hrishabh. (Below) International umpire Nitin Menon. EXPRESS/FILE

THE TRAFFIC outside Indore's Central Gymkhana ground rarely lets the area fall quiet. Inside, Narendra Menon walks into the middle. At 80, he still wants to be around bat, ball and stumps.

Menon's last game as an international umpire came in 1998. His son Nitin Menon is one now. Menon umpires junior matches. Three clubs operate at the ground: his Maharaja Yashwant Rao Cricket Club (MYCC), the Cricket Club of Indore run by former BCCI selector Sanjay Jagdale, and the Indore Divisional Cricket Association. Kids and coaches touch his feet and greet him with "*Jai Hind*".

Associated with MYCC since the 1960s, Menon umpires matches for boys aged 12 to 15 and teaches them the rules. "They don't hold the ball in their hand, let's say, run outs. And they shout, 'howzzat, howzzat'. So I have to tell them, 'Okay, if you are taking the batsman run out, the ball should be in your hand'," Menon told *The Indian Express*.

"Suppose the bails are not off, then I have to tell them, you have to take off the bails first. Then only the batsman can be out. And suppose a batsman is bowled, then you don't have to say, 'howzzat'. Bowled means that you don't need to appeal."

"Front-foot no ball, back-foot no ball. This is all, during the match only you can tell them, no? Then only they learn." Menon had taught junior cricket years earlier, before his umpire-coaching assignment took him away from the ground. He returned four years ago when his grandson Hrishabh started playing. The boys play 50-over games, 25 a side, from 3.30 or 4 pm until 8.30 or 9.

"Parents are waiting. They say, 'Sir, it has been a long time'. I have to convince them that we are teaching them. After two-three months, parents are very happy. 'Sir, we can stay till 10 o'clock, no problem.' Boys are very happy."

When cricket stopped during the rains, parents kept asking why he was not coming.

He says at least 30 boys from his club now play for Indore division, and five or six have played for the state. "My grandson was there; because of that, so many boys took advantage. ... And that is a very big compliment for me." "Boys know that when sir comes, we get to learn a lot. That thing is lacking nowadays. That is the difference between me and other coaches."

First batch

In 1990, his batch was the first group of 10 first-class cricketers to enter umpiring.

"I just wanted to be in the game after retirement. So, I used to coach junior boys, and I used to umpire with them also. Then, the board decided to take first-class cricketers in umpiring. Our batch was the first in 1990. Ten umpires. Those who passed the exam: myself, S Venkatraghavan, AV Jayaprakash."



"So, I used to coach junior boys, and I used to umpire with them also. Then, the board decided to take first-class cricketers in umpiring. Our batch was the first in 1990. Ten umpires. Those who passed the exam: myself, S Venkatraghavan, AV Jayaprakash."
NARENDRA MENON
ON HIS UMPIRING CAREER.

He became an umpire coach in 2007, a role he held for almost a decade.

Nitin was 22 and playing Under-22 cricket when he came to his father with an announcement. "Papa, I want to become an umpire," he said. "I was shocked," Menon says.

Menon had one piece of advice for him. "If you want to be a good umpire. Don't see the face of any batsman or bowler. Your duty is just to see below the waist: bat, ball, stumps, nothing else. He's following the same advice."

Technology, he says, has made umpiring harder. "It has become harder. When we used to do international matches, there were only five or six cameras. That's all. Now you see more than 20 to 25 cameras. So you can't run away. Any mistake. Either this camera will catch. Or another camera will catch." Menon's best memories came from officiating in two Ranji Trophy finals in Mumbai: Hyderabad against Mumbai in 2000, and Tamil Nadu against Mumbai in 2003. In the first, Mohammad Azharuddin and VVS Laxman put on 89, but it was Laxman's dismissal that stayed with him.

Laxman was run out with his bat just short of the crease. Menon still remembers how close it was, holding up his finger to demonstrate the distance between bat and line. "His bat was like this. This is the popping crease. His bat was like this (marginally short). The edge of it. But the edge is above. But it is out of the crease. So I gave him out."

"So Laxman saw me. He also knew he was out. All Hyderabad players went up just to see the TV."

Former India captain Tiger Pataudi was watching. The next day, Menon read what he had written about the dismissal. "He wrote about me. 'If an on-field umpire can give this kind of good decision. I don't think we need a third umpire.' You feel proud," he said.

"I love to umpire with boys. I love to stand. If I am standing there, I will umpire."

At 80, Menon's international career is behind him, but bat, ball and stumps beckon.

BRIEFLY



Vinicius Jr was sent off against Villarreal in the 72nd minute. REUTERS

Vinicius apologises to fans after red card for hair pull against Villarreal

REAL MADRID'S Vinicius Jr has apologised to his teammates and the club's fans after being sent off in the 1-0 win over Villarreal in LaLiga at the Santiago Bernabeu on Saturday. Vinicius now faces a nervous wait for the ruling of the disciplinary committee, which could see him miss Real's fixture with rivals Barcelona on October 25 at Camp Nou. The Brazilian thought he had scored Real's second goal but his effort was disallowed after a VAR review found he should be dismissed for pulling Nathan Saliba's hair in the build-up. After the match, Vinicius, who came on in the 52nd minute and was red carded 20 minutes later, posted on social media, saying, "sorry to the team and the fans." REUTERS

WFI hopeful of wrestlers getting visa for the U23 World C'ships

THE WRESTLING Federation of India (WFI) is hoping for a favourable response from the US Embassy on the rejected visa applications of four U23 World Championships-bound women grapplers, as their events are scheduled to begin at Las Vegas only on Wednesday. Five Greco Roman and four women wrestlers were denied visas for being under 20 years of age and unemployed. With the women's competition scheduled to begin from Wednesday, the WFI is hopeful that the two-day window following Sunday will give the embassy time to reconsider its decision and issue visas to the stranded Indian wrestlers Parveen (50kg), Ahilya Shatrughn Shinde (55kg), Neha Sharma (57kg) and Neha Sangwan (65kg). PTI

SOUTH AFRICA V AUSTRALIA FIRST TEST

Oz in cruise control after collective bowling effort

AP & Reuters
Durban, October 11

PAT CUMMINS claimed 3-54 as Australia took a 139-run lead against South Africa at stumps on day three of the first cricket Test here on Sunday. A collective bowling effort from Australia saw South Africa bowled out for 284 in its first innings Mitchell Starc (2-63), Josh Hazlewood (2-54) and Nathan Lyon (2-58) took a brace each.

Australia had scored 390 runs in its first innings with Matt Renshaw hitting a career-best 190 to help the visitors recover from a precarious 124-6.

In its second innings, Australia was 33-0 at stumps in 5.4 overs when play was called off early again due to bad light, with nearly 13 overs lost in the day. Nic Maddinson (17 not out) and Travis Head (10 not out) are at the crease.

David Bedingham top-scored for South Africa with 49 off 73 balls. The hosts were 197-8 at one stage before a 52-run ninth-wicket partnership between Keshav Maharaj (34) and Simon Harmer (35 not out) reduced some of the damage.

South Africa is the reigning world test champion and beat Australia in the 2025 final. It is Australia's first trip to the country since the 2018 ball tampering scandal when they last toured here.

South Africa was down to 115-4 at lunch. Starting from 27-1 on day two, Aiden Markram (37) and Bedingham added 57 runs to their overnight partnership. The breakthrough for Australia came just before drinks â€“ Markram edged Starc to slip in the 21st over.

South Africa scored 59-1 in the first hour. In the second hour, Temba Bavuma (3) was out caught off Lyon â€“ Steve Smith took a well-judged catch as Bavuma went for a reverse sweep. Cummins then had Bedingham caught in the slips with Smith taking another great catch to his left. After lunch, Cummins struck again. Wiaan Mulder was the first to go â€“ he scored 30 off 50 balls with three fours and a six, adding 56 with Tristan Stubbs.

Stubbs fell soon after for 32 caught at square leg, again off Cummins. Lyon had Kyle Verreynne caught at slip for 13 as South Africa stumbled to 197-7. Marco Jansen hit six fours for a 20-ball 26, before holing out off Hazlewood. South Africa was 238-8 at tea with Harmer and Maharaj able to go past the follow-on mark. Their 50-partnership ended when Starc dismissed Maharaj.



Skipper Pat Cummins (L) led from front with three wickets. AP

New record

Australia's Steve Smith set a record for most test catches as his side finished the third day of the first test with a 139-run lead over hosts South Africa before bad light brought an early close to Sunday's play at Kingsmead.

Smith took four superb catches to take his test tally to 223, going past the record of 220 held by England's Joe Root. Two of the catches showed outstanding anticipation as Smith shuffled across a few steps to snag South Africa captain Temba Bavuma and Kyle Verreynne as they both tried reverse sweeps off the spin bowling of Nathan Lyon.

He also produced a flying dive across first slip to break the record and see off the threat of David Bedingham.

His last catch, off Beau Webster, brought South Africa's innings to a close as they scored 284 in reply to Australia's first innings of 390.

BRIEF SCORES: Australia 390 & 33/0 (Nic Maddinson 17 not out) lead against South Africa 284 all out (David Bedingham 49; Pat Cummins 3/54, Josh Hazlewood 2/54) by 139 runs at stumps on Day 3.

Antonelli dares to dream as historic F1 title zooms in to view



Kimi Antonelli. AP

Tom Westbrook
Singapore, October 11

MERCEDES' KIMI Antonelli said he is allowing himself to dream about a historic world title which is within reach at the next race in Austin, Texas, after the 20-year-old sealed his 14th podium finish of the season at Sunday's Singapore Grand Prix.

The title would make Antonelli Formula One's youngest ever champion and Italy's first since 1953.

Antonelli's third place in a Singapore Grand Prix that was controlled from start to finish by Red Bull's Max Verstappen was scrappy, as he flirted with a penalty for testing the track's limits. But it was enough to extend his lead over teammate George Russell to 102 points and when asked if he dared to dream of clinching the title in Austin later this month on the long journey home he said: "For sure.

"But at the same time, I know it's very close, I know it's there, but I just need to make sure that I keep doing the best I can. The mindset is always the same, to go out there and win.

"I think this weekend I haven't particularly driven that well... but I feel confident that, (with) a week to reset and I'm really looking forward to being back in Austin.

"If I don't do my job well, then the result won't come. So in order to achieve what I want, I need to perform at 100%."

Antonelli can mathematically win the championship in Austin on the assumption there are still five races to come after, with the fate of the Grands Prix in Qatar and Abu Dhabi up in the air due to the conflict in the Middle East.

However, Mercedes boss Toto Wolff is refusing to tempt fate. "I remind myself that this is motor racing and crazy things have happened," Wolff said. "It probably needs the other two (contenders), George and Lewis (Hamilton), to retire and him winning. So this is not a likely scenario," he added, while recognising that the title was within reach and maybe inevitable.

"It's going to come towards him, whether that's in Mexico or Brazil, or far down the line."

Russell, who worked his way up from the back of the starting grid due to engine penalties, finished a respectable ninth. REUTERS

RANJI TROPHY ROUND 1: RAJASTHAN V TAMIL NADU

Karan ton, Rohan's refined knock puts hosts in driver's seat

U-23 teammates take their chances to lead Rajasthan to 286/4 on Day 1; Devendran wayward on debut

Bhuvan Gupta
Jaipur, October 11



Karan Lamba was unbeaten on 103 at stumps on Day 1. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

TIME WAITS for no one; neither does talent.

Karan Lamba had struck three hundreds and five fifty-plus scores in his previous six outings for Rajasthan. He was the state's top run-getter in the Vijay Hazare Trophy last season. He also scored big in the Colonel CK Nayudu Under-23 Trophy. Yet, a Ranji playing XI spot eluded him for the last two years.

Karan's U-23 teammate Rohan Rajbhar was riding a similar boat, with the difference that he was yet to make a Ranji debut. Both got their chance on Sunday and capitalised. Karan hit an unbeaten century while Rohan fell five short of three figures, as they took the hosts to a position of strength on Day 1 against Tamil Nadu (TN).

With the Sawai Mansingh Stadium pitch offering nothing to the TN bowlers, Rajasthan's young duo dug in. They shared a 125-run stand for the third wicket before the visitors' 37-year-old seamer Saravana Kumar snuffed out Rohan. His short ball snaked in to kiss the opener's gloves on the way to 'keeper N Jagadeesan.

A six-hungry Kartik Sharma then threw his wicket away to Washington Sundar. TN suddenly had a foot in the door. That is when Karan combined with Mahipal Lomror to restore Rajasthan's advantage — they ended the day at 286 for four. Captain Manav Suthar and Ajay Singh Kukna, both useful lower-order batsmen, are still to take the crease.

Having waited since February 2024 for a Ranji game, Karan did not look at his innings as a fitting riposte to selectors. He said he simply did what he needed to. "I have to do my job. Performing is in my hands, I focus on that. I don't fret on selection too much; for me it's all about how I can improve my game," Karan said after going to stumps at 103 not out. Lomror was giving him company at a brisk unbeaten 31. Karan, who got to his ton with a silken square drive off Saravana, added that the placid surface helped his cause. "The wicket was good to bat on. You rarely get such flat tracks, so I made sure to cash in," he said.

Apart from their time together at the U-23 level, Rohan and Karan have both represented Jaipur at the district level and that aided their alliance. "It helped our running between the wickets. Having played together for a long time, we don't usually have misunderstandings," the centurion said.

He found his graduation from U-23 to Ranji smooth. Karan admitted the lack of limelight to his CK Nayudu Trophy exploits did hurt him somewhat, but was quick to add that selectors are on the lookout at all kinds of tournaments. "You can get selected from anywhere. It's not that they will only pick from Ranji Trophy. If you perform well at the U-23s, they have their eyes on you anyway."

Two-year wait

Though Sunday's century came after two years of wait, Karan enjoyed his ton on Ranji debut in 2023 (against Jharkhand in Jaipur) more. "As a cricketer, it is a dream to play in the Ranji Trophy. The day I realised that dream I hit a hundred so that was more satisfying," he said.

The 20-year-old Rohan realised his Ranji dream on Sunday, albeit in a bittersweet manner. He batted with remarkable restraint and looked set for a hundred when Saravana cut his dream short. Rohan's longtime coach Rohit Jhalani felt his debut should have happened a couple of seasons back. "Mein toh last year bhi wait kar raha tha," the former first-class wicket keeper said.

Rohan, whose patient 95 came off 220 balls, has the right temperament for red-ball cricket, according to Jhalani. "He is very determined and has a compact technique. He has loved to hit big hundreds from the very beginning. He will play a long innings with Rajasthan and definitely has the potential to make the India cut too," the coach added.

Rohan reserved special treatment for TN skipper Sai Kishore, charging him straight away for a six down the ground.

He swept the left-arm spinner for a glorious boundary through square leg later and after being dropped on 76 and 80 by Sai Sudharsan, seemed destined for a hundred. Things turned out otherwise, but the youngster will have plenty more chances. Just like the 18-year-old TN pace sensation Deepesh Devendran, who was wayward on debut with figures of 0 for 54 in 13 overs.

BRIEF SCORES: **Rajasthan** 286 for four in 85 overs vs **Tamil Nadu** (Rohan Rajbhar 95, Karan Lamba 103 not out; Saravana Kumar 3 for 52).

Ranji wrap: Shami's four-fer puts Bengal on top

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 11



Shami hasn't featured for India in Test cricket since June 2023. FILE

IN HIS quest to don the national whites — something which has eluded him since June 2023 — Mohammed Shami took another stride in the right direction. Against Delhi in Bengal's red-ball campaign opener, he took four wickets for 30 runs at the Bengal Cricket Academy Ground in Kalyani.

The 36-year-old began his day with a dismissal he has been associated with for years — the cherry angling away with the seam, kissing the edge of Yash Dhull's blade. Ayush Doseja fell prey to an inswinger, while Shami's last two scalps were Divij Mehra and Hrithik Shokeen. Had it not been for the latter's 56, Delhi would not have reached a position — 240 all out — from where they could mount a fight on Day 2.

BRIEF SCORES: **Delhi** 240 all out (Hrithik Shokeen 56; Mohammed Shami 4/30) vs **Bengal.**

The 36-year-old began his day with a dismissal he has been associated with for years — the cherry angling away with the seam, kissing the edge of Yash Dhull's blade.

Jaiswal out on duck

It has been over a year since Yashasvi Jaiswal scored a century in red-ball cricket, and while it might not be a pressing cause of concern for the Indian management, they would ideally want him to have runs under his belt before boarding the flight for New Zealand.

Sunday, however, did not go according to plans, as the opener could not open his account against Chandigarh at the Wankhede Stadium. He lost his wicket to seamer Jagjit Singh Sandhu, although Siddhesh Lad is leading his team by example — the captain's unbeaten 80 powering Mumbai to 249/5.

BRIEF SCORES: **Mumbai** 249/5 (Siddhesh Lad 80 not out; Rohit Dhanda 3/44) vs **Chandigarh.**

Veterans' no-show

Jaiswal, though, was not found wanting in the assemblage of national Test team players who had a rather forgettable start to their domestic campaign. On the back of a century in the third ODI against the West Indies, KL Rahul struggled to translate his white-ball exploits into red-ball cricket.

Against Andhra, he could only contribute four runs to Karnataka's total, while fellow veterans Mayank Agarawal and Karun Nair accounted for 13 runs combined. The saving grace for the eight-time champions was Ravichandran Smaran, who scored his seventh First-Class century. Having revealed his goal of a 1000-run season during the Irani Cup earlier this month, Smaran would be content with how he started his endeavour.

BRIEF SCORES: **Karnataka** 274 all out (Ravichandran Smaran 126; Saurabh Kumar 3/69) vs **Andhra** 16/2.

J&K attack

The Irani Cup might have eluded them, but defending Ranji Trophy champions Jammu & Kashmir offered glimpses of the pace mastery that won them the historic title. Rohit Sharma took a fifer, while Sunil Kumar scalped four as Madhya Pradesh were bowled out for 196 runs.

BRIEF SCORES: **Madhya Pradesh** 196 all out (Shubham Sharma 79; Rohit Sharma 5/36) vs **Jammu & Kashmir** 3/1.

GROUP A: **Uttar Pradesh** 287/3 (Madhav Kaushik 124 not out, Rinku Singh 109 not out; Suraj Kashyap 2/44) vs **Bihar.**

Bawne, Maharashtra batter who, 19 years on, believes India will call



Ankit Bawne was unbeaten on 105 on Sunday. PTI

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, October 11

ANKIT BAWNE was 15, from Aurangabad, a city since renamed, when he scored 11 centuries in 12 innings at the MCA Invitational U-15 league. He had never had professional coaching and had learned the craft from television. Two double-centuries and as many centuries in the Polly Umrigar Trophy followed. The BCCI's MA Chidambaram award for India's best Under-15 cricketer was his.

That was 19 years ago. On Sunday, at Palam, Bawne made an unbeaten 105 off 232 deliveries on the first day of Maharashtra's Ranji Trophy opener against Services. It was his 25th First-Class century, after a season in which he scored 72 runs at an average of 10.28.

Maharashtra closed the day on 287/5, with Arjun Sharma taking three wickets for 74 runs for Services.

Stability or stagnation

Nineteen years can look like stability or like stagnation. When this newspaper put the question of 19 years to him, minutes after the hundred, he fell quiet.

"When you put it that way, it does feel that I have been here for a long time," he says. "Perhaps, I actually have. I am nearing 15,000 runs in domestic cricket. I am nearing 20 years in the circuit. It has actually been a long career. But honestly, I have never felt that way because I have always taken it one game at a time."

The hundred came on a pitch of uneven pace and bounce.

"Emotions are running here. Firstly, because it is a Ranji hundred, which is always special. But this is also my 25th First-Class century. Moreover, I had a point to prove this season.

"I did absolutely nothing last season. I did not even score 100 runs in the entire season. *Mera bat dhool kha raha tha* (my bat was collecting dirt). I made it a point that regardless of what happens, regardless of how the pitch and conditions are, I will score a hundred today. I had manifested this moment," said Bawne after his ton.

"The hunger I have at 34 is the same that I had at 15. If a Paras Dogra can lead a team to Ranji Trophy title at the age of 41, then why can't an Ankit Bawne dream of playing for India at 34?"
ANKIT BAWNE,
ON INDIA CALL-UP DREAM

There was an unbeaten 162 for India A against a New Zealand A featuring Lockie Ferguson and Ish Sodhi, in 2017. A year later came an unbeaten 91 against Australia A, followed by the captaincy of the side against the England Lions.

Unanswered knocks

India won that List A series 4-1. Bawne, it seemed, was knocking at the selectors' door.

The knocks went unanswered. That, though, has not stopped him from still dreaming.

"The hunger I have at 34 is the same that I had at 15. If a Paras Dogra can lead a team to Ranji Trophy title at the age of 41, then why can't an Ankit Bawne dream of playing for India at 34?

"If I score 1200 runs in this Ranji season, who's going to stop me from getting noticed by the BCCI selectors? The way I look at it, I always tell myself an opportunity can come at any given moment. If I think that I have played for nearly 20 years and still I never made it to the national team, I won't have the motivation to keep fighting."

As he reached his hundred, Bawne raised his bat towards the dugout. It was a message, though not one of disdain.

"I didn't do it in a rude way. It was just to convey a message, that I am still playing, still performing, still alive," he said in the end.

On Sunday, he was alive.

BRIEF SCORES: **Maharashtra 287/5 (Ankit Bawne 105 not out; Arjun Sharma 3/74) vs Services.**

Man City silence hostile Anfield with 3-0 win

Reuters
Liverpool, October 11

MANCHESTER CITY silenced a hostile Anfield crowd as second-half goals from Erling Haaland, Jeremy Doku and Rayan Cherki secured a 3-0 victory over 10-man Liverpool on Sunday and maintained the Premier League leaders' perfect start to the season.

City were playing for the first time since an independent commission found them guilty of 114 breaches of the league's financial rules, and were greeted by deafening boos and angry chants. But Enzo Maresca's side stood firm against Liverpool's early pressure and a fevered atmosphere before taking control after Ryan Gravenberch was sent off in the 62nd minute for a second booking following a foul on Doku.

Haaland then struck three minutes later, smashing a left-footed shot past Alisson after Doku worked the ball into the box and his attempted shot was deflected into the path of the big Norwegian.

Haaland made a beeline to celebrate with the travelling City fans including Oasis frontman Noel Gallagher.

Doku doubled the lead in the 68th minute with a gorgeous long-range shot that curled into the far top corner. Cherki completed the rout -- and sent scores of Liverpool fans heading to the exits -- in the 78th minute when he let the ball roll through to Josko Gvardiol before turning into the box to meet his teammate's pass and slot the ball home.

"It was a lovely moment that will stay with us a long time," Man City striker Haaland told Sky Sports. "It's time to stay strong and stick together and do what you can do something about, stick together."

Man City midfielder Elliot Anderson said City's unity had stood out. "We've shown real togetherness and fight. It's a tough place to come and it's challenging," he said."We really stuck together out there, fought for each other and played well."

The Liverpool fans left at the final whistle chanted "Going down! Going Down! Going Down!" in reference to City's potential relegation. The club have denied all wrongdoing, and have appealed the independent commission's verdict.

ISSF SHOOTING WORLD CUP

Sidhu's arc: From watching idol Reitz on loop, to beating him

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, October 11



Udhayveer Sidhu (C) won the 10m air pistol WC title. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

WHEN GROWING up, Udhayveer Sidhu and his younger twin brother Vijayveer often watched videos of Christian Reitz, the Rio Olympics 25m pistol champion. Years later, he edged out his idol to win his maiden World Cup title in 10m air pistol in Cairo. Beside them, Vijayveer was furiously clicking photographs of Reitz patting his brother.

After the final, the fanboy in Udhayveer surfaced. "Vijayveer and I have grown up idolising Christian Reitz sir and watching his videos on YouTube. When I won the gold, I congratulated and told him that it's the 46th international medal and that it's my first medal at the senior level," he tells *The Indian Express* from Cairo. "He told me that his maiden senior international medal too was a gold at the ISSF World Cup (Rio 2008). It's the best compliment of my shooting career," he says.

The twins grew up in Mansa in Punjab with their father Gurpreet Singh Sidhu, an assistant education officer. In 2013, he got them a 10m air pistol to train.

"When we started, both of us practised with the single 10m air pistol our father bought for Rs 130,000. As twins, we share a special bond and we always pushed each other. While Vijayveer is two minutes younger and does not listen to me as an elder brother most of the time (laughs), we always share inputs regarding shooting," Udhayveer says.

Constant feature

They lost their father in 2017 to an illness. But a year later, Udhayveer became the 25m pistol champion in the ISSF World Junior Championships in Changwon. Vijayveer won the 25m standard pistol title.

Over the next two years, the twins became a constant feature in the Indian junior shooting team. Vijayveer clinched the junior world titles in 25m pistol and 25m standard pistol in 2021 while Udhayveer won silver in the 25m standard pistol.

But Vijayveer received the senior call-up first. He duly impressed with a silver in the ISSF World Cup in New Delhi but narrowly missed the quota for Tokyo Games. He, though, qualified for the Paris Olympics. Udhayveer, meanwhile, kept plugging in the junior circuit. He won the junior 25m pistol and 25m standard pistol world titles in Cairo in 2022.

Both started in 25m pistol events together, balancing it with 10m air pistol events as well. Brotherly advice is frequent. "While we often talk about getting the basics right in the 10m air pistol and how it helps one with patience, Vijayveer always tells me to trust myself in the 25m pistol. I tend to think too much in controlling my shots but Vijayveer always tells me to trust my process," says Udhayveer.

Fight to remember

The eight-shooter grid in Cairo featured two medallists in Paris—bronze medallist Paolo Monna and 10m air pistol mixed team silver medallist Yusuf Dikec of Turkey. Udhayveer started with a series of 49.8 and 2.1 behind top placed Moana.

The Indian dropped to the sixth spot after the second series. Over the next 14 shots with one shooter being eliminated after every two shots, Udhayveer shot four shots fewer than ten with the rest shooting inconsistently. One-time leader Moana ended with the bronze. Udhayveer trailed Reitz by 0.3 points going into the final two shots before he hit a 10.2. The German managed only 9.6. With a lead of 0.3 before the final shot, Udhayveer hit a 9.8 with the German hitting a 9.6. "Udhayveer's level of tactical maturity impressed me," said coach Jelena Arunovic.

"He has managed to take the best practices from the 25m rapid fire pistol and successfully apply them to the 10m air pistol. Udhayveer managed the final well," she added.

The coach draws a sibling parallel between him and her younger sister Zorana, 10m air pistol mixed team gold medallist in Paris Olympics.

"I think we should look at the relationship between the twins from a slightly different perspective. Having her there in the team makes things easier for me. We competed during training, but we also shared experiences, learned from one another and always looked after each other. Later, I became her coach and guided her to all the major medals she won, including Olympic gold. Healthy competition and mutual support can go hand in hand," said the coach. So is it with the Sidhus.

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